

GREAT OFFERS!



Scan to
Subscribe

NEW DELHI | THURSDAY, JULY 30, 2026 | PAGES 16 | ₹5.00

PUBLISHED FROM: DELHI LUCKNOW BHOPAL RAIPUR BHUBANESWAR RANCHI CHANDIGARH DEHRADUN HYDERABAD VIJAYAWADA THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

www.dailypioneer.com

facebook.com/dailypioneer

@TheDailyPioneer

instagram.com/dailypioneer

linkedin.com/in/dailypioneer

The Pioneer

TRUSTED SINCE 1865

RNI No. 53466/91. Vol.36 Issue 209

THIS IS A PUBLIC ANNOUNCEMENT FOR INFORMATION PURPOSES ONLY. THIS IS NOT A PROSPECTUS ANNOUNCEMENT AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INVITATION OR OFFER TO ACQUIRE, PURCHASE OR SUBSCRIBE TO SECURITIES. NOT FOR RELEASE, PUBLICATION OR DISTRIBUTION, DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY OUTSIDE INDIA. INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF EQUITY SHARES ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE"), AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER I OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS")



JUNIPER GREEN ENERGY LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)



(Please scan this QR Code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and Abridged Prospectus)

Our Company was originally incorporated as "AT Capital Advisory India Private Limited" as a private limited company under the provisions of the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated December 5, 2011, issued by the Registrar of Companies, National Capital Territory of Delhi and Haryana at New Delhi. Subsequently, the name of our Company changed to "Juniper Green Energy Private Limited", pursuant to a board resolution dated November 22, 2018 and a shareholders' resolution dated November 28, 2018 to reflect a shift in our focus towards streamlining of our business and a fresh certificate of incorporation was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi and Haryana at New Delhi on December 8, 2018. Upon the conversion of our Company from a private limited company to a public limited company, pursuant to a Board resolution dated May 13, 2025 and a special resolution passed by our Shareholders in the extra-ordinary general meeting dated May 22, 2025, the name of our Company was changed to "Juniper Green Energy Limited", and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated May 26, 2025 was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre. For details in relation to the changes in the registered office of our Company, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters - Changes in the registered office of our Company" on page 396 of the Red Herring Prospectus dated July 23, 2026 ("RHP").

Corporate Identity Number: U40100DL2011PLC228318

Registered Office: 1103A & 1103B, 11th Floor, Hemkunt Chamber, 89, Nehru Place, New Delhi 110 019, Delhi, India; Corporate Office: 3rd and 4th Floor, Building 4, Candor TechSpace, Sector 48, Gurugram 122 001, Haryana, India
Contact Person: Prashant Pandia, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; Tel: +91 124 473 9600; E-mail: investors@junipergreenenergy.com; Website: www.junipergreenenergy.com

OUR PROMOTERS: ARVIND TIKU, HEMANT TIKOO, NIHARIKA TIKU, AT HOLDINGS PTE. LTD. AND JUNIPER RENEWABLE HOLDINGS PTE. LTD.

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JUNIPER GREEN ENERGY LIMITED ("COMPANY") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹18,000.00 MILLION ("FRESH ISSUE" OR THE "ISSUE"), THE ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY. THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹20.00 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY.

PRICE BAND: ₹214 TO ₹225 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 21.4 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 22.5 TIMES OF THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 66 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 66 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH THEREAFTER.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹21 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.

THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 271.08 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 257.83 TIMES

THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO IS 93.67 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS 1.34%.

The details of the fresh Issue and post issue market capitalization of our Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹214 per equity share		At Cap Price of ₹225 per equity share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	84,122,317	18,000.00*	80,009,150	18,000.00*
Total Issue Size	84,122,317	18,000.00*	80,009,150	18,000.00*
Post-Issue market capitalization of the Company	573,111,609	122,645.88	568,998,442	128,024.65

*The Issue includes the Employee Reservation Portion and a discount of ₹21 per Equity Share is being offered to Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion.

BID/ISSUE
PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY

BID/ISSUE CLOSING ON: MONDAY, AUGUST 3, 2026*

*UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 PM on Bid/Issue Closing Date.

WE ARE AMONG THE TOP 10 LARGEST RENEWABLE INDEPENDENT POWER PRODUCER ("IPPS") IN INDIA IN TERMS OF TOTAL CAPACITY AS AT MARCH 31, 2026, WHERE TOTAL CAPACITY INCLUDES OPERATIONAL, UNDER CONSTRUCTION CONTRACTED AND AWARDED PROJECTS. (SOURCE: CRISIL REPORT)

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE.

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹20.00 MILLION.

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE ISSUE AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES/REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendation of committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to the resolution dated July 24, 2026, the above provided price band is justified based on quantitative factors/KPIs disclosed in the "Basis for Issue Price" section on page 185 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s) as applicable, disclosed in the "Basis for Issue Price" on page 185 of the RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

(For details, refer to the "Risk Factors" section on page 25 of the RHP.)

1. Reliance on certain off-takers risk:

A significant portion of our revenue from operations is derived from the sale of electricity generated at our projects and our top two off-takers collectively contributed 86.06%, 91.11% and 97.00% of our revenue from operations for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. The loss of any such key commercial relationships could adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.

Particulars	2026		Fiscal 2025		2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)	Amount (₹ million)	Percentage of revenue from operations (%)
Revenue generated from our off-taker - GUVNL	2,865.17	39.85	2,426.91	47.71	2,009.51	51.32
Revenue generated from our off-taker - MSEDCL	3,321.85	46.21	2,207.73	43.40	1,788.70	45.68
Total	6,187.02	86.06	4,634.64	91.11	3,798.21	97.00

2. High dependence on suppliers risk:

Our business is dependent on suppliers for the procurement of critical components, equipment, material and other goods for the operation of our projects as well as for other business operations. Our top 10 suppliers collectively contributed to 84.42%, 79.99% and 87.52% of our total purchases for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Interruptions in the supply of our critical components and other goods could adversely affect our business operations, financial position and cash flow.

3. Encumbrance of Equity Shares risk:

Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd. ("Juniper Renewable"), one of our Corporate Promoters, had pledged 7,194,462 Equity Shares (1.46% of total pre-Issue share capital on a fully diluted basis) in favour of IREDA as security for a loan availed by our Company. Additionally, post-listing, we are required to create a further pledge over certain Equity Shares in favour of IREDA as security in relation to one of our project financing arrangements. Any default under these pledge arrangements will entitle IREDA to enforce the pledge, which could dilute the shareholding of our Corporate Promoter and may adversely affect our business, results of operations, cash flows and prospects.

4. Geographical concentration risk:

Our renewable energy projects are located in the states of Gujarat, Maharashtra, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh. Our operations are susceptible to local and regional factors including adverse changes in government policies, political factors, economic conditions, weather conditions, natural disasters, the outbreak of infectious diseases and other unforeseen events and circumstances affecting these states. Any such events may disrupt our projects, adversely impact our ability to meet contractual obligations, and materially affect our operations, cash flows, financial condition and results of operations.

5. Land acquisition risk:

Our development of renewable energy projects may be restrained by our inability to identify or acquire suitable land sites. If we are unable to identify suitable land on commercially acceptable terms, our ability to develop new renewable energy projects on a timely basis or at all might be affected, which could result in the imposition of liquidated damages and/or reductions in tariffs which could adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

6. Dependence on environmental conditions risk:

Our revenue is a direct function of the electricity we generate, which is significantly influenced by environmental conditions, irradiation and wind speed. Electricity output may decrease under adverse conditions including cloudy weather, sandstorms, heavy rainfall, solar eclipses and environmental pollution. The seasonal nature of our energy production can place additional demands on our working capital reserves, particularly during periods of reduced cash flow from operations. Any adverse change in environmental conditions may materially impact our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.

7. Related party transactions risk:

In the ordinary course of our business, we have in the past entered into, and may continue to enter into, related party transactions. While all such transactions have been conducted on an arm's length basis in accordance with the Companies Act, relevant Accounting Standards and applicable regulations, we cannot assure you that we might not have achieved more favourable terms had such transactions not been entered into with related parties. The arithmetic aggregated absolute total of all related party transactions (excluding capital related transactions) amounted to ₹89.26 million (1.24% of revenue from operations) for Fiscal 2026, ₹56.99 million (1.13% of revenue from operations) for Fiscal 2025 and ₹60.59 million (1.54% of revenue from operations) for Fiscal 2024. There can be no assurance that such transactions, individually or in the aggregate, may not involve potential conflicts of interest which could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.

8. Change of regulatory policies and economic incentives risk:

Our business depends on a supportive policy and regulatory framework, including government incentives, renewable purchase obligations and favourable auction structures. Any reduction, modification or cancellation of such incentives or policy support could adversely impact the viability and profitability of our projects. We are also required to maintain numerous approvals, licences, registrations and permits, and any failure to obtain, renew or maintain these could interrupt our operations. Non-compliance with applicable environmental, health and safety laws could result in fines, curtailment of operations or criminal sanctions, and any changes in laws or regulations may require significant additional compliance expenditure, any of which could adversely affect our business, cash flows, financial condition and results of operations.

9. Lease termination and non-renewal risk:

We do not own a majority of the land on which our projects are located or will be located, and our Registered Office and Corporate Office are held on lease from third parties. If these leases or sub-leases are terminated or not renewed on terms acceptable to us, it could adversely affect our business, results of operations and cash flows.

10. Utilization of a portion of Net Proceeds for repayment of loan facilities from an affiliate of a Book Running Lead Manager:

A portion of our Net Proceeds may be used to repay or pre-pay certain loan facilities availed from The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited. While HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited is one of our Book Running Lead Managers and The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited is an affiliate of our Book Running Lead Managers, these loans were sanctioned in the ordinary course of business and are not considered a conflict under applicable SEBI Regulations. The Board has chosen the loans and facilities to be repaid/prepaid based on commercial considerations. However, the use of Net Proceeds for repayment of such loans may still be perceived as a potential conflict of interest.

11. The price to earnings ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 is 257.83 and 271.08 times at the lower and upper end of the Price Band respectively.

12. The weighted average return on net-worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 1.34%.

13. Set forth below are details of the price at which specified securities were acquired in the last three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus by each of our Promoters, Promoter Group and shareholders entitled with the right to nominate directors or any other rights:

Name of acquirer/shareholder	Nature of the transaction	Nature of specified securities	Face value (in ₹)	Date of acquisition	Number of specified securities	Acquisition price per specified shares (in ₹)*
Promoter⁽³⁾						
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	August 22, 2023	3,703,267	594.07
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	September 22, 2023	1,396,200	594.07
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	December 20, 2023	2,621,094	667.66
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	January 15, 2024	898,660	667.66
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	January 25, 2024	2,246,652	667.66
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	April 9, 2024	2,225,816	673.91
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	April 26, 2024	2,723,924	844.37
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Preferential allotment	CCDs 1	100	July 30, 2024	40,000,000	100
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Preferential allotment	CCDs 2	100	September 10, 2024	16,350,000	100
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	December 20, 2024	3,907,359	974.52
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Conversion of CCDs ⁽²⁾	Equity shares	10	December 20, 2024	5,782,333	974.52 ⁽¹⁾
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Rights issue	Equity shares	10	March 13, 2025	3,910,500	1,163.84
Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd.	Bonus issue in the ratio of 10 Equity Shares for every 1 Equity Share held	Equity Shares	10	March 26, 2025	444,535,720	NA

*As certified by ARAJ & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants, bearing firm registration number 023981N/N500116, by way of their certificate dated July 24, 2026.

⁽¹⁾ Consideration for such Equity Shares (issued pursuant to conversion of CCDs) was paid at the time of issuance of such CCDs, which were acquired at a price of ₹100 per CCD in two tranches (the date of allotment of CCDs 1 and CCDs 2 was July 30, 2024 and September 10, 2024, respectively).

⁽²⁾ Pursuant to a resolution dated July 24, 2024 and July 30, 2024 approved by our Shareholders and Board, respectively, 40,000,000 compulsorily convertible debentures ("CCDs 1") were allotted to Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd. Thereafter, pursuant to a resolution dated July 24, 2024 and September 10, 2024 approved by our Shareholders and Board, respectively, 16,350,000 compulsorily convertible debentures ("CCDs 2", together with CCDs 1, "CCDs") were allotted to Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd. Subsequently, pursuant to a resolution dated December 20, 2024 approved by our Board, all 56,350,000 CCDs were converted into 5,782,333 equity shares and allotted to Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd. on December 20, 2024. Accordingly, as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, there are no outstanding CCDs.

⁽³⁾ Also a shareholder with nomination right. For further details, see section titled "History and Certain Corporate Matters – Details of the Shareholders' Agreement and other material agreements" on page 409 of the RHP.

...continued on next page...

...continued from previous page.

14. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted during the last one year, 18 months and three years from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus:				
Period	Number of Equity Shares transacted of face value of ₹10 each	Weighted average cost of acquisition (in ₹) ^a	Cap Price is 'x' times the weighted average cost of acquisition	Range of acquisition price: lowest price – highest price (in ₹) ^a
One year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.
18 months preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	448,446,220	10.15	22.17	Nil – 1,163.84
Three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	473,951,525	52.06	4.32	Nil – 1,163.84

^aAs certified by ARAJ & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants, bearing firm registration number 023981N/N500116, by way of their certificate dated July 24, 2026.

⁽¹⁾Weighted average cost of acquisition has been arrived at by considering only the cost of shares transacted by the Promoters on account of any further issue, conversion of CCDs, bonus issue or secondary transfers, i.e., the cost paid or received by the Promoters for transactions in Equity Shares, divided by the total number of Equity Shares transacted.

⁽²⁾Nil represents cost of Equity Shares acquired pursuant to a bonus issue (at no consideration).

⁽³⁾The details in the table above have been calculated for all the Equity Shares acquired by the Promoters.

15. **Weighted average cost of acquisition, Floor Price and Cap Price**

The Floor Price is 6.05 times and the Cap Price is 6.36 times the weighted average cost of acquisition based on Primary Issuances and Secondary Transactions as disclosed below:

Type of transactions	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (₹) ^a	Floor Price ₹214 (in times)	Cap Price ₹225 (in times)
WACA for Primary Transactions	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.
WACA for secondary sale/ acquisitionof share	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

- The Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement.
- The Promoters or members of the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing of the draft red herring prospectus dated June 27, 2025 till date
- The aggregate Equity shareholding and percentage of the pre-Issue paid up Equity Share capital and post-Issue Equity shareholding, of our Promoter, members of our Promoter Group and public shareholders (top 10 Shareholders) of our Company is set forth below. Further, as on date, none of the members of the Promoter Group hold any Equity Shares of our Company

S. No.	Pre-Issue shareholding as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus			Post-Issue shareholding as at Allotment ²			
	Name of the Shareholder	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each (on a fully diluted basis) ¹	Pre-Issue Shareholding, on a fully diluted basis (%) ¹	At the lower end of the Price Band (₹214 per Equity Share)		At the upper end of the Price Band (₹225 per Equity Share)	
				Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Post-Issue Shareholding (%)	Number of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Post-Issue Shareholding (%)
1	Juniper Renewable Holdings Pte. Ltd. ^a	488,989,292	99.43 ^a	488,989,292	84.90 ^a	488,989,292	85.52 ^a

^aIncludes six equity shares of face value of ₹10 each, i.e., one equity share of face value of ₹10 each held by each of Suneet Puri, Parag Agrawal, Ankush Malik, Gaurav Kumar Kalal, Amit Gupta and Deepak Katyal on behalf of and as nominees of Juniper Renewable, one of the Corporate Promoters.

^{*}The percentage of Equity Share capital on a fully diluted basis, assuming issuance of 2,817,358 Equity Shares resulting upon exercise of vested options under the ESOP 2025.

Notes: 1. This will include any transfers of Equity Shares by existing Shareholders and assuming issuance of 2,817,358 Equity Shares resulting upon exercise of vested options under the ESOP 2025, up to the date of the Prospectus.

2. Assuming full subscription in the Issue. The post-Issue shareholding details as at Allotment will be based on the actual subscription and the Issue Price and updated in the Prospectus, subject to finalization of the Basis of Allotment.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE



You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of ICICI Securities Limited

The “Basis for Issue Price” section on page 185 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: www.icicisecurities.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.jmfi.com and <https://investmentbank.kotak.com> for the “Basis for Issue Price” updated with the above price band.

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):		
Bid/Issue Period (except the Bid/Issue Closing Date)		
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. Indian Standard Time ("IST")	
Bid/Issue Closing Date*		
Submission of Electronic Applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts)–For RIBs, other than QIBs and NIIs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST	
Submission of Electronic Applications (Bank ASBA through Online channels like Internet Banking, Mobile Banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST	
Submission of Electronic Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST	
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST	
Submission of Physical Applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual Applications of QIBs and NIIs where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST	
Modification/ Revision/cancellation of Bids		
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories ^a	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Issue Closing Date	
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIs	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Issue Closing Date	
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST on Bid/Issue Closing Date	

^aUPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on the Bid/Issue Closing Date.

^aQIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Issue Closing Date, for cancelled/withdrawn/deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher, from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding four Working Days from the Bid/Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Issue Closing Date by the intermediary responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidder shall be compensated by the intermediary responsible for causing such delay in unblocking in accordance with applicable law. Further, investors shall be entitled to compensation in the manner specified in the SEBI Master Circular in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of fund. The processing fees for applications made by the UPI Bidders may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation on compliance with SEBI Master Circular.

ASBA[#]

Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

#Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to Issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.



UPI
UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI - Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. Retail Individual Investors and Non-Institutional Investors also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT Notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and abridged prospectus and also please refer to the section “**Issue Procedure**” on page 710 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (“AIBI”) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=35 and <https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmid=43>, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and Axis Bank Limited has been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Issue, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018. For Issue related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll-free number: 18002101740 and mail id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period shall be extended for at least three additional Working Days after such revision of the Price Band, subject to the total Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band, and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice and also by indicating the change on the websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Members of the Syndicate and by intimation to Designated Intermediaries and Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. The Issue is being made in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process in accordance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to QIBs (the “**QIB Portion**”), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors and the balance of such allocation will be on a discretionary basis by our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations (the “**Anchor Investor Portion**”), of which, (i) 33.33% shall be available for allocation to domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription in (i) above, the allocation may be made to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than Anchor Investor Portion) (“**Net QIB Portion**”). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Investors (“**Non-Institutional Category**” or “**Non-Institutional Portion**”) of which one-third of the Non-Institutional Category shall be available for allocation to Bidders with an application size of more than ₹200,000 and up to ₹1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Category shall be available for allocation to Bidders with an application size of more than ₹1,000,000 and under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of Non-Institutional Category may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Category in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Investors (“**Retail Category**” or “**Retail Portion**”), in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Issue Price. All Bidders (except Anchor Investors) shall mandatorily participate in this Issue only through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“**ASBA**”) process and shall provide details of their respective bank account (including UPI ID (defined hereinafter) in case of UPI Bidders (defined hereinafter)) in which the Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks (“**SCSBs**”) or the Sponsor Bank(s), as the case may be, Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion through the ASBA process. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees applying under the Employee Reservation Portion, subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. For details, see “**Issue Procedure**” on page 710 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN, UPI ID and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of

Type of transactions	Weighted average cost of acquisition per Equity Share (₹) ^a	Floor Price ₹214 (in times)	Cap Price ₹225 (in times)
Since there were no Primary Issuance or Secondary Transactions of equity shares of our Company during the 18 months preceding the date of filing of the Red Herring Prospectus, where either issuance or acquisition/ sale is equal to or more than five per cent of the fully diluted paid-up share capital of our Company (calculated based on the pre-issue capital before such transaction/s and excluding employee stock options granted but not vested) the following are the details based on the last five primary and secondary transactions (secondary transactions where Promoter(s), members of the Promoter Group or Shareholders having the right to nominate Director(s) to the Board of our Company, are a party to the transaction), during the three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, irrespective of the size of transactions:			
WACA of Equity Shares based on Primary Issuances undertaken during the three immediately preceding years	35.36 ^a	6.05	6.36
WACA of Equity Shares based on Secondary Transactions undertaken during the three immediately preceding years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

^aAs certified by ARAJ & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants, bearing firm registration number 023981N/N500116, by way of their certificate dated July 24, 2026.

^aTaking into consideration cost of Equity Shares issued pursuant to a bonus issue which are issued at no consideration.

16. The four BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 94 public issues in the past three years out of which 28 issues closed below the issue price on listing date:

Name of the BRLMs	Total Public Issues	Issues closed below the issue price on listing date
ICICI Securities Limited*	25	7
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	2	1
JM Financial Limited*	14	3
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	12	3
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	41	14
Total	94	28

^{*}Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.

Bid/ Issue Programme	
EVENT	INDICATIVE DATE
ANCHOR INVESTOR BIDDING DATE	Wednesday, July 29, 2026
BID/ISSUE OPENS ON	Thursday, July 30, 2026
BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON^a	Monday, August 3, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Tuesday, August 4, 2026
Initiation of refunds for Anchor Investors/Unblocking of funds from ASBA account	On or about Wednesday, August 5, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Wednesday, August 5, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Thursday, August 6, 2026

^aUPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on the Bid/Issue Closing Date.

records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants’ sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, March 30, 2022 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, investors are requested to see “**History and Certain Corporate Matters**” on page 396 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, see “**Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection**” on page 754 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of Share Capital of our Company and Capital Structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorized share capital of our Company is ₹10,000,020,000 comprising of 1,000,002,000 Equity Shares of face value ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of our Company is ₹4,889,892,920 comprising 488,989,292 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For details of the capital structure of our Company, see “**Capital Structure**” on page 148 of the RHP.

Names of the Initial Signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company along with their allotment are: Hemant Tikoo and Suneet Puri were the initial subscribers to the MoA. For details of the share capital history and capital structure of our Company see “**Capital Structure**” on page 148 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each that will be offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. We have received in-principle approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each pursuant to letters, each dated August 14, 2025. For the purpose of this Issue, NSE is the Designated Stock Exchange. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been filed and a signed copy of the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Section 26(4) of the Companies Act 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/Issue Closing Date, see “**Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection**” on page 754 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”): SEBI only gives its observations on the draft Issue document and this does not constitute approval of either the issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 684 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of the SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of the NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Issue Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Issue Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 686 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of the BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by the BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 686 of the RHP for the full text of disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue including the risks involved. The Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the investors is invited to “**Risk Factors**” on page 25 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS				REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
					Prashant Pandia 3 rd and 4 th Floor, Building 4, Candor TechSpace, Sector 48 Gurugram 122 001, Haryana, India Tel: +91 124 473 9600 E-mail: investors@junipergreenenergy.com
ICICI Securities Limited ICICI Venture House, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Tel.: +91 22 6807 7100 E-mail: junipergreen@icicisecurities.com Website: www.icicisecurities.com Investor Grievance ID: customercare@icicisecurities.com Contact Person: Kishan Rastogi/ Nikita Chirania SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179	HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited 52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort Mumbai 400 001, Maharashtra, India Telephone: + 91 22 6864 1289 E-mail: juniperipo@hsbc.co.in Investor grievance email: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353	JM Financial Limited 7 th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025, Maharashtra, India Telephone: + 91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: junipergreenenergy.ip@jmfi.com Investor grievance email: grievance.ibd@jmfi.com Website: www.jmfi.com Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361	Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited 27 BKC, 1 st Floor, Plot No. C-27, “G” Block Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051, Maharashtra, India Tel.: +91 22 4336 0000 E-mail: junipergreen.ipo@kotak.com Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com Investor grievance e-mail: kmcredresal@kotak.com Contact Person: Ganesh Rana SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704	KFin Technologies Limited 301, The Centrum, 3 rd Floor, 57, Lal Bahadur Shastri Road, Nav Pada, Kurla (West), Kurla, Mumbai 400 070, Maharashtra, India Tel.: +91 40 6716 2222 E-mail: junipergreen.ipo@kfintech.com Website: www.kfintech.com Investor Grievance ID: eiward.ris@kfintech.com Contact Person: M Murali Krishna SEBI Registration Number: INR000000221	Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary accounts, non-credit of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, and so on. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF RHP: Investors should note that investment in Equity Shares involves a high degree of risk and investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the Risk Factors contained herein, before applying in the Issue. Full copy of the RHP is available at the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, the website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, the website of our Company at www.junipergreenenergy.com and the website of BRLMs, i.e., ICICI Securities Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, JM Financial Limited and Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.jmfi.com and <https://investmentbank.kotak.com> respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the abridged prospectus is available on the website of our Company at www.junipergreenenergy.com, the BRLMs, i.e., ICICI Securities Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, JM Financial Limited and Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.jmfi.com and <https://investmentbank.kotak.com> respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Application forms can be obtained from the Registered Office of JUNIPER GREEN ENERGY LIMITED, Tel: +91 124 473 9600 and the BRLMs – ICICI Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6807 7100, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, Telephone: + 91 22 6864 1289, JM Financial Limited, Telephone: + 91 22 6630 3030 and Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, Tel: +91 22 4336 0000.

SYNDICATE MEMBER: JM Financial Services Limited and Kotak Securities Limited and the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. ASBA has to be availed by all the investors. For details on ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to “**Issue Procedure**” on page 710 of the RHP. Further ASBA Application forms can be obtained from Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of banks that are available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The investors are required to fill the Bid Cum Application form and submit the same to the relevant SCSBs at the specific locations or registered brokers at the broker centers or RTA or DP’s. The SCSB’s will block the amount in the account as per the authority contained in application

form. On allotment, amount will be unblocked and account will be debited only to the extent required to be paid for allotment of shares. Hence, there will be no need of refund. UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

SUB-SYNDICATE MEMBERS: Almondz Global Securities Ltd., 5 Paisa Capital, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Ltd., Asit C. Mehta Financial Services Limited, Axis Capital Ltd., Centrum Capital Ltd., Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Private Limited, DB (International) Stock Brokers Ltd., Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services, Finwizard Technology Private Limited, Globe Capital Market Ltd., HDFC Securities, IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Ltd., IIFL Capital Services Ltd. (Formerly known as IIFL Securities Ltd.), Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Pvt. Ltd., Keynote Capital, KJMC Capital Markets Services Ltd., LXP Securities, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd., Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Formerly known as Edelweiss Broking Limited), Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt. Ltd., Pravin Ratilal Share and Stock Brokers Ltd., Religare Securities, RR Equity Brokers Pvt. Ltd., SBICAP Securities, Sharekhan Ltd., SMC Global Securities, Trade Bulls Securities (P) Ltd., Viren M Shah and YES Securities Ltd.

BANKERS TO THE ISSUE:

Escrow Collection Bank and Refund Bank: Axis Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Bank: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited

Sponsor Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and Axis Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in RHP.

Place: New Delhi, India
Date: July 29, 2026

For JUNIPER GREEN ENERGY LIMITED
on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Prashant Pandia
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Juniper Green Energy Limited is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the red herring prospectus dated July 23, 2026 with the Registrar of Companies, National Capital Territory of Delhi-I, at South Delhi. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, as well as on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of the Company at www.junipergreenenergy.com/investors/ and the websites of the Book Running Lead Managers, namely, ICICI Securities Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, JM Financial Limited and Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited on www.icicisecurities.com, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.jmfi.com and <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>, respectively. Potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risks, please see the section titled “**Risk Factors**” on page 25 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely in the draft red herring prospectus dated June 27, 2025

IN FOCUS



Painted storks seen inside an enclosure at Alipore Zoological Garden, in Kolkata, West Bengal

Dipke demands action over pellet gun use on students

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar

Asserting that student protesters are “not terrorists,” Cockroach Janta Party founder Abhijeet Dipke on Wednesday demanded action against officials who ordered pellet gun firing on July 20, warning that the youth will “change the Government” if police harassment continues.

Returning home after a month-long protest in New Delhi that led to the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan over the NEET paper leak, Dipke claimed police across multiple states are visiting student activists’ homes and threatening them with arrest. “The



CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke speaking to the media after arriving at his residence in Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar district, Maharashtra

Government should behave well now. The blood of students was spilled on the streets on July 20 (during the March to Parliament). It was really bad. Wasn’t it enough, now that the students are still being troubled? In many states, police

are visiting the houses of students and threatening them with arrests,” he told reporters.

Dipke also sought strict legal action against officials who authorised the use of pellet guns against student demonstrators at

New Delhi’s Jantar Mantar and warned that the Government should not presume that students’ anger has decreased after Pradhan’s resignation.

“Whether it be Amit Shah (or anyone else), action should be taken against the person who gave orders to fire pellet guns,” Dipke said. He also warned that if need be, the students may launch a fresh agitation on a “much bigger scale”.

“These students are not terrorists. They are the future of our country. If the future of the country is troubled in such a way, just as Dharmendra Pradhan had to step down. Tomorrow, we will go and change the Government if it doesn’t fall in line,” the Dipke added.

30,000 students to rally for transgender rights on August 8

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A youth coalition is organising coordinated transgender rights demonstrations across 25 cities in 25 States on August 8 under the name *Hamari Awaaz*. The demonstration aimed to mobilise an estimated 30,000 students in a single day of action that organisers describe as the largest transgender rights demonstration in India’s history.

The initiative is being led by Ishaan Bajaj, an 18-year-old activist who founded and runs Swayam, an LGBT+ inclusion organisation operating in 25 countries that has directly reached 40,000 people through pride events and a further 4,00,000 through digital outreach. The demonstration has two stated objectives. The first is increasing public visibility around the everyday barriers facing trans-



gender Indians, including employment discrimination and inconsistent enforcement of the Transgender Persons Act. The second is building momentum toward a planned legal petition that the coalition intends to file with the Supreme Court following the demonstration, though the exact scope of the petition has not yet been finalised.

“This isn’t a one-day event for us. August 8 is the visible part. The infrastructure behind it is what we worked on and actually care about,” Bajaj said.

30-year-old man stabbed to death saving woman from molestation in Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A 30-year-old man was stabbed to death while allegedly trying to protect a woman from a group of youths who attempted to molest her inside a park in Delhi’s Bharat Nagar on Wednesday afternoon.

The woman sustained serious stab injuries and has been referred to a higher medical centre after doctors suspected a possible lung injury.

Police have apprehended a juvenile in connection with the case.

Police received a PCR call regarding a stabbing at Khimman Singh Park in Ashok Vihar at around 3:33 pm. A police team rushed to the spot and found Devki (26), wife of Pawan and a resident of Jahangirpuri, along with Sunil (30), a native of Mainpuri in Uttar Pradesh’s Etah district, lying injured.

According to Devki’s statement, four to five unidentified youths approached them while they were sitting in the park. Police sources said the group allegedly began molesting the woman. When Sunil objected, an altercation broke out, following which one of the assailants



allegedly attacked both of them with a knife before the group fled the spot.

The injured were rushed to Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital, where doctors declared Sunil brought dead. Devki, who sustained serious injuries, was later referred to a higher medical centre for advanced treatment.

A senior doctor at the hospital said both victims had suffered multiple stab wounds. Sunil sustained four stab injuries: one on the face, two on the chest and one near the waist. Devki suffered two stab wounds: one on the upper back and another on the lower back.

“The woman has been referred to a higher centre because the stab wounds might have caused a lung injury,” the doctor said.

However, police said the exact sequence of events and the motive behind the attack are still being verified as part of the investigation.

A forensic team examined the crime scene and collected evidence. Investigators are scanning CCTV footage from the surrounding area to identify the remaining accused and reconstruct the sequence of events.

Meanwhile, Mandeep, a security guard at the park, said he rushed to the spot after hearing the woman’s cries for help. “I was on my round when I heard a woman shouting for help. I immediately reached the spot and saw two people lying on the ground. The woman was conscious, but the man was unconscious. I arranged an e-rickshaw and rushed them to a nearby hospital. I also informed the police,” he said.

Police have registered FIR under Section 103(1) (murder) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) at the Bharat Nagar police station. One juvenile has been apprehended, while the remaining accused are absconding. Multiple police teams have been constituted to identify and arrest them. Further investigation is underway.

Gujarat first to launch NEP-aligned digital progress card

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Gandhinagar

Gujarat has become the first State in India to introduce a digital Holistic Progress Card (HPC) aligned with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 in collaboration with NCERT’s PARAKH initiative.

Unlike the conventional marks-based report card, the new digital system will evaluate students through a comprehensive 360-degree framework covering academic performance, creativity, leadership, life skills, sports,



arts and social-emotional development.

The assessment model combines self-evaluation, peer review, parent feedback and teacher assessment, providing a broader picture of a student’s overall development and learning needs.

The Gujarat Secondary and Higher Secondary Education Board has developed the online platform in association with NCERT-PARAKH and the Samagra Shiksha programme, enabling schools to maintain digital student records.

Beginning in the 2026-27 academic year, the initiative will be introduced on a pilot basis in 10 per cent of Government, grant-in-aid and private secondary and higher secondary schools in every district before being expanded across the State in phases.

Training workshops for principals, district education officials and nodal officers were recently conducted in Surat, Gandhinagar, Ahmedabad and Rajkot to facilitate implementation of the new assessment framework.

Waris Punjab De marches to Mann’s residence over Amritpal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Chandigarh

Akali Dal Waris Punjab De supporters, seeking the release of jailed Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh and the Bandi Singhs (Sikh prisoners), clashed with Chandigarh Police on Wednesday after being stopped from a march to gherao the residence of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann.

Police resorted to water cannons to disperse party workers as a large number of them broke through police barricades at the Chandigarh-Mohali border. Tense situation prevailed as the protesters tried to force their way to Mann’s resi-

dence, prompting the authorities to deploy a heavy police force and station anti-riot vehicles near the chief minister’s house.

According to Chandigarh SSP Kanwardeep Kaur, some police jawans have sustained injuries, some of them grievous. Some protesters have been detained.

Earlier, Akali Dal Waris Punjab De had announced that it would gherao the Punjab chief minister’s residence to press for the release of Amritpal Singh and the Bandi Singhs, the Sikh prisoners convicted for being involved in militancy during the 1990s Punjab insurgency.

On Wednesday, a large number of



party workers carrying posters of Amritpal Singh and the Bandi Singhs, accompanied by Nihangs (Sikh warriors) wielding swords and other traditional weapons, marched from Gurdwara Amb Sahib in Mohali to Chandigarh. Amritpal Singh’s father

Tarsem Singh and prominent party leader Manpreet Singh Ayali were among the protesters, according to police.

In view of the march, Chandigarh Police had made heavy deployment of personnel and erected barricades at the Mohali-Chandigarh border near Burali Jail to stop the protesters from marching towards the Union Territory.

However, a large number of protesters tried to break through these barricades, forcing police to resort to water cannons in a bid to disperse. A clash ensued, in which several policemen were injured, according to the Chandigarh SSP.

Farmers breach barricades, march within 1km of Madhya Pradesh CM’s residence over MSP demand

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhopal

High drama unfolded in Bhopal on Wednesday as protesting farmers demanding procurement of the moong crop at the MSP broke through multiple police barricades and reached Roshanpura Square, barely a kilometre from Chief Minister Mohan Yadav’s official residence.

Before reaching Roshanpura, the protesters staged a demonstration outside Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan’s residence, even as the Madhya Pradesh Government opened talks with representatives of protesters. Led by the Samyukta Kisan Morcha and 18 other farmer organisations, the



marchers crossed several layers of barricades on Narmadapuram Road, triggering tense stand-offs with police.

Heavy security was deployed at Roshanpura Square, where the

protesters eventually camped while negotiations continued at the state secretariat.

Though there were repeated scuffles between farmers and police and windows of a few

buses were damaged, authorities refrained from using force.

The farmers are demanding procurement of the entire summer moong harvest at MSP, scrapping of the e-token system for fertiliser distribution, and timely availability of fertilisers ahead of the next sowing season. In a bid to defuse the crisis, Chief Minister Mohan Yadav announced a four-member committee to hold talks with farmer representatives. “The Government has always stood with farmers and is ready to consider positive suggestions. At the same time, both sides should ensure that the public doesn’t face inconvenience. We will resolve the issue through talks,” Yadav said. He expressed hope that the Bharatiya Kisan

Sangathan and other organisations would solve the issue through discussions, saying the Government’s commitment to public welfare also included farmers’ welfare.

Despite the Government’s outreach, some protesters intensified the agitation by staging a semi-nude demonstration on Narmadapuram Road. The protest also drew support from residents, including many members of Generation Z.

Adding a symbolic touch to the agitation, protesters performed a ‘Sadbuddhi Yagya’ and cooked baati-chokha on the roadside. The stir showed no signs of easing after the first round of talks between State Agriculture Minister Aidal Singh Kansana and farmer

leaders ended without a breakthrough on Tuesday night.

Farmers remained on the road overnight, causing massive traffic disruptions and forcing police to divert commuters. The protesters, marching towards the chief minister’s residence, were stopped near Veer Savarkar Setu on Tuesday night, while schools in the surrounding areas remained closed on Wednesday morning.

Meanwhile, Kansana wrote to Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan seeking an increase in the procurement limit for summer moong to ensure better returns for farmers.

Responding after protesters gathered outside his residence, Chouhan wrote to the chief minister, saying the Centre had

already approved procurement of up to 4,54,580 tons of summer moong for Madhya Pradesh under the Price Support Scheme for the 2025-26 season.

He stated this accounted for 87 per cent of the total 5,23,243 tons approved for procurement across the country under the PM-AASHA scheme, the highest allocation to any State. This letter is shared by a close aide of Chouhan with the media. Chouhan also clarified that the Centre does not prescribe procurement targets for states. Under the PM-AASHA guidelines, procurement is permitted up to 25 per cent of estimated production, and any procurement beyond that limit has to be undertaken by the State Government, he said.

Rahul demands Shah’s sacking over...

Pointing to a picture of Shah on the screen at the press conference, Rahul said to students, “This is the man who beat you, thrashed you, humiliated you and shot you with pellet guns. We will ensure that the students who were beaten get justice and people who shot students with pellet guns are punished,” he said. So it is our advice to the PM to sack Shah, he said. He also demanded a Supreme Court-monitored probe into the alleged police excesses.

Vande Mataram gets legal shield

The existing law provided punishment for intentionally preventing the singing of the national anthem Jana Gana Mana or causing disturbance to any assembly engaged in singing it. However, the law did not accord the same protection for the national song. “Presently, there is no specific legal provision to prevent insults to the singing of Vande Mataram, which is honoured as the national song. Therefore, in order to prohibit any person from intentionally preventing the singing of the national song or causing disturbance to any assembly engaged in such singing, it is proposed to amend Section 3 of the said Act to include the

national song also within its ambit, so as to make such acts punishable,” the Bill said.

The Opposition, led by the Congress, staged a walkout as Deputy Chairman Harivansh allowed the members to speak on the Bill after lunch, despite Opposition uproar and two back-to-back adjournments earlier in the day in the House. They were seeking a response from Union Minister of Home Affairs, Amit Shah over police action against those who had protested in the national Capital over NEET paper leak. When the Chair took up the discussion on the Bill in the post-lunch session, Opposition parties continued to protest.

In his reply to the bill, Union Minister of State for Home Affairs Nityanand Rai said the Congress is trying to insult the country’s honour -- its national song Vande Mataram — by resorting to appeasement politics. He mentioned several instances where Vande Mataram was used as the last words by many freedom fighters while sacrificing their lives for the country.

“One cannot understand the Congress’ opposition to Vande Mataram... The country’s youth are watching and the people of the country will teach them a lesson,” Rai said. He said Vande Mataram is needed for the promise of *Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat*.

“The Vande Mataram bill is not merely an ordinary bill but represents India’s soul, national awareness and cultural heritage and reminds

us of the freedom struggle,” Rai said.

Earlier this year, the Union Home Ministry directed that all six stanzas of Vande Mataram shall be sung first when the national song and the national anthem are played together.

In an order dated January 28, the home ministry gave the first set of protocols for singing the national song, directing that six stanzas of it, having a duration of 3 minutes and 10 seconds, shall be sung at official functions such as the arrival of the President, unfurling of the national flag, and speeches of governors.

FIRs over online posts targeting PM

Police stated that seven to eight X accounts have been named in one FIR and cases have been registered for criminal intimidation, circulating false information, rumours, or alarming news through electronic means, and defamation.

Notices issued by the IFSO under the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, direct X to disable access to several identified URLs.

One such notice, reviewed by *The Pioneer*, is titled “Intimation to Intermediary for Disabling Access to Unlawful Information” and cites Rule 3(1)(d) of the IT Rules, 2021, which states

that intermediaries are required to remove or restrict access to unlawful content within three hours of receiving actual knowledge and to preserve the relevant electronic records.

The notice states that Delhi Police has determined that identified URLs on X contained content allegedly prohibited by law. It references a specific X post and explains that the material under investigation was considered unlawful, prompting the takedown order.

It also references an FIR registered by the Special Cell under various BNS provisions, stating that the circulation of the content allegedly caused serious harm to the Prime Minister’s reputation, dignity, and public image, and had the potential to disturb public order and create unnecessary controversy, according to sources. Police sources reported that some posts under investigation were uploaded during and after the July 20 Sansad Chalo protest led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP).

A senior Delhi Police officer told *The Pioneer* that this action is part of routine monitoring and is not limited to content targeting the PM. “This is a routine process. Delhi Police continuously monitors social media platforms to identify and remove posts containing derogatory or defamatory content, fake news, deepfakes, or material that harms the integrity and reputation of individuals,” the officer said.

Investigators are currently working to identify the individuals operating the accounts,

assess the intent behind the posts, and analyze the digital evidence received from the platform. Police stated that further legal action will be based on the information provided by X and the results of the ongoing investigation.

Top Maoist, Misir Besra arrested in Jharkhand

Police records connect him to more than 140 cases in Jharkhand, Odisha, and West Bengal, including attacks on security forces, extortion, arms trafficking and other violence. He was arrested in 2007 but escaped in a dramatic incident in Bihar in 2009.

With Besra now in custody, security officials say the CPI (Maoist)’s central committee and politburo are now largely non-functional, showing a major loss of top leadership after years of arrests, killings, and surrenders. This arrest is expected to disrupt the remaining Maoist networks in eastern India’s Red Corridor and speed up efforts to make the area free of Naxal activity. As interrogation continues, officials are focused on getting actionable information to stop any remaining threats and encourage more surrenders. For communities in Jharkhand’s forested districts, which have faced Maoist violence for years, this is seen as a real step toward lasting safety and development.

₹4,500 crore approved to check untreated sewage flow into Yamuna

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a bid to check untreated sewage flows into the Yamuna river, the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) has approved projects worth ₹4,500 crore. The projects include 15 new Decentralised Sewage Treatment Plants (DSTPs), expansion of sewer networks, upgradation of existing sewage treatment plants, sludge management facilities, in-situ treatment of drains, and several others. According to Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, all 15 newly awarded DSTPs will be completed in 21-month.

With these approvals, the BJP will now have 28 Decentralised Sewage Treatment Plants under implementation, including 13 DSTPs approved earlier and 15 newly awarded projects, marking one of the most significant expansions of Delhi's sewage treatment infrastructure in recent years.

The 28 awarded DSTPs are expected to benefit around 20 lakh residents.

Addressing the media after the 179th Delhi Jal Board Meeting, Water Minister and Chairman of the Delhi Jal Board, Parvesh Sahib Singh, said the Government has adopted a comprehensive infrastructure-led approach to restore the Yamuna by addressing the problem at its source. "People often ask when the Yamuna will become clean. The answer lies in building the right infrastructure. Unless every drop of sewage is treated before it reaches our drains and eventually the Yamuna, the river cannot be restored. That is exactly what we are building today."

Delhi currently generates nearly 1,000 MGD (Million Gallons per Day) of sewage. When the present Government assumed office, the Capital's sewage treatment capacity stood at only 749 MGD, leaving a substan-



tial treatment gap.

Through the upgradation and rehabilitation of existing Sewage Treatment Plants (STPs), the Delhi Government has already increased this capacity to 814 MGD. With the completion of all 28 DSTPs, Delhi will add another 227 MGD of treatment capacity, taking the city's total sewage treatment capacity to 1,041 MGD- higher than the current volume of sewage generated

every day.

"For the first time, Delhi will have the capacity to treat more sewage than it generates. This is a historic milestone in our mission to clean the Yamuna and a major step towards building a sustainable sewerage system for Delhi."

The Minister said that while 13 DSTPs had already been approved, the Delhi Jal Board has now awarded 15 addi-

tional DSTPs with a combined treatment capacity of 103.5 MGD at an investment of nearly ₹2,000 crore.

These projects are expected to benefit around 20 lakh residents.

"There are still hundreds of colonies and villages where sewer lines either do not exist or remain incomplete. Without proper sewer connectivity, untreated wastewater ultimately flows into drains and then into the Yamuna. These projects address that problem at its source," he said.

Explaining the significance of decentralised treatment plants, Singh said DSTPs treat sewage close to where it is generated, reducing dependence on long sewer conveyance systems, improving operational efficiency and ensuring faster treatment.

The newly awarded 15 DSTPs form part of a larger sewer infrastructure programme that also includes the laying of 989 kilometres

of new sewer network and providing house sewer connections across 244 colonies and 57 villages. These projects, involving an investment of nearly ₹1,600 crore, will enable lakhs of households to connect directly to the sewerage network, preventing untreated sewage from entering drains and ultimately the Yamuna.

Existing STPs are being upgraded to increase their treatment capacity from 66 MGD to 86.8 MGD, while a new 35 MGD Sewage Treatment Plant is also being developed at a combined cost of ₹918 crore. To improve long-term sustainability, the Delhi Jal Board has also approved sludge management facilities at 10 existing STPs located at Coronation Pillar, Keshopur, Rithala, Narela and Rohini. The ₹274 crore project will ensure scientific treatment, safe disposal and productive utilisation of sludge generated during sewage treatment.

DJB TO TRACE 30 LAKH "ILLEGAL" WATER CONNECTIONS IN 6-MONTH E-KYC DRIVE

New Delhi: Delhi Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Wednesday said that in its bid to reduce revenue loss and strengthen its current billing systems, the Delhi Jal Board plans to trace 30 lakh "illegal" water connections which are currently not paying bills. The DJB has around 30 lakh customers, a figure significantly lower than the actual number of households. The DJB now plans to launch an electronic Know Your Customer (e-KYC) exercise, and trace and geo-tag these connections to reduce its non-revenue water (NRW). "The DJB has around 30 lakh customers, while there are around 60 lakh power connections; this means around 30 lakh people are drawing water illegally. There is a need to overhaul the billing system; there are other problems also," Singh said.

He said several people complain about not receiving bills for years and then suddenly they receive a big amount. "To change this, we plan to hire three companies which will carry out the customer verification exercise in the first phase and complete the E-KYC process in the next six months.

"We have also received several complaints of wrong billing. In the second phase, the companies will also take up the work of meter reading; after the process is done, the DJB will have complete data about all the water connections across the city," Singh further said. Currently, the DJB reports nearly 50-52 per cent NRW, meaning that more than half of the treated water does not generate revenue either due to leakages, theft or unbilled usage. (PNS)

St Stephen's College issues notice banning shorts, student groups call it attack on personal liberty

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Student organisations on Wednesday criticised Delhi University's St. Stephen's College over a newly issued campus dress code prohibiting students from wearing shorts in classrooms, laboratories and several common areas. They argued that the move amounted to "moral policing" and infringed upon students' personal liberty.

The criticism came after the college issued a notice, dated July 26, asking all junior members to adhere to campus regulations, including a ban on wearing shorts in classrooms, tutorials, laboratories, the chapel, assembly hall, library and dining hall. Principal Susan Elias's notice has sparked accusations of "moral policing".

The notice also reiterated that the college campus is a smoke-free zone, urged students to maintain cleanliness and directed them to carry valid identity cards at all times.

The ban itself was not completely new. St Stephen's had long discouraged the wearing of shorts in formal spaces.

"We received a notice from the college that stated how it was against the college's dress code rules to wear



shorts on campus. This is surprising because I don't think wearing shorts in summers can be against any dress code," says a first-year student on condition of anonymity.

Another one adds, "For me and my friends who have just came out of schools where we had a uniform, it feels we are going backwards. Once you are an adult and are in college, you do not expect that your expression in any form, even your dressing, will be curtailed. It just takes away from the whole experience of finally being out in the world and venture into the life of being a college student."

The National Students' Union of India (NSUI)

demanding that the college withdraw the dress code, calling it an attack on students' constitutional rights.

"The Constitution of India guarantees every citizen the freedom to decide what they wear, what they eat and what they say. The purpose of educational institutions is to nurture free thought and critical thinking, not to impose unnecessary restrictions on students' personal choices," NSUI National President Vinod Jakhar said in a statement.

Jakhar further alleged that attempts were being made to impose an ideological agenda on educational institutions and said universities should remain spaces for democratic dialogue, scientific temper and freedom of expression.

Referring to a statement made by Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi in Parliament, Jakhar claimed the dress code reflected what he described as a growing ideological influence over universities and colleges.

The NSUI demanded that the St. Stephen's administration immediately withdraw the notification, engage in dialogue with students and uphold their constitutional rights and personal liberty. The Krantikari Yuva Sangathan (KYS) also opposed the directive, saying it upheld the right to freedom of expression and that the college should refrain from "moral policing".

"It should be noted that the college administration has directed students not to wear shorts in specific academic and common areas, including the chapel, library, classrooms, dining hall and assembly hall. The college must refrain from moral policing and immediately withdraw the notification," the organisation said in a statement.

The July 26 notice, signed by Principal Susan Elias, states that junior members are required to "strictly adhere" to the campus regulations.

Police tighten security across Capital ahead of Kanwar Yatra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police stepped up security arrangements across the national Capital ahead of the annual Kanwar Yatra, deploying additional personnel, Quick Response Teams (QRTs), PCR vans and pickets at strategic locations to ensure the smooth and safe movement of Kanwariyas, officials said on Wednesday.

Senior police officers said elaborate security and traffic arrangements have been put in place across the city, particularly in north, northeast, east, central, outer north, outer, Rohini, Dwarka, west, southwest and south Delhi police districts that fall along the routes used by devotees entering the Capital from neighbouring states.

Police established camps along the Kanwar routes to provide immediate assistance to pilgrims whenever required.

"There are seven major entry points in northeast Delhi through which Kanwariyas enter the city. These routes also connect to several other districts, making them critical from both the security and traffic management perspectives. Adequate deployment has



been made at all these locations," a senior police officer said.

To ensure seamless movement of devotees, Delhi Police has also held coordination meetings with police forces in neighbouring states. Officials said personnel have been instructed to extend assistance irrespective of jurisdictional boundaries in case of emergencies.

"Our teams will not restrict themselves to jurisdictional issues. If assistance is required anywhere along the route, police personnel will respond immediately and coordinate with the concerned district," the officer said.

Apart from security measures, Delhi Traffic Police has prepared an extensive traffic management plan aimed at reducing inconvenience

to commuters while ensuring uninterrupted passage for Kanwar pilgrims. Traffic personnel have been deployed at major intersections and diversion points, and motorists have been advised to follow traffic advisories and use alternate routes wherever necessary.

On Wednesday, senior officers of the Delhi Traffic Police inspected arrangements at Ghazipur's Telco Point and Chintamani Chowk in Shahdara district, where they reviewed traffic management measures and interacted with the personnel deployed on the ground. Police also said all fire stations across the national Capital have been directed to remain on alert to respond promptly to any emergency during the pilgrimage.

Delhi Police refute claims of gunshot injury to woman protester



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police on Wednesday dismissed social media claims that a woman protester sustained a gunshot injury during the July 20 protest in central Delhi, saying her official medico-legal certificate (MLC) does not support the allegation.

In a statement, the police said the MLC prepared at Dr Ram Manohar Lohia (RML) Hospital on the day of the protest records a lacerated wound in front of the right tragus, with the nature of the injury described as blunt. According to the doctor's opinion, the injury was simple and there was no evidence of a gunshot wound.

"The claim of gunshot injury is not supported by the medical findings on the MLC," the statement said, urging the public to verify information through authentic sources before sharing such claims on social media.

Police said the woman visited RML Hospital on July 20, where doctors examined her and prepared the MLC. The official medical document, they said, recorded only a blunt-force injury and made no mention of any firearm-related wound.

Explaining the document's significance, a senior police officer said an MLC is a medico-legal certificate prepared by doctors and shared with the police, forming the basis for further legal action in criminal cases. Police sources further claimed that after leaving RML Hospital, the woman approached a private hospital in Gurugram, where another medical document was prepared.

Describing the allegations circulating online as "baseless," Delhi Police maintained that the original MLC from RML Hospital clearly documented a simple blunt injury near the woman's right ear and did not indicate any gunshot injury

LG, CM set mid-August deadline to complete deregulation reforms

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday jointly reviewed the progress of Delhi's Deregulation and Compliance Reduction exercise. They directed all agencies and departments to complete all pending reforms by mid-August, while being informed that the Delhi Ease of Doing Business Bill, 2026, has been finalised and is expected to be cleared by the Cabinet within a week.

The review meeting, chaired by the LG, was attended by the Chief Minister, Ministers Ashish Sood and Manjinder Singh Sirsa, the Special Secretary from the Cabinet Secretariat of the Government of India who

is spearheading the exercise, the Chief Secretary of Delhi, ACS Industries, MCD Commissioner, DDA Vice Chairman, Principal Secretary Law, Secretary Education, Divisional Commissioner, Secretary Health, and senior representatives from Fire Services, Tourism, and other departments. The previous such review had been held on June 15, 2026.

The deregulation exercise is being spearheaded by the Cabinet Secretariat of the Government of India under the Prime Minister's vision of Ease of Doing Business and Ease of Living. Phase-I, launched in January 2025, covered 23 Priority Areas. Phase-II, launched in January 2026, covers 23 Priority Areas and five optional ones.



On Phase-I, the meeting was informed that 13 Priority Areas have been implemented, four were found not applicable following the enactment of the new Labour Codes, and the remaining six are under advanced stages of implementation. These six

cover flexible zoning norms, rationalisation of building regulations, and enhanced roles for empanelled third parties in building approvals. They are tied to the notification of the new Master Plan for Delhi and the approval of the new Urban Building Bye-

Laws 2026 by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

On Phase-II, implemented Priority Areas have risen from three at the time of the last review to nine, including the removal of dual trade licences by MCD, liberalised regulations for shops and commercial

establishments, and expedited electricity connections. Seventeen Priority Areas remain under active implementation across MCD, DDA, Fire, Health, Education, and Industries departments. The number of Priority Areas still pending with departments has been reduced from three to two.

The Delhi Ease of Doing Business Bill, 2026, which addresses 13 of the 28 Priority Areas under Phase-II, has been circulated to 29 departments for comments and stakeholder consultations. It has now acquired final shape and is expected to go to the Cabinet within a week.

Draft bills related to easing requirements in the education sector and adding a Right to Appeal under the Right to Services Act have

also been finalised and are expected to be placed before the forthcoming session of the Legislative Assembly.

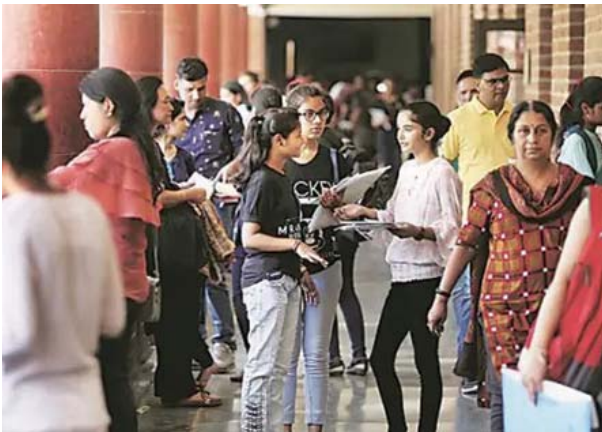
Several pending reforms covering setbacks, Floor Area Ratio, ground coverage, and Development Control Norms for industrial and commercial plots, along with the removal of jurisdictional ambiguity over land use, are contingent on the notification of the Master Plan for Delhi 2041, which is at an advanced stage of finalisation. The LG said any laxity in implementing the Ease of Doing Business and Ease of Living agenda is non-negotiable. The CM noted that significant progress had been made since the present Government took over, despite delays caused by the previous Government's approach.

Day two at Delhi University: Freshers begin finding their place on campus

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
■ New Delhi

On Tuesday, they arrived with their parents and their paperwork. Today they came alone, with a slightly better sense of where things are and a slightly worse sense of what to do next. The second day at Delhi University's North Campus has that particular quality: the family has gone home, the WhatsApp groups are still chaotic, and the actual business of becoming a DU student has quietly, irreversibly begun.

The benches outside Hindu College's main building were full by 9.30 am. A boy from Muzaffarpur sat with a notebook he had not opened yet,



watching older students walk past with the specific confidence of people who know which chai stall serves the better cup. He did not know

yet. He would find out.

His name is Rohit. He is studying Political Science. He got through in the second round of CSAS after spending

two weeks certain he had missed his chance.

"When the first list came, my name was not there. I didn't tell my parents. I just kept refreshing the portal," he said. "When the second list came, I called home and cried. I don't think I even heard what my mother said. I just knew I was in." He came to Delhi three days ago. He has not slept well. He finds the city too loud at night. "At home it is quiet by 9 pm. Here there is noise at 2 am. I don't know what people are doing, but they are doing it loudly," he said, smiling in a way that suggested he would get used to it.

Across the gate, near Miranda House, a group of

four girls sat on the steps sharing one umbrella and two packets of biscuits. They had met yesterday during orientation and discovered they were all from different states. One from Nagpur, one from Lucknow, one from Siliguri, one from Jaipur. They had already decided to find a room together if possible.

Priyanka, from Siliguri, said she had never lived this far from home. "My mother called me six times yesterday. I told her I was fine each time. I was not fine each time," she said. "But today is better. Yesterday I didn't know anyone. Today I know three people."

Outside the Kirori Mal College canteen, the line for

tea stretched to the corridor. A boy from Meerut explained the queue to two freshers who had been standing in the wrong place for ten minutes. He graduated last year. He was back on campus to meet a professor. "This campus pulls you back," he said simply.

In the reading room of the central library, a girl from Ranchi sat with three textbooks she had bought the previous evening from the stalls near the campus. She had not started any of them. She was reading a novel. "I have my whole degree for the textbooks," she said. "Today I just want to sit in a library. I have always wanted to sit in this library."

States Focus



TN CM VIJAY TAKES METRO RIDE, INSPECTS ONGOING RAIL WORKS

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Wednesday travelled by Metro train and reviewed the operations of the CMRL at its headquarters in Nandanam, officials said. He travelled from Omandurar Metro station to Nandanam in the afternoon, accompanied by State minister for Finance, Planning and Development N Marie Wilson and senior Chennai Metro Rail Limited officials. The CM purchased a ticket for the journey and interacted with commuters, many of whom took selfies with him.

Later, he inspected the ongoing Metro Rail works in Guindy and discussed the progress of various projects with officials, sources said. He subsequently travelled by Metro from Porur to Poonamallee, taking a window seat, and inspected the construction work at Kathipara. (PTI)



OVER 150 ROADS CLOSED IN HIMACHAL, ORANGE ALERT ISSUED

As many as 152 roads across Himachal Pradesh are closed for traffic due to landslides and flashfloods triggered by torrential rains, even as persistent, heavy showers lashed parts of the state on Wednesday.

According to the State emergency operation centre (SEOC), the maximum number of road closures have been reported from Mandi district with 57 roads blocked, followed by 33 in Chamba, 31 in Kullu, 14 in Shimla, two in Una and one in Lahaul-Spiti. Additionally, 68 water supply projects and 72 power transformers have been hit. Moderate to heavy rainfall was witnessed in most parts in the 24 hours since Tuesday evening, with Palampur recording 133-mm rainfall. (PTI)

In RS, Nadda defends Delhi Police action at CPI(M) office

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Minister JP Nadda on Wednesday in the Rajya Sabha described the police swoop on Communist Party of India (Marxist)'s office in Delhi on Tuesday as a "normal law and order situation" and accused the opposition of "politicising and sensationalising" the police action.

The minister made the assertion when CPM Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas raised the issue of police raid at the party office in the House. Supporting him, Leader of Opposition Mallikarjun Kharge said democracy was under threat.

A Delhi Police team on Tuesday allegedly attempted to take CPM Student Wing SFI's Delhi Secretary and former JNU Students' Union president Aishe Ghosh into custody from party's AKG Bhavan office in an older case. The police action led to argument between the police and



Union Health Minister JP Nadda speaks in the Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon session of Parliament in New Delhi on Wednesday

the CPM leaders after which the police team left AKG Bhavan without Aishe Ghosh.

"It was a very normal law and order situation that we have to understand. Police acted to maintain the order," Nadda said in the Rajya Sabha, adding that "any student who is into activism will have to face such a situation."

The Union Minister then went to draw an Emergency parallel and gave example of how he too was arrested several times when he was a student activist. "I have been a student activist and I was arrested several times from

the classroom during the Emergency under Congress rule," he pointed out. Nadda asserted that the "police acted according to the law and order situation" and opposition should not politicise it.

"The Opposition is trying to sensationalise and politicise a law and order activity by the policy," Nadda said.

Raising the issue, Brittas said a Delhi Police team, in plain clothes, entered the party office to arrest Ghosh in the 2021 protest case in JNU. He sought to relate the police action to the recent students' protest, saying

Ghosh's only mistake was that she participated in the Jantar Mantar protest.

The CPM claimed that the police is using an old case to take action against a student leader after her involvement in the recent protests.

The Upper House witnessed several adjournments as the Opposition pressed for Home Minister Amit Shah's presence in the House. This was the second time the Upper House of Parliament was adjourned on Wednesday. The first adjournment came around 20 minutes into the Zero Hour.

As the Rajya Sabha met for the Question Hour at noon, Congress MP Renuka Chowdhury questioned about the home minister, and was joined by other Opposition leaders in demanding his presence in the House. Slogans were also raised demanding Shah to come to the House. Following this, Chairman CP Radhakrishnan adjourned the House till 2 pm.

3 killed, over 2 lakh affected in Odisha flood

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhubaneswar

Three people, including a fire service personnel, died and more than 2 lakh people were affected as the flood situation remained grim in Odisha on Wednesday, with swollen rivers marooning six northern districts, officials said.

Revenue and Disaster Management Minister Suresh Pujari said the three deaths were reported from Keonjhar district, which has been comparatively less affected than the worst-hit Balasore, Bhadrak and Jajpur.

A fire service personnel died of electrocution while on duty, an elderly man was



killed in a wall collapse, and a child's body was found floating in the floodwaters, he said after reviewing the flood situation.

"There has been no report of any human or animal casualty from the worst flood-affected districts of Balasore, Bhadrak and Jajpur. We have apprised the chief minister about the deaths reported

from his native district of Keonjhar," he added.

Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi said he was closely monitoring the flood situation, appealing to people not to panic.

"The life and safety of every citizen is of utmost importance to us. My government and I are closely monitoring the situation arising out of incessant rains and floods. I have discussed the situation with the chief secretary and the special relief commissioner and directed the entire administration to ensure the safety of people in the affected areas," he said in a social media post.

The CM also condoled the death of fire service person-

nel Chandan Pattnaik.

Director General of Fire Services Sudhansu Sarangi said Pattnaik died of electrocution while pumping out water from a waterlogged area. He said Fire Services personnel rescued 212 people from marooned villages during the last 24 hours.

Pujari said six districts — Balasore, Bhadrak, Jajpur, Mayurbhanj, Sambalpur and Dhenkanal — have been severely affected by the floods.

Besides these, Keonjhar, Sundargarh, Jharsuguda, Bargarh, Nuapada, Kalahandi, Rayagada and Gajapati have also witnessed flooding following heavy rain triggered by a deep depression.

Cooperation ministry infused new energy in sector: Shah

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Jamnagar (Gujarat)

The country's cooperative movement received new vigour and momentum after the Narendra Modi-led Government established a separate ministry for the sector, Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah has said.

He was speaking after virtually inaugurating 'Sahakar Bhavan', the newly constructed headquarters of Jamnagar District Cooperative Bank here on Tuesday. Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel was present on the occasion.

Modernisation is essential for strengthening the cooperative system, and this process begins with modernising the headquarters and functioning of the cooperative institutions, Shah noted.

"Under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Government of India established a separate



Ministry of Cooperation and infused new energy and momentum into the country's cooperative movement," he said.

The Centre set up a separate Ministry of Cooperation in 2021. The ministry provides a separate administrative, legal and policy framework to strengthen the cooperative movement in the country.

Shah emphasised that initiatives, such as establishing more than two lakh new primary agricultural credit societies (PACS) and

No bullets fired on protesters: MoS Jitendra Singh claims in LS



MoS Jitendra Singh speaks in Lok Sabha during the Monsoon session of Parliament on Wednesday

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union minister Jitendra Singh on Wednesday said in Lok Sabha that no bullet was fired on students protesting in the national capital against the NEET fiasco as he dismissed Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's allegations that Union Home Minister Amit Shah had ordered firing on students.

Replying to the debate on the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, the minister for state for PMO said the authority to issue an order for firing rests with the magistrate, not with a minister, and Gandhi lacked experience in public life and hence has levelled such allegations.

He said Gandhi alleged that the home minister has ordered firing on protesters in Delhi but was not able to authenticate that allegation.

"The first and fundamental point is he should know that when no shots were fired in the first place, the question of giving an order does not arise at all. (*Jab goli chali hee nahi, toh aadash dena ka sawal hee paida nahi hota*)," Singh said, dismissing the allegations levelled by the leader of opposition in Lok Sabha.

He said the authority to issue such an order rests with the magistrate, not with a minister.

"No bullet was fired, only tear gas was used," Singh

said, strongly defending Shah.

On Gandhi's allegations that Shah's cavalcade has 30 vehicles, Singh again rejected the suggestion and took a dig at him, saying the leader of the opposition does not even know the count.

On Gandhi's remarks that the home minister had gone on foreign travel, the minister said Gandhi should know that Shah has never visited a foreign country.

"So without facts, and without a sense of responsibility, saying something in the House and then leaving the House, cannot be the behaviour of a responsible leader of the opposition," he said.

Earlier, Gandhi alleged that Shah had authorised police excesses against student protesters, triggering a massive uproar in Lok Sabha during the debate on the bill.

"The home minister is not here today because he is scared," Gandhi said, drawing objections from the treasury benches.

The home minister "authorised" violent action against students, the Congress leader alleged, referring to the crackdown by security forces during the march to Parliament on July 20 during the CJP-led protest on the NEET paper leak issue.

Speaker Om Birla immediately intervened, saying the discussion was not on the Home Minister.

MP forms panel to hold dialogue with agitating farmers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhopal

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Wednesday said a committee comprising ministers has been formed to hold talks with the farmers agitating here over various demands, including 100 per cent moong procurement at MSP, and expressed confidence of finding a solution.

A large number of farmers congregated in state capital Bhopal on Tuesday and launched a protest, which continued overnight. The agitation disrupted traffic on busy Narmadapuram highway. Raising anti-government slogans, the agitating farmers had reached Budhni in Sehore late Monday evening before arriving in Bhopal on Tuesday.



Maharashtra FDA bans sale of junk food within 50 metres of schools

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Maharashtra FDA has banned the sale of processed and packaged foods and drinks high in fat, sugar and salt within 50 metres of school compounds, and the order will be implemented strictly, FDA commissioner Tukaram Mundhe said on Wednesday.

He said every school kitchen operator and food supplier to schools should have licenses under food safety regulations.

He said the sale, advertisement and free distribution of high-fat, salt and sugar (HFSS) food items are prohibited in and around all schools in the state as part of efforts to promote healthy eating habits among children.

"Within school premises and up to 50 metres from the school compound, the sale, advertisement and free distribution of high fat, salt and sugar (HFSS) food items is completely banned by the FDA. It will be implemented strictly," Mundhe told reporters.



He said the State Government had issued a compliance order on July 27 to enforce food safety and nutritional standards across educational institutions, adding that the move would affect nearly two crore students studying in around 1.08 lakh schools in Maharashtra.

Mundhe said the guidelines would apply to all Government, Government-aided and private schools affiliated to any education board, and no institution would be exempt from the provisions.

He said canteens, midday meal kitchens, food suppliers and hostel kitchens catering to schools must obtain mandatory registration and

licences under food safety regulations.

"No organisation or institution can prepare or supply food to schools, hostels or under the midday meal scheme without registration and a valid licence to operate," Mundhe added.

He said school principals, headmasters and local authorities would play a key role in implementing the restrictions.

According to Mundhe, the norms will cover children from 22 months of age up to students studying in Class 12, and HFSS food items could neither be sold, advertised nor distributed free of cost within the prescribed limits around schools.

Satpura centre in MP rewilds 25 tigers in 10 years

GIRISH SHARMA
■ Bhopal

Nestled deep inside the forests of the Satpura Tiger Reserve, a quiet conservation effort has emerged as one of India's most remarkable wildlife success stories. Over the past decade, the Churna-Mallupani Rewilding Centre has successfully prepared and released 25 tigers back into their natural habitat, demonstrating how science-led rehabilitation can help restore wild populations while reducing human intervention.

Established in 2017, the rewilding centre was created to rehabilitate orphaned tiger cubs or animals rescued from difficult circumstances that would otherwise struggle to survive in the wild. Instead of remaining in captivity for life, these tigers undergo a carefully designed

programme that equips them with the instincts and skills needed to live independently in the forest.

The rehabilitation process closely replicates natural conditions. Cubs are housed in large, secluded forest enclosures where human contact is kept to an absolute minimum. Their health is monitored round the clock using CCTV cameras, camera traps and regular veterinary supervision, but direct interaction with caretakers is deliberately restricted to prevent the animals from becoming accustomed to people.

A key part of the programme is teaching the tigers to hunt. Live prey such as deer and wild boar are introduced into the enclosures, allowing the animals to develop essential stalking, chasing and killing skills. As



the tigers mature, they gradually learn to survive on their own, just as they would in the wild.

Wildlife experts say the approach has delivered impressive results. Over the last 10 years, 25 rehabilitated

tigers and leopards have been successfully released into forests after completing the programme. Their movements are continuously tracked using radio collars and other monitoring techniques to ensure they adapt well to their natural

surroundings and avoid conflict with humans.

The Satpura Tiger Reserve has become a model for wildlife rehabilitation, attracting attention from conservationists across the country. Forest officials believe the

centre has played a significant role in strengthening tiger conservation by giving orphaned cubs and rescued animals a realistic opportunity to return to the wild rather than spending their lives in captivity.

As India marks International Tiger Day, the success of the Churna-Mallupani Rewilding Centre stands as a powerful example of how scientific management, patient rehabilitation and long-term monitoring can contribute to the conservation of one of the world's most iconic big cats. By restoring the natural instincts of rescued tigers and returning them to the forests where they belong, the initiative has given dozens of animals a new lease of life while reinforcing Madhya Pradesh's reputation as a leader in tiger conservation.

MADHYA PRADESH BUILDING DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD.
(Govt. of MP Undertaking)
16-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal-462011 (MP)
No. 6609/MPBDC/HR/2025 (Phase-15) Bhopal, Date : 29.07.2026

RECRUITMENT NOTICE/ADVERTISEMENT

Madhya Pradesh Building Development Corporation Ltd. (MPBDC) is a wholly government-owned company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013, with its registered office at 16-A, Arera Hills, Bhopal. To meet its manpower requirements, MPBDC invites applications for the following position from eligible candidates:

1. Assistant General Manager (Architect) (UR-01) - on Deputation/Contract

Interested candidates for the above post should submit their applications through the proper channel, in accordance with the provisions of the Rule Book available on the MPBDC portal <https://mpbdc.mp.gov.in>

CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (HR & ADMIN.)
M.P. Madhyam/127250/2026



Editor's
TAKE

PoK's bloody ballot: Elections without trust

The PoK elections, tainted by deadly violence and dismissed by India as a 'cosmetic', have exposed the deepening crisis Islamabad can no longer mask

The recent spate of violence in Pakistan Occupied Kashmir is neither new nor unjustified. There have been genuine issues of the people there which largely remain unaddressed by the Pakistani regime in Islamabad. These grievances get amplified when the elections which are largely sham take place in the valley. The elections take place in the region just to showcase the world that the region is democratically governed though it is firmly controlled from Islamabad. Even the elections are not fair. Reports of widespread protests, electoral manipulation, security force crackdowns on civilians are enough to prove that the democratic institutions in PoK remain weak and a facade for an autocratic rule. India has consistently maintained that the entire region of Jammu and Kashmir, including PoK, is an integral part of India. New Delhi has rejected the elections, describing them as a "cosmetic electoral exercise" designed to create the illusion of legitimacy over territory that it considers illegally occupied by Pakistan. This is the long held Indian position. The poll violence and people's resentment only proves India's point. The protests that PoK has been witnessing are not just about the election process alone. For nearly three years, residents have voiced grievances over rising electricity tariffs despite the region producing hydropower, inflation, unemployment, inadequate public services, and excessive interference by Pakistan's military establishment. One of the major flashpoints has been the controversy over reserved "refugee" seats in the PoK Assembly, which dilute the political voice of residents. These longstanding economic and political frustrations have now converged with electoral discontent.

Conducting periodic elections cannot compensate for the absence of genuine political autonomy. What does this mean for the future of PoK? The region is unlikely to witness lasting stability unless local institutions are repaired and people's grievances are addressed. Political legitimacy cannot be manufactured through elections conducted amid widespread allegations of intimidation and violence. For India, the developments present both an opportunity and a responsibility. New Delhi should continue to expose human rights concerns and governance failures in PoK through diplomatic channels while avoiding rhetoric that could unnecessarily escalate military tensions. India's strongest argument lies not merely in its constitutional claim but in demonstrating democratic governance, economic development, and institutional stability in the Union Territories of Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh. A prosperous, peaceful and inclusive Indian Kashmir remains the most persuasive counter-narrative to Pakistan's claims. Ultimately, the future of PoK will not be determined by sham elections. It will depend on whether the people of the region are allowed genuine political participation, economic opportunity and the freedom to express dissent without fear.

India's education system needs its next leap

As the National Education Policy 2020 enters its sixth year, India faces a defining question: can it move beyond political contestation and build an education system that truly fulfils the Constitution's vision of equitable, high-quality learning for every child?



JS RAJPUT

Independent India, born amidst the trauma of Partition, began its journey with a population of nearly 340 million and a literacy rate of barely 12 per cent. Within two years of Independence, the Constitution placed before the nation an extraordinarily ambitious educational mandate. Article 45 of the Directive Principles of State Policy declared: "The State shall endeavour to provide, within a period of ten years from the commencement of this Constitution, free and compulsory education for all children until they complete the age of fourteen years."

Although this constitutional goal could not be achieved within the prescribed decade, its inspirational force has shaped India's educational journey. Today, despite the addition of more than one billion people to the population, India's literacy rate has risen to nearly 81 per cent. This remarkable transformation reflects the enduring commitment of successive governments, educators, and society at large to expand educational opportunities. The framers of the Constitution clearly recognised that education would be the principal instrument for nation-building. It had to embrace India's extraordinary diversity while nurturing a deep appreciation of its underlying unity. Emerging from the bitterness and human tragedy of Partition, India needed an education system capable of healing divisions, strengthening democratic values, and preparing future generations for rapid social, scientific, and economic change.

Fortunately, the nation benefited from visionary scholars, scientists, and statesmen who undertook a comprehensive review of existing educational structures and formulated forward-looking policies. Their recommendations received the support of political leadership that understood education as the foundation of national development. During the first two decades after Independence, three landmark commissions laid the intellectual foundations of modern Indian education: the University Education Commission (1948-49) under S Radhakrishnan, the Secondary Education Commission (1952-53) chaired by A Lakshmanaswami Mudaliar, and the Education Commission (1964-66), popularly known as the Kothari Commission, led by D S Kothari. Their reports continue to influence educational thinking even today India formulated its first three comprehensive education policies in 1968, 1986 and 1992, and each one of these has stood India in good stead. The 1968 policy prescribed a common core-curriculum to be studied by both boys and girls.

It may appear a fairy tale to young persons of today that till then, girls were given the options



ONE MAJOR ISSUE THAT DESERVES SERIOUS ATTENTION OF THE NATION IS THE FAST-INCREASING DIVIDE BETWEEN THE SARKARI SCHOOLS AND THE MUCH-SOUGHT AFTER PRIVATE SCHOOLS. GRADUALLY, MOST OF THE SARKARI SCHOOLS HAVE LOST THEIR ACCEPTABILITY, AND ARE NOW PATRONISED ONLY BY THOSE UNABLE TO AFFORD A PRIVATE SCHOOL

The writer is an educationist, a Padma Shri awardee, and works in the fields of religious amity and social cohesion

to quit science and maths, and opt for to home science, spinning weaving, arts and crafts etc., as science and maths were perceived too tough for the girls. Today, more girls qualify in the much-sought after NEET competition than boys. This is an achievement that deserves a grand national celebration. The nation must be grateful to the eminent physicist and spiritually-endowed educationist DS Kothari.

The May 2026 NEET exam paper leak was a great systemic failure. It hurt the conscience of the nation. The re-examination was conducted without any blemish. The culprits have been identified and the prime minister has assured strict action in the matter. Instead of creating a national consensus on how to make such exams leak-free, the attempts are being made to politicise it. There are daunting challenges before the education system, and these need to be paid far greater attention by all concerned. The NEET paper leak inflicted shame on the system, and created tragic instances of suicides. Everyone was apprehensive on whether the re-examination could also be compromised! It was successfully completed. The right query should have been: why the machinery was so careless the first time? The academics and scholars free from ideological constraints should have analysed the situation, brought out a plan of action for the government to consider and implement it in all sincerity. The government could have called a meeting of the Central Advisory Board on Education: CABE; obtained its inputs and presented to the nation the outlines of risk-free examination system. CABE could come out with instructions on issues like teacher preparation and recruitment, curriculum concerns, center-state relationships, the issues of leadership, and much more. One wishes the concerned organizations seriously plan for the future, devise action plans, and ensure that unscrupulous and uncommitted are dexterously kept miles away from the hierarchy created for the conduct of the exams One wishes that the elected representatives of the people realize their obligation to deliberate upon educational issues over and above the party lines.

Unfortunately, this is not happening. One wonders whether some senior and seasoned

parliamentarians could come together, converge into an informal yet effective Think Tank on Education. They could seriously scrutinize the implementation of the National Education Policy; the NEP-2020. It could be pointed out that this is the task of the Standing Committee of Parliamentarians, so why suggest another creation? What is being suggested is a self-motivated group that could think on educational improvements as their social, cultural and moral responsibility. They would be guided by their inner conscience, not by any ideology or politics. One is convinced this a pragmatic suggestion. The NEP-2020 was launched six-years ago in July 2020. Numerous deliberations and unprecedented consultations with the stake holders clearly established the need for overhauling the education structure in full, 'including its regulation and governance, to create a new system that is aligned with the aspirational goals of 21st century education'. India has reiterated its commitment to the SDG-4: "ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all". To this the policy adds a very significant rider: "...while building upon India's traditions and value systems". It would be evident to every alert and active person that it fully resonates with the spirit of education for all promised by the Constitution of India. Are we really true inheritors to it?

One major issue that deserves serious attention of the nation is the fast-increasing divide between the Sarkari Schools and the much-sought after private schools. Gradually, most of the Sarkari Schools have lost their acceptability, and are now patronised only by those unable to afford a private school. In practice language learning and the rush for English medium schools remain unresolved. The conditions of teacher education institutions are indeed precarious. While paper leak is a shame, commercialization of teacher education, and also school education just can't be tolerated for long. Quality and excellence in educational attainments must receive requisite attention, and resources. The decision makers, and their opponents must realise it. There is no alternative to a respectful dialogical intent and initiative at the national level. Having observed the education system both at the implementation level as also at the policy formulation level for over six-decades, one simply rues he inability of my generation to adhere to the real spirits clearly contained in the Constitution: socio-economic or cultural background of the learner should never hander his education at any stage.

Jane Jacques Rousseau wrote in his immortal treatise on education, 'Emile': "How could I become wicked, when I had nothing but examples of gentleness before my eyes, and none around me but the best people in the world." India's young persons deserve such an environment. Let those who represent the will of the people of India realise their responsibility, and give them an environment they deserve.

PIC TALK



Women offer prayers in the Ganga river on the occasion of 'Guru Purnima' festival, in Patna, Bihar. PHOTO: PTI

The invisible energy that powers our lives



RAJYOGI
BRAHMA
KUMAR
NIKUNJ JI

2ND OPINION

As children, many of us played with magnets and discovered the quantum-electric fact that the magnetic positive poles repel each other, as do negative poles, while the positive and negative poles strongly attract each other. This attraction-repulsion phenomenon of electromagnetism is what makes the generation and usage of electricity practical in so many ways. Interestingly, the properties of electrical energy compare amazingly well with those of spiritual energy or the soul.

There are several interesting parallels between the two. A soul manifests its energy as the mind, intellect and sankars (latent tendencies). Thought is an energy created by the soul, which is transmitted by the brain in the form of an electric impulse. Studies of human psychology confirm the role of electrons in neural messaging. Just



pause and think: every time a thought is born in our mind, an invisible current begins to move.

So, if the thought is positive, the current feels warm, radiant and uplifting; but if it is negative, the same current feels heavy and draining. Our body, being a sensitive instrument, immediately registers this shift. That is why, after a few minutes of anger or anxiety, one feels physically tired even without any exertion. In this case, energy is never lost, but it simply changes form depending on the quality of our inner state.

There are certain things that are good conductors of electricity, while some other things are bad conductors. The quality of our inner connections, like the company we keep, the information we consume throughout the day and the conversations we indulge in, also determines whether we act as good conduc-

tors of divine energy or poor ones.

When we associate with souls who radiate positivity, we naturally absorb their vibrations, just as a wire absorbs current from a live source. But when we surround ourselves with gossip, anger or materialistic influence, our inner wiring gets corroded. This corrosion is not visible like rust, yet it quietly weakens our moral and emotional strength. Hence, spiritual hygiene is as important as physical hygiene. Regular introspection and remembrance of the Supreme act as cleansing agents of the soul. Just as solar panels absorb sunlight and convert it into usable electricity, meditation helps the soul absorb the divine rays of peace and love.

The more regularly we connect, the more charged we remain. The beauty of this connection is that the more you share the energy, the stronger the current becomes. Unlike physical energy, spiritual energy multiplies with giving. A kind word, a calm presence or a silent blessing instantly radiates vibrations that travel farther than we imagine.

Lastly, all electrical products and sources carry a note of caution for the safety of users. Similarly, to avoid shock, fuse, short circuit or tripping in life, use your mind with caution. For smooth operation and troubleshooting, carefully follow the manual of spiritual wisdom and avail yourself of the consumer support services of the Almighty, who is the most stable and eternal source of power.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a columnist

STRONGER LAWS NEEDED TO COMBAT RISING CYBERCRIME THREATS

The Supreme Court's call for recognising digital arrests as a separate criminal offence is a timely and necessary intervention against a rapidly growing form of cybercrime. Fraudsters impersonating police officers, investigating agencies and other public authorities have been exploiting fear to extort money and obtain sensitive personal information from unsuspecting citizens. A distinct legal provision, supported by stringent punishment, will strengthen deterrence, improve investigation and ensure more effective prosecution. Equally important is the Union government's proposed legislation to tackle deepfakes, which are increasingly being used to spread misinformation, commit fraud and damage individual reputations. However, legislation alone cannot eliminate these crimes. Continuous public

awareness campaigns and digital literacy programmes are essential to help citizens recognise suspicious calls, messages and online content before falling victim to fraud. Prompt and accessible reporting mechanisms are equally important so that victims can seek assistance without delay.

Better coordination among law enforcement agencies, financial institutions, digital platforms and other stakeholders can also help identify offenders and prevent the movement of fraudulently obtained funds. A comprehensive legal and institutional response will not only protect citizens from evolving cyber threats but also reinforce public confidence in India's rapidly expanding digital ecosystem. Strong laws must therefore be accompanied by awareness, preparedness and effective enforcement.

AC VINEETH KUMAR | KERALA

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

Making the right moves in the right direction

Mumbai's local trains are the lifeline of its people, carrying millions of passengers across the bustling metropolis every day. Navigating this massive network during peak hours, however, can be overwhelming, especially for commuters unsure of where to board or transfer.

To ease this daily chaos, a dedicated Good Samaritan stands on the Dadar Western Line bridge every weekday. For two consecutive hours, he selflessly guides lost passengers to ensure they reach their destinations safely and on time. Dadar is one of the most crowded stations in Mumbai, where people from all walks of life can be seen.

This unsung hero, Narendra Patil, volunteers his time entirely by choice to keep travellers from losing their way. Patil performs this noble act with a warm smile, actively directing and comforting anxious commuters. He stands at the same spot between 9.30 am and 11.30 am, offering directions and clarity and making sure everyone gets to their destination without trouble or delay.

His knowledge and simple explanations help commuters reach their destinations without difficulty. It is a valuable courtesy service in this busy part of Mumbai.

CK SUBRAMANIAM | NAVI MUMBAI

AI must reward human intelligencee

This has reference to the thought-provoking Editorial, 'The Human Firewall Against AI Exploitation' (July 29), which shifts the AI debate from technological capability to the equally vital questions of workers' rights, dignity and the ethics of sharing AI's economic gains.

However, India must view this challenge through a wider socio-economic lens. Post-COVID disruptions, geopolitical conflicts and now AI-driven automation are creating a prolonged era of job insecurity. India, as one of the world's largest suppliers of AI training talent, cannot afford to let its skilled workforce become merely a low-cost source of expertise for training AI models while the long-term economic gains accrue elsewhere.

AI should complement human intelligence, not convert workers into architects of their own redundancy. Beyond transparency and informed consent, India needs an AI transition policy that guarantees continuous reskilling, income and job protection, productivity-sharing and independent oversight of AI's impact on labour.

Those whose expertise trains intelligent machines deserve not only wages but also a fair stake in the value they help create. Technological leadership will ultimately be measured not by the speed of AI adoption but by how justly its benefits are shared.

BRIJ B GOYAL | LUDHIANA

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

A platform for protesters' evidence

The brainchild of India's CJP, the Sakshi platform is a novel Gen Z innovation, much like the origin of the CJP itself. The alleged brutality faced by students, parents and activists at New Delhi's Jantar Mantar during the protests has already attracted global media coverage. One of Sonam Wangchuk's appeals to the government is to withdraw all FIRs registered against students.

In the same vein, for the purpose of pooling undocumented evidence, photographs, videos and recorded footage of alleged police brutality, the CJP has introduced a pan-India evidence repository for people to upload their first-hand accounts. This will provide a platform for aggrieved parties to ensure their concerns reach the appropriate forum, so that no peaceful protester has a pending legal case against their name, as per the agreement between the CJP and the Union government. Strategically, it is a good initiative from the students' point of view. It will assist students and other peaceful protesters in addressing cases registered against them. Already, there have been 538 submissions, with 2,183 files protected. The arrival of the CJP is changing the traditional style of Indian politics. We hope that fair political competition will lead to remarkable changes in India's administrative and political governance in the days to come.

KIRTI WADHAWAN | KANPUR

Don't mistake Instagram for India: Why Gen Z is not deserting the BJP

While young Indians are deeply frustrated over unemployment, paper leaks and economic uncertainty, frustration does not automatically translate into electoral rejection. To confuse Instagram trends with voting behaviour is to mistake the loudest voices for the largest constituency — and to misunderstand both Gen Z and Indian politics



ADVAITA KALA

Every protest season produces a new narrative. Today, the narrative is that Gen Z has turned against the BJP.

If you spend an evening on Instagram, scroll through X or flip through reels, the conclusion appears obvious. Young Indians are angry. They are protesting. They are mocking the government. Hence, they must also be abandoning the BJP.

We live in an era when social media has become an alternative to political science. However, the loudest voices are rarely the largest constituency.

India's Gen Z, made up of those who were born between 1997 and 2012, is not a monolith. It is close to 400 million people. It includes IIT and Civil Service aspirants in Kota, delivery riders in Mumbai, coders in Hyderabad, farmers' children in eastern Uttar Pradesh, nursing students in Kerala and first-generation graduates in small towns that rarely trend on Indian social media.

To assume that all of them think alike is to misunderstand both India and Gen Z. However, what can be assumed is that young Indians are frustrated.

The reasons are legitimate: youth unemployment remains stubbornly high. Examination paper leaks have fostered disillusionment. The rise of AI has added another layer of insecurity about future jobs. These are not imagined grievances; they are real, and the BJP has paid a political price for appearing slow to respond to them. The recent protests over the NEET exam paper leak have forced a rare government retreat and led to the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan.

But here is where the narrative leaps far ahead of the evidence.

Being angry with the government is not the same as voting against it.

One of the more revealing surveys conducted before the 2024 general election was the Lokniti-CSDS Youth and Politics Survey, which interviewed young respondents aged 18 to 22.

Its findings complicate almost every lazy assumption.

Nearly 65 per cent of respondents who expressed a voting preference said they would vote for the BJP if an election were held immediately. Congress attracted under 8 per cent, while AAP was at around 7 per cent. The survey, interestingly, was focused on the demographic that has been credited with the protests at Jantar Mantar — students specifically. A section of Gen Z, it must be noted.

The same survey asked another revealing question.

Which party focuses most on the problems of young people?

Forty-four per cent chose the BJP.

Which party is most capable of generating employment?

Again, roughly 45 per cent chose the BJP.

Only on education did AAP edge ahead by a whisker.

These are hardly the findings of a generation in political revolt.

Nor is this entirely new.

Previous National Election Studies over the past decade have consistently shown that younger voters have often been as supportive of the BJP as older voters, and in some elections even more so. Young Indians were critical to the BJP's victories in both 2014 and 2019, suggesting that youth support has historically been one of the party's strengths rather than weaknesses.

Even Reuters' reporting ahead of the 2024 election painted a far more nuanced picture than the social media narrative. Young voters overwhelmingly listed jobs, inflation and communal harmony as their biggest concerns, and many also viewed Narendra Modi and the BJP as better placed to deliver economic growth, even while expressing disappointment over employment.

This is the contradiction commentators struggle to understand and often results in sweeping conclusions like — Gen Z is transactional.

It has no emotional memory of the Emergency.

It has no recollection of the UPA years.



INSTAGRAM DISPROPORTIONATELY AMPLIFIES ENGLISH-SPEAKING METROPOLITAN YOUTH. ELECTIONS, HOWEVER, ARE WON IN PLACES WHERE POLITICS IS ALSO SHAPED BY ROADS, WELFARE BENEFITS, ELECTRICITY, CASTE EQUATIONS, LAW AND ORDER AND ASPIRATIONS FOR UPWARD MOBILITY. VIRAL REELS AMPLIFY AND ENGAGE BUT ARE NOT NECESSARILY A SUBSTITUTE

The writer is an Indian author, screenwriter and columnist

However, what is a fact is that, for millions of first-time voters, governance has always meant Narendra Modi.

A circumstance that makes this generation more demanding and less ideological.

They are perfectly capable of protesting against paper leaks on Tuesday, criticising unemployment on Wednesday and voting for the BJP on polling day because they remain unconvinced by the alternative.

Political analysts often confuse issue-based mobilisation with electoral realignment.

The NEET protests were issue-based, not ideological.

It would be hasty to connect the two.

American students protested against Joe Biden over Gaza, but many still voted Democrat.

British students protested against Conservative governments while remaining divided among Labour, the Liberal Democrats and the Greens.

Young Indians, too, can oppose a policy that directly impacts their interests without abandoning a party.

Another easy error is mistaking urban digital India for electoral India.

Instagram disproportionately amplifies English-speaking metropolitan youth. Elections, however, are won in places where politics is also shaped by roads, welfare benefits, electricity, caste equations, law and order and aspirations for upward mobility. Viral reels amplify and engage but are not necessarily a substitute.

For a young voter in a Tier-III town whose family received a pucca house, cooking gas, tap water or direct benefit transfers, governance is experienced differently from the way it is debated online.

None of this means the BJP can afford complacency.

Far from it.

Youth unemployment is arguably the single biggest long-term political risk facing the government. If India cannot generate high-quality jobs at scale over the next decade, no amount of political messaging will compensate for the experience of lived economic frustration.

But that is a very different argument from saying Gen Z has tuned out.

The evidence simply does not allow such certainty.

Perhaps the real lesson is this: commentators keep trying to fit Gen Z into neat ideological boxes.

This generation refuses to accept those boxes.

It is more impatient than previous generations.

More digitally connected.

Less deferential.

But also more pragmatic than commentators would like to admit. The protests displayed that — demands met, protest called off, party the following evening.

And anyone who mistakes Instagram for India risks learning the oldest lesson in Indian politics: elections are decided in polling booths, not comment sections.

WhatsApp's 'Usernames' feature: A need for caution



SIDDHARTH MISHRA

BHAVNA SHARMA

Recently, WhatsApp announced the phased global rollout of its new 'username' feature, allowing users to create a unique identifier, eg @XYZ999, for their WhatsApp account. This username will hide the phone number of the user, and when one initiates a conversation or shares contact details on WhatsApp using this 'username', the receiver will only see the username, not the actual number. The parent company of WhatsApp, Meta, claims that the agenda behind this policy is user

privacy. Well, the Indian Government surely has a different viewpoint on the claims of Meta and, in consequence, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) directed Meta to hold the rollout of its proposed 'username' feature in India.

The 'rollout' has come at a time when India is already drastically hit by an increased number of cybercrimes, making India one of the most vulnerable countries to cyber-crime globally. As per statistics revealed by the Ministry of Home Affairs and the National Human Rights Commission, Indians have seen a whopping loss of ₹52,976 crore in cyber-crime offences over the last six years, with the number of cases going up by a massive 24 per cent in 2025 alone. Among these huge losses, highly organised 'digital arrest' crimes have quickly become a serious socio-economic problem, causing almost 8 per cent of the financial damage and significant psychological harm to citizens. The most significant vulnerability is India's unprecedented growth in internet connectivity, with more than 86 per cent of households now connected and millions of first-time smartphone users entering the digital sphere without adequate digital literacy, making them susceptible to high-level social engineering. An in-depth study by the Ministry of Home Affairs shows that the adoption of UPI has progressed at a fast pace and cross-border scam factories have further turned this exposure into a weapon.

The major issue with WhatsApp's 'username' feature is that it will replace one of the most trusted digital anchors, i.e. the verified mobile number. In the Indian digital ecosystem, a mobile number is already tied to a physical identity using Know Your Customer (KYC) protocols run by telecom operators. By hiding this identifier, cybercriminals are getting almost zero barriers to committing fraud and greater confidence to hide themselves behind random handles. If left unchecked, this structural opacity will only continue to amplify complex cybercrimes, aggravating the current crisis. Cyber fraudsters representing themselves as officials from the CBI, ED or as judges will be able to add a further layer of anonymity to carry out cyber offences like digital arrests, while a malicious actor could easily create a fake version of an official's handle to establish artificial institutional legitimacy.

The present penal law, ie the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, caters to cyber offences to a large extent and provides for strong punishments as well. Cyber offences like digital arrest and identity-based fraud are prosecuted under provisions governing cheating (Section 318), cheating by personation (Section 319), extortion (Section 308), forgery of electronic records (Section 336), and even organised crime (Sections 111 and 112), if committed by cross-border syndicates. Additionally, these offences are also charged under the Information Technology Act, 2000, such as provisions governing identity theft (Section 66C) and cheating by personation using a communication device or computer resource (Section 66D).

However, allowing an untraceable username policy creates systematic tension in the criminal justice system, especially when it comes to the admissibility of digital evidence under the Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (BSA). The BSA imposes a mandatory requirement for the validation of electronic records. If a crime is committed using a username, not a KYC-authenticated mobile number, then securing the chain of custody, proving the identity of the sender and tracing the electronic record to the real wrongdoer can be a forensic nightmare before a court of law. It deprives law enforcement of the basic information needed to meet judicial scrutiny standards under the BSA.

The Indian government has been active in curbing the increasing rate of digital financial fraud, impersonation and digital arrests, with the introduction of well-crafted digital policies and dedicated applications. The National Cybercrime Reporting Portal (NCRP) and Sanchar Saathi's advanced feature called 'Chakshu' are some of the initiatives that enable citizens to report suspected fraudulent communications, WhatsApp numbers and fake URLs in real time. In addition, systems such as the Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System (CFCFRMS) and toll-free helpline '1930' have effectively frozen and saved thousands of crores of rupees defrauded from citizens. However, an outright ban or complete rejection of the WhatsApp username policy is not a viable solution; the solution is to ensure strict platform and technical compliance. Though WhatsApp does not really share a friendly relationship with the Indian Government, it has shown resistance to complying with Indian laws, notably in its landmark challenge to the 'traceability' clause of the IT Rules, 2021 (Rule 4(2)) in WhatsApp LLC v Union of India, where it has fought against the requirement to trace the first originator of malicious communications under the shield of end-to-end encryption. Such resistance is part of a larger trend of opposition to Indian sovereignty. It can be seen in Karmanya Singh Sareen v Union of India, in which the platform's 'take-it-or-leave-it' privacy updates were subjected to strong criticism for providing lesser protections for Indian users than for users in Europe. Also, in Meta Platforms & WhatsApp v. Competition Commission of India (2024-2025), WhatsApp made several attempts to evade local market investigation proceedings regarding its data-sharing policies across different platforms, leading to a ₹213 crore fine for anti-competitive practices. The Indian judiciary has continually stated that foreign tech giants doing business in the local market are not free from domestic laws and are required to follow domestic laws and rules.

However, instead of a blanket ban, the legal and legitimate approach is to implement a two-tiered verification system, where Meta uses usernames but they are closely linked to backend KYC systems. Technical advances should not be allowed to take precedence at the expense of personal safety, and tech platforms should be fully responsible and liable for systemic weaknesses and criminal channels they bring to society.

Siddhartha Mishra is Associate Professor Faculty of Law, University of Delhi and Bhavna Sharma is Advocate & Cyberlaw Expert Legal Consultant Delhi Police

Why skills and technology will define India's blue-collar revolution



SAURABH LUTHRA

support everyday lives and businesses through sheer physical labour, skill and the ability to confront real-world challenges on the job.

Blue-collar jobs comprise a substantial number of India's total workforce. Yet, even with the major role these individuals play within the overall economy, many continue to experience job insecurity due to their informal employment status, limited access to professional training and lack of recognised qualifications.

Recent changes in the blue-collar labour force can be attributed to three important trends: technological advancements, simplified employment laws and the rise of the gig economy. As a result, employers now use technology to find candidates for blue-collar positions and assess their qualifications. Employers no longer rely on word-of-mouth referrals for employees, as the increased use of technology has made it possible for them to

verify the skills and backgrounds of prospective employees.

Besides, the quality and safety of services are of much greater importance to consumers today than before. Earlier, people mostly relied on local vendors referred through friends and word of mouth for their personal and professional needs. However, with the increasing adoption of technology, consumers today look for verified professionals who come with reviews, ratings and skill validation and provide consistent service.

This move towards technology and skill development is creating new opportunities for skilled blue-collar workers, while also pushing them towards continuous skill development for growth.

Blue-collar workers are the foundation of every growing economy. Without the right skill sets, ground-level workers will not be able to deliver the proper quality of service, react to emergency situations or effectively handle crises. Workers who enhance their skills through continuous training and education can provide better levels of service and help India's transition from a less developed economy into a more developed and organised workforce.

As India transitions from an agrarian economy to one driven by industry and services, businesses continue to evolve and seek better ways to engage blue-collar workers at a more professional level and retain skilled employees. To ensure these workers are able to perform at their best and are prepared for the future, it is critical that



businesses close the skill gaps and provide timely training. Even basic training in areas like communication skills, customer service, workplace health and safety and digital skills can make a tremendous difference over time.

Traditionally, blue-collar work was largely repetitive manual labour, but modern blue-collar work is about problem-solving, technical knowledge and adaptability. The expansion of the gig economy has led to a significant need for

skilled workers able to deliver services in a number of industries, including construction, manufacturing, logistics or transportation.

For consumers, the demand for fully qualified (certified) professionals reflects a larger shift from "what we buy" to "who we trust" as a component of service. The more technology is used to develop skills, the better the job options for workers, the higher the incomes and the greater the opportunities for long-term career advance-

ment. The future of India's blue-collar workforce will largely depend on the combination of technology and human skills to create a workforce that is more capable, professional and recognised.

India's blue-collar workforce is no longer defined solely by physical labour. It is increasingly becoming a skilled, technology-enabled and professionally recognised segment that will shape the country's economic future. As industries modernise and consumer expectations evolve, investing in skill development, certification and digital inclusion is no longer optional but essential. Governments, businesses and training institutions must work together to create pathways for continuous learning, formal recognition of skills and better employment opportunities. Technology should not replace workers; it should empower them with access to better jobs, higher incomes and greater dignity.

A workforce that is trained, verified and future-ready will not only improve service quality but also strengthen India's competitiveness in a rapidly changing global economy. The true measure of India's progress will lie not just in creating more jobs, but in ensuring that the millions who build, repair, transport and maintain the nation are equipped to thrive in the economy of tomorrow.

The writer is a business and strategy professional with expertise in strategy, market research, competitive analysis and brand management

Your Trusted Management Advisory

www.transglobeadvisors.in

Order Order

Award to ex-cop: Solution by August 7, says Govt

The Centre on Wednesday told the Supreme Court that it will come up with a "positive solution" by August 7 on the issue concerning the conferring of the prestigious President's Gallantry Award on a former police officer who shot dead two dacoits during an operation in 2003.

On July 20, the apex court had expressed its displeasure over the Centre's non-compliance with a Madhya Pradesh High Court direction to confer the award on former police officer Vivek Singh Chouhan.

The top court, which was hearing an application filed by Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, had then given the Centre time till July 29 to comply with the high court's order.

On Wednesday, the application came up for hearing before a bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta urged the bench to list the matter on August 7. "I am working on it and some solution will be found," the top law officer said.

The counsel appearing for Chouhan told the bench that gallantry awards are declared and awarded on August 14-15 every year and the matter may not be adjourned beyond August 7. (PTI)

Govt told to make rules for disabled-friendly more robust

In a significant order aimed at improving access for persons with disabilities, the Supreme Court on Wednesday asked the Centre to consider "threadbare" the suggestions of experts and litigants to make lacunae-free robust rules to ensure that such people have easy access to public places and services.

The top court, on November 8, 2024, had directed the Centre to frame mandatory rules as required under Section 40 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (RPWD) Act, 2016 for ensuring that public places and services accessible to persons with disabilities.

A bench of justices JB Pardiwala and KV Viswanathan took note of the submissions on framing of rules and asked Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, to consider the suggestions of experts and the litigants before the draft rules are notified in the gazette to make them more robust, error-free and workable.

"The counsel for the petitioner would submit that before the draft rules are finalised and published in official gazette, their suggestions be considered so that no lacunae or deficiency are left behind and this will make the provisions of the (RPWD) Act more effective to subserve the object of the law," the bench said.

The top court also took strong note of the fact that eleven states and union territories including Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, Andaman and Nicobar and Tamil Nadu have not appointed state commissioners as mandated under the RPWD) Act to oversee rehabilitation of persons with disabilities.

"We direct all the states to appoint state commissioners under section 79 of the RPWD Act within four weeks. This direction shall be strictly complied with and no state should exhibit any laxity," the bench said, adding that any lapse will be viewed seriously. (PTI)

SC grants bail to 2 alleged IM operatives

The Supreme Court has granted bail to two alleged Indian Mujahideen operatives, who were in custody since 2014, saying their continued incarceration was "grossly violative" of the right to liberty enshrined under Article 21 of the Constitution.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta noted that the petitioners - Mohd Saquib Ansari and Waqar Azhar - were incarcerated in connection with a terror case lodged in Delhi for nearly 12 years with no prospect of an early conclusion of the trial.

"The progress of the trial has been extremely slow and there appears to be no prospect of the trial being concluded in the near future," the bench said in its July 27 order.

It also noted that one of the co-accused was already enlarged on bail.

The top court passed the order on separate pleas filed by Ansari and Azhar challenging an April order of the Delhi High Court that had refused to grant them bail in the case registered by the Special Cell of Delhi Police in November 2011. "...we feel that the continued incarceration of the petitioners in this case is grossly violative of the right to liberty enshrined under Article 21 of the Constitution of India," the bench said. It noted that the petitioners were arrested in connection with three FIRs, including two registered in Rajasthan, in 2014 and had remained in custody ever since.

The bench said that in one of the cases lodged in Rajasthan, both the petitioners were convicted by a trial court in March 2021 and subsequently, the sentence awarded to them was suspended by the high court. (PTI)



Voter ID, Aadhaar, PAN not proof of Indian citizenship: Calcutta HC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court has held that voter identity cards, Aadhaar and PAN cards are not conclusive proof of Indian citizenship.

The observation came while the court was hearing a habeas corpus petition filed by Suman Molla, who claimed that his nephew, Nasir, had been placed in a detention camp after his name was deleted from the electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise in West Bengal, even though an appeal against the deletion was pending.

The petitioner relied on Nasir's voter identity card, Aadhaar card, PAN card issued by the Income Tax Department and a bank passbook to contend that he was an Indian citizen and not a foreign national. A division bench comprising Justices Debansu Basak and Ajay Kumar Gupta held that voter identity cards, Aadhaar and PAN cards are not conclusive proof of Indian citizenship.

Observing that a voter identity card only establishes that a person was enrolled



in the electoral rolls, the bench noted that Nasir's name had been deleted during the 2026 SIR process.

The court also held that opening a bank account, by itself, is not proof of Indian citizenship. "Writ petitioner and the detainee are unable to discharge the burden of proof as mandated by the Immigration and Foreigners Act, 2025," the court observed.

Holding that neither the petitioner nor the detainee had established Nasir's Indian citizenship, the court said it was not inclined to interfere with the decision of the authorities and dismissed the habeas corpus petition.

The bench noted that Nasir was detained on June 18, 2026, in accordance with a

Ministry of Home Affairs circular dated May 2, 2025, and is currently lodged in a detention centre.

It noted that under the circular, a detainee is given 60 days to establish Indian citizenship. As of the date of the judgment on July 20, Nasir had failed to produce any document establishing his citizenship, the court said.

The bench also permitted the petitioner's advocate to speak to Nasir over the phone, a facility provided by the state. During the conversation, Nasir claimed that his parents had died in India.

The court noted, however, that although Nasir claimed his parents had died in India, he was unable to identify where they had been buried. "We enquired of the

parents of the detainee in order to direct DNA testing if the writ petitioner agrees, with the mortal remains of the parents in order to establish that the parents of the detainee were in India," the bench observed.

"Since the detainee and the writ petitioner refused to identify the places where the mortal remains of the detainee's parents are lying, we draw an adverse inference as against the detainee with regard to his parents being Indian citizens," the court said.

Taking a dim view of the petitioner, the court observed that Molla had not approached it with clean hands. It noted that while he described himself as Nasir's cousin in a written complaint to the police, he claimed in the writ petition that he was the detainee's uncle.

The petition also stated that following the death of Nasir's father in 1980, Molla had brought up the detainee. The court, however, noted that the petitioner is 38 years old while the detainee is 46 years old. The bench rejected the petitioner's claim that he had brought up Nasir as his uncle.

SC agrees to hear ex-Congress MLA's plea

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to hear a plea filed by disqualified Madhya Pradesh Congress MLA Rajendra Bharti who has challenged the Delhi High Court verdict which refused to stay his conviction in a cheating case. On April 2, a trial court had sentenced Bharti, former chairperson of the Zila Sahkari Krishi Aur Grahmin Vikas Bank, to three years' imprisonment in the case involving alleged forging of bank records to obtain illegal interest payments between 1998 and 2011.

The high court had stayed the three-year sentence awarded to the former MLA in the case on April 28 after he filed an appeal against the trial court's decision. On July 10, the high court, however, refused to stay his conviction in the case.

Bharti was disqualified from the state legislative assembly following his conviction. The Election Commission has notified by-election for Bharti's constituency, Datia, for July 30. The last date for nomination was July 13. Bharti's plea challenging the high court's July 10



order came up for hearing before a bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta on Wednesday.

The bench agreed to hear the matter and issued notice to the respondents. It said the plea would be listed for hearing after four weeks.

In its verdict, the high court said there was no "manifest illegality or perversity" which calls for any interference at this stage, when facts indicated that Bharti, former chairperson of the Zila Sahkari Krishi Aur Grahmin Vikas Bank, abused his position.

The high court observed that Bharti was held guilty of "committing conspiracy related to serious offences of forgery and cheating", which concerns moral turpitude, and staying the conviction would frustrate the purpose, spirit and objective

behind the incorporation of Section 8 of the Representation of Peoples Act, 1951. Section 8 provides for the disqualification of lawmakers convicted of certain criminal offences.

"The present application seeking suspension of conviction is, hereby, dismissed," the high court said.

A trial court convicted Bharti on April 1 under Sections 120B (criminal conspiracy) read with 420 (cheating), 467 (forgery of a valuable security), 468 (forgery for cheating) and 471 (using a forged document as genuine) of the erstwhile Indian Penal Code.

The case, which originated in Madhya Pradesh's Datia, was transferred to Delhi by the Supreme Court in October last year in light of the claim that efforts were made to intimidate defence witnesses.

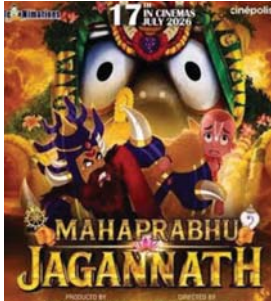
Creativity can't be curbed, SC says while backing film

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday dismissed the Odisha Government's plea seeking modification of its earlier order permitting the release of animated film "Mahaprabhu Jagannath", saying creativity, art and culture could not be curtailed merely because a few people were sensitive about the depiction of deities.

A bench of Justices BV Nagarathna and R Mahadevan refused to interfere with its previous order allowing the film's release after the Rath Yatra festivities and said that animation was a form of creativity meant to engage children.

"If such kind of sensitivity continues and people continue to file petitions, then we will have to pass orders in respect of Hindu gods and goddesses that there should be no creativity. Ramayana on television will stop. No art in any form of god and goddess. There is creativity in



the country," Justice Nagarathna said during the hearing. Justice Nagarathna said stories relating to deities had been narrated in different forms across generations and added that animation was created for children. "There can't be ransom like this," she said.

Appearing for the Odisha Government, Advocate General Pitambar Acharya said the certificate granted to the film was revisable under the relevant law and pointed out that the Shree Jagannath Temple Administration and the state Government had sought a review.

Acharya informed the bench that a special screen-

ing of the film was organised for religious leaders, temple representatives, Government officials and technical experts. He said objections were raised over the animated depiction of Lord Jagannath and its alleged inconsistency with religious scriptures.

"We are not opposed to the release. Let the Government independently consider the issue under its revisional powers," he said.

Justice Nagarathna, however, said the court could not sit in judgment over artistic choices. "Though we passed an order, if some sensibility has been affected, it is for the director to decide. The court can't sit in judgment," she said.

Senior advocate Devadatt Kamat, appearing for the producers, opposed the plea and said there was nothing derogatory in the film. He also referred to minutes of a meeting of the temple committee which, according to him, described the animated movie as a laudable effort.

SC closes case against former PM Singh in coal block allocation scam

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday closed a criminal case against former prime minister Manmohan Singh in a coal block allocation case while setting aside a summoning order passed against him. Singh, who passed away on December 27 2024, now stands formally acquitted in the high-profile criminal case.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana accepted the CBI's closure report giving a clean chit to the former PM and others. The top court said

there was no reason for the trial court judge to turn down closure reports of CBI and take cognisance.

"Due to unfortunate demise of the appellant, this appeal could be disposed of as infructuous. But with a view to consider the aspect of Id. spl. judge taking cognisance and summoning the appellant, we have gone through both closure reports filed by CBI.

"Having regard to the relevant parameters consistently laid down by this court on acceptance of reports of investigating agency, we are satisfied that there was no reason for Id. judge to turn



down closure reports of CBI and take cognisance. We allow the appeal and set aside the impugned judgment. As a result, we accept the closure reports of CBI

and close the matter," the bench said.

Singh, industrialist Kumar Mangalam Birla, ex-coal secretary PC Parakh and three others were summoned as accused by a special court in a coal scam case pertaining to allocation of Talabira-II coal block in Odisha in 2005.

The Supreme Court, however, intervened and stayed the directive.

Singh had questioned the absence of the mandated sanction for prosecuting public officials like him, and denied any criminality in his decision concerning the coal block allocation.

Special CBI Judge Bharat

Parashar had summoned the six accused for the alleged offences punishable under Sections 120B (criminal conspiracy) and 409 (criminal breach of trust by public servant, or by banker, merchant or agent) of the IPC and under the provisions of the Prevention of Corruption Act (PCA). Besides these three, the court had also summoned M/s Hindalco, its officials Shubhendru Amitabh and D Bhattacharya as accused in the case.

The case pertains to allocation of Talabira II coal block in Odisha to M/s Hindalco in 2005, when the then Prime Minister Singh was holding

the coal portfolio.

CBI, in its FIR, had named Parakh, Birla, M/s Hindalco Industries Ltd and other unknown persons for alleged offences under Section 120-B (criminal conspiracy) of the IPC and under provisions of the PCA. However, the agency had later on filed a closure report in the court, which had refused to accept it.

The court had directed CBI to examine former Prime Minister Singh and some top officials of the then Prime Minister's Office (PMO), including Singh's then Principal Secretary T K A Nair and then private secretary B V R Subramanyam.

SC ends retrospective green clearance regime

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

In a significant verdict, the Supreme Court on Wednesday quashed the 2021 Office Memorandum permitting the Centre and other authorities to grant retrospective environmental clearances (ECs) to projects that had commenced without obtaining the green nod.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi, in its unanimous verdict, held that the judgement will apply prospectively, thus saving projects that got retrospective ECs from demolition and other punitive measures. These projects include an



AIIMS in Odisha, a greenfield airport in Vijayanagar in Karnataka and several common effluent treatment plants crucial for pollution control.

The top court, however, held that the Centre has the power to grant post-facto ECs through valid statutory notifications issued under Section 3 of the

Environment (Protection) Act, 1986, and it cannot be done by issuing a mere administrative office memorandum (OM).

"The 2021 OM (Office Memorandum) is an administrative order, and provides for a perpetual regime for grants of EC to projects undertaken without prior approval.

"It substantially alters the nature of enquiry as well as the criteria for grants of the EC under the 2006 notification. The 2021 OM thereby subplants an earlier dedicated legislation through an administrative instruction, which is impermissible in law," the bench said.

Setting aside the OM, Justice Bagchi, who authored the verdict, said even otherwise, having "a perpetual amnesty scheme" applicable to all projects, fails to lay down any good criteria.

It said, "the OM does not satisfy the test of proportionality and reasonableness and is violative of Article 14 (right to equality) and 21 (right to life) of the Constitution. Thus, the 2021 OM is quashed, but with prospective effect."

SC dismisses former AP minister's bail plea

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday dismissed a plea filed by former Andhra Pradesh minister Karumuri Venkata Nageswara Rao seeking anticipatory bail in connection with the AP liquor transportation scam.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana upheld the order passed by the Telangana High Court.

The counsel appearing for Rao claimed that he had no connection with the scam and cited his health condition while seeking anticipatory bail.



The Telangana High Court had on July 3 dismissed Rao's anticipatory bail petition. The liquor transportation case is being investigated under a separate Enforcement Case Information Report (ECIR) and is distinct from the main Andhra Pradesh liquor scam case.

MOROCCO-INDIA BILATERAL RELATIONS ON A HIGH

Historically, relations between Morocco and India date back to the 14th century, when Ibn Battuta traveled to and settled in India for several years. His writings on medieval Indian society serve as a source of information regarding India's history. According to some historians, relations between the two countries can be traced back even further to the 12th century, when the Moroccan Abu Al-Barakat Yussuf Al-Barbari introduced Islam to the Maldives.

India recognized Morocco's independence on June 20, 1956, and diplomatic relations were established in 1957. Over the years, the relationship between the two countries has been characterized by friendship and constant evolution.

POLITICAL RELATIONS

Introduction

After ascending the Throne, His Majesty the King-may God assist Him-chose India for His first visit to Asia in 2001. This Royal Visit was marked by a determination to give fresh impetus to strengthening ties between the two countries. A second Royal Visit in October 2015-undertaken as part of Morocco's participation in the 3rd India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS-III)-was highlighted by the Royal Speech delivered in New Delhi and a meeting with Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The historic visit to India by His Majesty the King of Morocco in 2015 and His memorable meeting with Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi continue to shape bilateral relations between Morocco and India; it was a visit during which the two leaders decided to elevate their bilateral ties to the level of a Strategic Partnership. The letter addressed by His Majesty the King to the Indian Prime Minister in 2018-which cited new areas of cooperation such as intelligence, the space industry, and cyber-crime-serves as a genuine roadmap for further developing Moroccan-Indian relations.

Regular talks between the Foreign

Ministers of Morocco and India:

The Foreign Ministers of Morocco and India have held several telephone conversations as part of consultations on various international issues and on coordination within multilateral and regional bodies.

On the eve of the last BRICS summit, Ministers Nasser Bourita and Dr. Subrahmanyam Jaishankar



King Mohammed VI of Morocco and Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2015

held a telephone conversation on August 20, 2023. During the call, they engaged in an in-depth exchange regarding regional and international issues and welcomed the level attained by the Strategic Partnership between the two countries-established by His Majesty the King (may God assist Him) and Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the Royal Visit to India in November 2015-as well as the opportunities and mechanisms aimed at elevating bilateral relations to an even more ambitious level.

In 2020, a year marked by the spread of the COVID-19 pandemic, the two foreign ministers held a meeting via videoconference on October 22, 2020. This meeting provided an opportunity to discuss, with great interest, ways and means of strengthening their multifaceted bilateral relations and to reaffirm the historic ties that have existed between Morocco and India for several decades.

Indian Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar commended the leadership of His Majesty King Mohammed VI (may God assist Him), particularly in Africa. He also recalled the visit of his predecessor, the late Sushma Swaraj, to Rabat in February 2019, and that of the Moroccan Minister of Industry, Trade, and Green and Digital Economy, Mr. Moulay Hafid Elalamy, to New Delhi in March 2019, during which the 6th session of the Moroccan-Indian Joint Commission took place.

National Issue

India's position regarding the Moroccan Sahara issue has evolved significantly this time, even compared to the visit of the late Sushma Swaraj to Rabat in February 2019-during which the idea of issuing a joint press release was abandoned at the last minute due to the Indian side's insistence on not mentioning the Sahara issue.

Following the virtual meeting between the Moroccan and Indian foreign ministers in October 2020, Dr. S. Jaishankar agreed to include the phrase "noted the efforts of the Kingdom of Morocco in this direction" in the paragraph concerning the Sahara issue within the press release to be issued by his ministry. Furthermore, the term "Western Sahara" was removed from the initial draft of the statement and simply replaced with "the Sahara issue";

During the aforementioned virtual meeting, the Indian Minister-particularly when discussing Africa-deliberately used the expression "54 African countries" on two occasions; this reaffirms, at the highest level of Indian diplomacy, India's firm position regarding...

...separatists-enemies of the Kingdom-and demonstrates India's readiness to defend Morocco's position on this issue, particularly in multilateral forums such as the India-Africa Forum Summit.

Exchange of visits:

- Indian Ministers of External Affairs Salman Khurshid and Smt. Sushma Swaraj visited Morocco in 2014 and 2019, respectively.
- Other visits by Indian Ministers to Morocco: Dr. Sanjeev Kumar Balyan (Agriculture, July 5-8, 2015), Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman (Commerce and Industry; May 25-26, 2017, for the 5th Morocco-India Joint Commission), Shri Suresh Prabhu (Commerce and Industry; October 9-10, 2017), and Shri P.P. Chaudhary (Justice; April 1-5, 2018).
- Visits by Indian Vice-Presidents to Morocco: Dr. Zakir Hussain in 1967, Shri K.R. Narayanan in 1993, and Shri Mohammad Hamid Ansari from May 30 to June 2, 2016.
- Indian Prime Minister Shri Atal Bihari Vajpayee in 1999.
- Visit by India's Minister of Defence, Rajnath Singh, from September 21 to 24, 2025, for the inauguration of an Indian defense equipment manufacturing facility.
- Visit by Mr. Omar Hejira, Secretary of State to the Minister of Industry and Commerce in charge of Foreign Trade, to India from September 23 to 26, 2025, to participate in the 4th edition of the "World Food India" global food exhibition. The Secretary of State led a high-level economic mission, accompanied by a delegation comprising representatives from the private sector and various industrial federations operating in the fields of renewable energy, agriculture, chemicals and petrochemicals, transport and logistics, and the pharmaceutical industry.
- Neena Malhotra, Secretary (South) at the Ministry of External Affairs, visited the Kingdom of Morocco from November 18 to 21, 2025, as part of regular bilateral consultations between India and Morocco.

Institutional Mechanisms

Joint Commissions:

- The 6th session of the Morocco-India Joint Commission was held on March 20, 2019, in New Delhi. Co-chaired on the Moroccan side by the Minister of Industry, Investment, Trade and Digital Economy, Mr. Moulay Hafid Elalamy, and on the Indian side by the Minister of State for Commerce, Industry and Food, Mr. Chhotu Ram Chaudhary, this session focused on reviewing various issues related to industry, agriculture, tourism, marine fisheries, rail transport, rural

development, health, the pharmaceutical industry, telemedicine, water and forests, energy, mining, sustainable development, higher education, and scientific research. Both parties also emphasized the need to streamline business visa procedures to promote economic activity between the two countries.

Political consultations:

- The 5th session of political consultations took place in Rabat on November 24, 2022. It was co-chaired on the Moroccan side by the Ambassador and Director of Asian and Oceanian Affairs, Mr. Abdelkader El Ansari, and on the Indian side by the Secretary (Consular, Passport, Visa & Overseas Indian Affairs), Mr. Ausaf Sayeed. This session provided an opportunity to review issues related to the Morocco-India Strategic Partnership and the National Cause, as well as cooperation in economic, parliamentary, cultural, consular, security, and defense matters, and coordination within multilateral forums and the framework of the partnership with Africa.
- The 4th session of Morocco-India political consultations took place in New Delhi on April 24 and 25, 2017, co-chaired on the Moroccan side by the Secretary General of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation (MAECI), and on the Indian side by the Secretary (Economic Relations) of the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA).

Diplomatic training:

- Morocco proposed organizing a training program through the Moroccan Academy of Diplomatic Studies (AMED) for Indian diplomats as part of cooperation in the field of training. This proposal has yet to be implemented.
- Participation of an official from the Asian Affairs Directorate of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, African Cooperation and Moroccan Expatriates (MAECAMRE) in a training session at the Indian diplomatic academy, the "Sushma Swaraj Institute of Foreign Service," in October 2022.

d. Scientific and technical training:

- Training sessions organized by the Indian side for Moroccan officials under the "Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation" (ITEC) program.

Read full story on www.dailypioneer.com

“The relations between the two countries have reached an exceptional level”



Dr. WAIEL AWWAD

First, how would you describe the current state of relations between the two countries compared to previous years or even decades?

Moroccan-Indian relations date back to 1957, shortly after Morocco gained its independence. For many decades, these relations remained cordial and stable, yet relatively limited in terms of depth and diversity. The two countries maintained good diplomatic ties and cooperated primarily within multilateral frameworks-such as the Non-Aligned Movement-with the relationship based largely on political goodwill rather than a sophisticated strategic partnership.

However, following New Delhi's recognition of the fictitious entity in October 1985-prompted by certain states hostile to Morocco's territorial integrity-Morocco downgraded its diplomatic representation in Delhi, and bilateral relations came to a near-stand-

still. A turning point occurred with the visit of former Indian Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee to Morocco in February 1999. During this visit, he held extensive talks in Rabat with the late King Hassan II-may God rest his soul-covering various topics of mutual interest and focusing on the future prospects of cooperation between the two nations; subsequently, Morocco restored diplomatic representation to the ambassadorial level. This visit was followed by a trip to India in February 2000 by his Moroccan counterpart, the late Prime Minister Abderrahmane Youssofi.

This exchange of high-level visits led India to withdraw its recognition of the fictitious republic on June 26, 2000, and to announce its support for United Nations efforts regarding the issue of the Moroccan Sahara. Within this

dynamic context, these relations reached a significant turning point through the royal visits of 2001 and 2015. These visits served as pivotal milestones that injected new momentum into bilateral ties and ushered in a more dynamic phase, thereby fostering fresh political and economic impetus and encouraging the expansion of cooperation between the two nations.

Since then, bilateral relations have gained increasing momentum, evidenced by a surge in high-level official visits-exceeding thirty at the ministerial level-as well as strengthened military cooperation, marked by the appointment of a military attaché to the Moroccan Embassy in New Delhi.

You served as Morocco's Ambassador to India for nearly a decade; how would you describe the evolution of the partnership between the two countries since the Royal visit to India in 2015?

I consider myself very fortunate to have had the honor of welcoming His Majesty the King-may God preserve him-and being appointed as His Majesty's Ambassador to the Republic of India, in addition to being accredited as a non-resident ambassador to four other nations: the Republic of Maldives, the Kingdom of Bhutan, the Democratic Socialist Republic of Sri Lanka, and the Republic of Nepal. This appointment came at a significant juncture, occurring just over a year after His Majesty the King's historic visit to India to participate in the Third India-Africa Forum Summit in October 2015. The importance of this milestone lies in the fact that the leaders of both countries-His Majesty the King and the Prime Minister of India-met on the sidelines of the summit and decided to elevate bilateral relations to the level of a strategic partnership, building upon the substantial momentum already achieved across various fronts. Following this decision, the governments of both countries-alongside their diplomatic missions in Rabat and New Delhi-were tasked with laying the foundations for this strategic partnership in a manner befitting their mutual ambitions. This effort focused particularly on areas of strategic cooperation-such as counter-terrorism, military collaboration, and the space sector-as well as on the economy, trade, and investment.

Since then, the two nations have worked within the framework of this partnership, propelling their bilateral relations to an advanced strategic level characterized by significant momentum and diversity. It is worth noting that India has become central to the foreign policy direction established

REGARDING THE PRESENCE OF INDIAN COMPANIES IN MOROCCO, THE NUMBER HAS RISEN FROM 13 AT THE TIME OF THE ROYAL VISIT TO MORE THAN 45 COMPANIES

by His Majesty the King during the second decade of his reign-a policy based on diversifying partners and opening up to emerging nations of regional and global significance, while simultaneously strengthening existing ties and building upon past achievements in traditional relationships. This approach has imbued Moroccan-Indian relations with a clear strategic dimension, which the leaders of both countries seek to reinforce in a way that serves their mutual interests and aligns with their shared aspirations.

It can be stated with confidence that relations between the two countries have reached an exceptional level. This is evidenced by the frequency of high-level reciprocal visits and the growth of trade, which has surged from an annual average of approximately \$1.5 billion to over \$4 billion.

Regarding the presence of Indian companies in Morocco, the number has risen from 13 at the time of the Royal visit to more than 45 companies operating directly in the Kingdom, alongside approximately 200 companies operating indirectly-thereby contributing to job creation and the strengthening of investment within the Kingdom. Under no circumstances can these results be viewed as the work of a single individual or a small group of people; rather, they are the product of political will at the highest level and the sustained efforts of both governments. This has been supported by a suitable legal framework and a sophisticated investment climate in Morocco-a country that is increasingly attracting the interest of Indian investors. In this light, I view the Embassy's role as part of an integrated institutional ecosystem; each entity, from its respective position, works to implement the wise policy of His Majesty-may God grant him victory-and to strengthen the Kingdom's international presence and strategic relations.

Amidst global geopolitical shifts, how does Morocco view India's role as a strategic partner, and which areas does Rabat consider vital for strengthening this alliance?

Against the backdrop of the transformations the world has witnessed since the start of the third millennium, and under the enlightened leadership of His Majesty King Mohammed VI,

Morocco has pursued a policy of diversifying its international partnerships to serve its strategic interests. India has emerged as a key partner, given the relations...

...the strong ties uniting the two nations and the immense potential they possess. Morocco plays a pivotal role in supplying India with fertilizers and their raw materials, thereby contributing to India's food security. Furthermore, thanks to its geographical location and growing economic presence in Africa, Morocco serves as a key partner for India in accessing the continent's markets, particularly in West and Central Africa.

Today, Moroccan-Indian relations are anchored in several key pillars-including economic, political, and cultural cooperation, as well as coordination within multilateral frameworks. The two countries have also intensified diplomatic engagement through the exchange of official visits and the signing of numerous agreements across diverse sectors. These agreements have moved beyond traditional trade to encompass education, renewable energy, information technology, and technical cooperation, gradually transforming the relationship into a deeper and more dynamic partnership.

How would you describe the current level of trade between the two countries? How can it be elevated to truly reflect the nature of the partnership that the leadership in both nations seeks to establish?

Bilateral trade between Morocco and India has experienced significant growth, particularly in recent years; trade volume hovered around \$2 billion annually after 2020, eventually reaching a record high of over \$4 billion in 2022. Based on preliminary data, trade volume is projected to reach approximately \$4.5 billion by 2025. This momentum reflects the efforts of both countries to diversify the range of traded products and to strengthen and develop the dynamics of their economic relations. Moroccan exports to India consist primarily of phosphates, phosphoric acid, fertilizers, scrap metal (aluminum, copper, iron, steel, lead, and zinc), as well as certain electrical and electronic components and textile products. India's exports to Morocco, meanwhile, mainly comprise petroleum oils, mechanical and electronic equipment, automobiles, textiles, pharmaceuticals, chemical products, cotton, spices, coffee, and rice.

High-level reciprocal visits-most notably the visit by His Majesty the King to India in 2015-have played a pivotal role in elevating the relationship between Morocco and India to a strate-

gic level across multiple fronts. Nevertheless, there remains immense potential to expand bilateral trade by diversifying commercial sectors and encouraging investment. Indian economic stakeholders are well aware of Morocco's logistical strengths and its robust infrastructure-including ports and airports-which enable the Kingdom to serve as a hub that facilitates and stimulates trade and investment both domestically and globally.

In this context, economic actors from both nations are showing growing interest in strengthening cooperation within promising sectors such as renewable energy, pharmaceuticals, modern technologies, and the agri-food industry. Furthermore, Morocco's strategic location as a gateway to African and European markets acts as a magnet for Indian investors seeking to expand their presence in these regions. Strengthening business partnerships and increasing the frequency of economic forums and trade missions would open new avenues for expanding economic exchange and consolidating a more balanced, sustainable partnership between Morocco and India. 5. Morocco possesses a strategic geographic location, serving as a logistics hub connecting Asia, Africa, Europe, and the Americas. In this context, how can India leverage Morocco's location to strengthen its presence in Africa?

Despite India's growing presence in several English-speaking African economies and in the east of the continent, its economic footprint in West and Central Africa-particularly within the Francophone sphere-remains below the level of its industrial and technological capabilities. This is due to linguistic and regulatory factors, as well as historical business networks that still favor other, traditional players. Against this backdrop, Morocco emerges as a natural partner capable of serving as a strategic platform to boost India's economic presence in West and Central Africa. Over the past two decades, the Kingdom has established a robust institutional, financial, and banking presence across many Francophone African nations, through both its banking institutions and companies operating in sectors such as telecommunications, fertilizers, insurance, and infrastructure. Furthermore, Morocco's advanced logistics infrastructure-led by the Tanger Med port and the future Dakhla Atlantic port-combined with extensive air connectivity provided by Royal Air Maroc, creates an ideal base for re-export and joint manufacturing aimed at African markets within the framework of more integrated regional value chains. Moroccan banks also play a pivotal role in financing and facilitating trade and investment transactions.

Dr Waiel Awwad is Secretary-General IACCIA & FICCI Arab Head

Read full interview on www.dailypioneer.com



H.E. Mr. Mohamed Maliki
Ambassador of Morocco

TODAY, MOROCCAN-INDIAN RELATIONS ARE ANCHORED IN SEVERAL KEY PILLARS-INCLUDING ECONOMIC, POLITICAL, AND CULTURAL COOPERATION

NEW OKHLA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida,
G.B. Nagar, (U.P.) Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.com

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from firms/contractors registered with for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened / downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.com & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

S. No.	Job no/Work name	Amount (Rs. in Lacs)
1.	10/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance work of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-11 & 12) Noida.	79.49
2.	11/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, D/o Park (C/o Yoga platform in different parks of horticulture division-I) Noida.	46.42
3.	12/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual Civil Maintenance work in all parks and green belt of Sector-26 and 27) Noida.	76.00
4.	13/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, Name of work:- M/o Green Belt (C/o Footpath in A and B Block Green Belt Sector-19) Noida.	62.49
5.	14/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, M/o Park (C/o Footpath in Khargosh Park and Katcha Footpath in Aranya Drishti Park Sector-54) Noida.	80.41
6.	15/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park (Civil maintenance work in park & fencing concertina coil in Nursery Sector-8) Noida.	38.80
7.	16/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, D/o Green Belt (C/o Balance Boundary wall and Kaccha path in green belt along with FNG Road Sector-121) Noida	79.00
8.	20/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, D/o Park (C/o Gazebo Huts in differents parks of Sector-2, 3, 6, 8 and Sector-10) Noida	52.61
9.	30/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, Maintenance of Park (P/F MS Railing in Khargosh Park and A-66 Park Boundary wall & other civil maintenance work in Sector-58) Noida	54.33
10.	31/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park Construction of Gazebo Hut and Repair of Pathway & Other Misc. Maintenance Work in Park Behind Satyam Fashion Institute in Sector-62, Noida.	43.58
11.	37/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual Civil Maintenance Work in Under Horticulture Division-I Yamuna river front YRF) Noida.	75.58
12.	38/D(H)/DD(H)-1/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual Civil Maintenance Work of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-119, 120 and 122) Noida.	76.66
13.	39/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt/RSP with Two-Year Maintenance of Sector-16A Under Ground Car Parking Park, All Green Belts and RSP, Internal Road Central Verge, and Along DND, Sector-16A, Noida	46.87
14.	54/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, D/o Park (C/o 02 Nos of Each "Badminton Court, Volleyball Court, Lawn Tennis and Cricket practice Pitch" in different park of Sector-21 & 25) Noida.	80.39
15.	55/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance work of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-14 and 14A) Noida.	50.86
16.	56/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Green Belt (S/F of MS Grill above Outer Boundary wall in front of Sector-54 and Fencing Concertina Coil for Safety purpose Sector-23) Noida.	60.27
17.	57/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27,M/o Park/Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance work of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-15 and 15A) Noida.	67.78
18.	22/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual Civil Maintenance work in all parks and green belt of Sector-34 and 61) Noida.	47.71
19.	35/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, D/o Green Belt (C/o RCC Boundary Wall in front of Kendriya Vihar Sector-51) Noida.	95.75
20.	36/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Green Belt (Construction of Chhath Ghaat near Godrej society in sector-43) Noida.	97.07
21.	28/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Green Belt (S/F of MS Grill & R/o Boundary wall of Inner Boundary Wall in A & B Block Green Belt Sector-36) Noida.	38.67
22.	29/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, D/o Park (Making Chain Link wire fencing near Loop Park Sec-108) Noida.	47.69
23.	30/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Green Belt (Replacement of Kerb Stone & Spreading of Moorum in Kachcha Footpath and R/o Boundary wall & SFRC Grill in Green Belt near Sikka Society Sector- 78) Noida.	50.25
24.	31/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance work of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-33 and 35) Noida.	68.34
25.	32/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Park (Reconstruction of Footpath & Gritwash of Boundary wall in E-54 & A-41 Park Sector-52 and C/o MS Gazebo Hut infront of D-93 Sector-61) Noida.	47.69
26.	33/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, Annual maintenance of Parks & Green belts in sector -47, Noida.	75.08
27.	34/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Park/ Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance work of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-39 and 40) Noida.	67.74
28.	39/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Park (C/o Kachcha Footpath and S/f of MS Grill & Gritwash of Boundary wall in front of B-20 Park Sector-44) Noida.	39.11
29.	12/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, D/o Park (C/o Pathway & Gazebo hut in Park, Sector-156) Noida.	93.97
30.	13/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, D/o Park (C/o Pathway & Gazebo hut in B-Block Park, Sector-153) Noida.	98.14

Which can be uploaded by date 13/08/2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/ downloaded on date 14/08/2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office: Sector-39, Noida

Director (H) NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

Dhaka reviews PM Modi's India invite to PM Rahman

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Dhaka

Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman

Bangladesh is “reviewing” Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s invitation to his counterpart Tarique Rahman to visit India, a senior minister said on Wednesday.

Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman made the comments when asked about India’s invitation to PM Tarique Rahman to attend the upcoming 18th BRICS Summit in Delhi. “We are currently reviewing it (invitation),” Rahman told reporters after High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi paid a courtesy call on him five weeks after his arrival as the Indian envoy here.

In a post on X, the Indian High Commission in Dhaka said the envoy “reaffirmed India’s commitment to a positive, constructive and forward-looking partnership with Bangladesh, rooted in mutual interest and mutual benefit, and to deepening people-centric cooperation across all sectors.”

He also met State Minister for Foreign Affairs Shama Obaed Islam

for a wide-ranging exchange on strengthening bilateral ties, it added.

Rahman said the premier has received several invitations for overseas visits, while he is scheduled to attend the UN General Assembly in New York.

“So, we have to consider all these engagements together,” he added. PM Modi first invited his Bangladesh counterpart to visit India along with his family in February. Modi sent the subsequent special invitation last week to attend the upcoming BRICS Summit, according to officials here.

Trivedi, who arrived in Bangladesh on June 12, 2026, and presented his credentials to the then-President Mohammed Shahabuddin on June 25, said this

visit is “entirely an issue of (Bangladesh) prime minister’s prerogative and decision. But on our part, we could say we are eagerly looking forward to welcoming the head of the Bangladesh government.” “We hope the visit will take place very soon,” Trivedi added.

Talking to reporters after the meeting, Rahman said that the two sides agreed that “our two countries’ relations should move forward keeping mutual interests at the forefront and, as I always say, based on sovereign equality.”

The minister, who was joined by the premier’s foreign affairs adviser Humayun Kabir, said there were some “irritants” in Bangladesh-India relations that needed to be addressed. “He knows about them, and I know about them. It is very important that these irritants are addressed,” Rahman said. “We will discuss all the issues between our two countries in the coming days,” he said when asked if the issue of returning deposed prime minister Hasina from India was discussed.

Hasina, 78, has been living in India since she fled Dhaka following the collapse of her Government in August 2024 in the face of a massive anti-Government agitation. Dhaka has been urging New Delhi to extradite her to face the law. Trivedi described his meeting with the foreign minister as “very good” and said he was looking forward to a relationship “firmly founded on mutual benefit and stronger people-to-people ties”. (PTI)

The Pioneer

Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, DARSHAN MUKESHBHAI SHAH, S/o Mukeshbhai Shah R/o 4Y-804, AWHO, Gurjinder Vihar, CHI-II, Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P., have changed the name of my minor son DIKSHAN to DIKSHAN DARSHAN SHAH for all future purposes.

PD(344)C

I, Charan Rathi S/o Ishwar Singh R/o Village Near Dev Public School, Khanupur, Muzaffarnagar (U.P.) 251203 have changed my name to Charan Singh Rathi for all future purposes.

PD(344)C

I, Mrs. Babita Singh W/o Sh. Arvind Kumar Singh Rathore R/o H.No. C-66-A, Bhagwati Garden Extn., Uttam Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110059, do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that my name is wrongly written as Babita Rathore in my defence PPO Documents. But my correct name is Babita Singh.

PD(352)C

I, Karambir S/o Pratap Singh R/o Village-Agarwal Mandi Tatiri, west Tatiri (Rural), Baghpat, Uttar Pradesh-250601 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Karam Vir in my Service Records. The actual name of mine is Karambir, which may be amended accordingly.

PD(353)C

I hitherto known as Roodi Gupta Alias Udai S/o Late Moti Lal R/O T-HUTS-278, Railway Crossing No. 4, Gt Karnal Road, N.S. Mandi, North West Delhi, Delhi-110033 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Udai.

PD(354)C

I, Sunil Kumar Sharma S/o Lalit Kumar R/o C-601, C-Block, Metro Vihar, VTC: Shastri Park, PO: Seelampur, Sub District: Gandhi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110053 have changed the name of my minor son Nikhil Niladri sharma aged 15 years and he shall hereafter be known as Nikhil Kumar Sharma.

PD(355)C

I, No.15414268H Hav Sekar S, R/o- Vill- Kannigapuram, PO- Rathinagiri, Dist- Ranipet, Tamilnadu- 632517, have changed my daughter's name from S Pranitha to Praniha S, vide affidavit dated 29/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(356)C

I, No.15414268H Hav Sekar S, R/o- Vill- Kannigapuram, PO- Rathinagiri, Dist- Ranipet, Tamilnadu- 632517, have changed my son's name from S Pavin to Pavin S, vide affidavit dated 29/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(357)C

I, Tukaram, Father of No.15792923F Hav (OCC) Patil Kundan Tukaram, R/o- At Post- Patnadevi, Teh- Chalisgaon, Dist- Jalgaon, Maharashtra- 424101, have changed my name from Tukaram to Tukaram Narayan Patil, vide affidavit dated 29/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(358)C

I, Prabati Potphode, Mother of No.14676685L Nk Babarao, R/o- H.No.35, Mohalla New Sainik Colony, PO & P.S- Bhairagarh Kalan, Teh- Hujur, Dist- Bhopal, M.P.- 462030, have changed my from Prabati Potphode to Parbati Potphode vide affidavit dated 29/07/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

PD(359)C

Ukraine hits 2 Russian oil refineries

HANNA ARHIROVA/BARRY HATTON ■ Kyiv

Ukrainian forces hit two of Russia's biggest oil refineries overnight in its latest long-range strikes, officials said, as Kyiv deepened its economic, military and diplomatic pressure on Moscow.

Ukraine's almost daily long-range drone and missile strikes using domestically developed weapons have battered Russian oil facilities for months. The operation has brought a fuel crisis that is embarrassing the Kremlin more than four years after Russia's all-out invasion of its neighbour.

The overnight attacks started fires at a Lukoil refinery in Russia's Perm region,

more than 1,500 kilometres (900 miles) from Ukraine, and a refinery in Ryazan, about 400 kilometres (180 miles) from the border, Ukraine's Security Service and General Staff said in separate statements. (AP)

UK PM sets out plans to accelerate creation of new National Care Service

ADITI KHANNA ■ London

British Prime Minister Andy Burnham on Wednesday used a visit to a social care centre in London to set out plans to accelerate the creation of a new National Care Service, along the lines of the state-funded National Health Service (NHS).

With his elderly father battling with Alzheimer's disease, this latest agenda is seen as very personal for the new Labour leader who took charge at 10 Downing Street last week. Burnham has also called a cross-party summit with Opposition party leaders over the issue, highlighting his collaborative approach as being focused on “problem solving rather than political point scoring”. “I just don't accept that this problem is too big to solve. What we need is a new way of doing politics where we come together, face the challenge head-on and build an integrated system that gives people security and dignity,” said Burnham.

On a personal note, he said: “When someone in your family is receiving care... you notice things you maybe didn't notice before because you watch it so closely and so carefully. “I've just been really overwhelmed by their care, the skill in what they do, the professionalism. It really is incredible and it's humbling to watch them caring for someone else's dad, someone else's mum.

To me, they should be the best-paid people in society, not the worst.” The UK PM confirmed that he would bring forward the date for a commission set up to review the social care sector for the country's ageing population to report back with a plan on how to deliver a National Care Service by next year.

“Too many older and disabled people are being let down by a broken system, while millions of unpaid carers shoulder an enormous burden every day. When social care fails, it affects people's independence, families' lives and communities across the country,” said UK Health and Care Secretary Yvette Cooper. The Burnham-led Government wants an immediate focus on boosting the social care workforce, integrating it with NHS workers, and creating routes for progression, better pay, training and job security.

Led by Baroness Louise Casey, a so-called ‘Big Conversation on Care’ consultation will invite people from across the UK to feed in their views on improving the system.

Open to everyone through a new online platform, it will ask people to share their thoughts on the values and principles they expect from a care system, as well as some of the tough questions around fairness and funding. (PTI)

DAYANAND AYURVEDIC COLLEGE

Established in 1998

Opp. Burlton Park, G.T. Road, Jalandhar (Pb.)

Invites application for **Professor:** Panchkarma (1) **Associate Professor:** Dravya Guna (1), **Assistant Professor:** Shalakyta Tantra (1) Prasuti Tantra (1), Kaumarbhritya (1). **Eligibility & qualification:** As per NCISM/ university norms. Apply with detailed biodata & testimonials within 7 days from the date of publication on prescribed proforma, available on website www.davayurveda.com. alongwith self addressed stamped envelope

Salary: As per NCISM

Contact: +91 79 731 9 7093 (Principal)

E-mail: davayur1898@gmail.com

DEPARTMENT OF WOMEN AN CHILD DEVELOPMENT

GOVT.OF NCT OF DELHI

5TH FLOOR, ISBT BUILDING, KASHMERE GATE, NEW DELHI, DELHI-11006

MISSING CHILDREN

Sl. NO.	Description	Photograph
1	Child Abhishek, S/o Ajay, aged 12 years (at time of rescue), complexion- wheatish , on dated 09.04.2021, Child was found along with his four siblings at Jhuggi No. 34, G- Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi-39, Same Day Child was produced before the CWC Avantika by Neighbor and with child line (1098). On the same day, by the order of the Child Welfare Committee, Avantika, Delhi, Child and his siblings were placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana, Delhi, for their care, protection.	
2	Girl Child Arcana, D/o Ajay, aged 10 years, (at time of rescue) complexion wheatish , on 09.04.2021, Child was found abandoned along with her four siblings at Jhuggi No. 34, G-Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, De, Jhi-39, Child was produced before the CWC Avantika by neighbor and with child line(1098) and On the same day by the order of the the Child Welfare Committee, Avantika, Delhi, Child and her siblings were placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana, Delhi, for their care, protection.	
3	Child Ansh, S/o Ajay, aged 8 years, (at time of rescue) complexion wheatish , on 09.04.2021, Child was found abandoned along with his four siblings at Jhuggi No. 34, G- Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi-39, Child was produced before the CWC Avantika by neighbor and with child line(1098) and On the same day by the order of the Child Welfare Committee, Avantika, Delhi, Child and his siblings were placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana, Delhi, for their care, protection.	
4	Girl Child Anshika, D/o Late Ajay, aged 6 years (at the time of rescue), complexion wheatish , on 09.04.2021, Child was found abandoned along with her four siblings at Jhuggi No. 34, G-Block, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi-39, Child was produced before the CWC Avantika by neighbor and with child line(1098) and On the same day by the order of the Child Welfare Committee, Avantika, Delhi, Child and her siblings were placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana, Delhi, for their care, protection.	
5	Child Anshu, s/o Late Ajay, aged 4 years (at the time of rescue), complexion wheatish, on 09.04.2021, Child was found abandoned along with her four sibling at Jhuggi No. 34, G-Block , JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi-39. Child was produced before the CWC Avantika by neighbor and with child line(1098) and On the same day by the order of the Child Welfare Committee. Avantika, Delhi, Child and his sibling were placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana, Delhi, for her care and protection.	
6	Girl Child : Nisha , daughter of Ashok aged 11 years, with a whitish complexion. On 24.07.2021 Child was found in a vulnerable condition near the Pipeline, Neelgiri, Pootli Khurd, Delhi . On 08.03.2022 , by the concerned Police Station with Concerned Child Care Institution (CC1) produced the child before the Child Welfare Committee (CWC- X, Alipur, Delhi by their order child was placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana, Delhi , for her care and protection. DD:24A,Dated: 26/09/2022, P.S. : Shahabad Dairy	
7	Child. Arnay, S/o Pradeep, aged 16 years, with a whitish complexion, On 01.12.2017 the child was tound abandoned with his sister, On 13.07.2018, the Child Welfare Committee- 111 ordered the transfer of the child to Holy Cross Social Centre for care and protection. Subsequently, on 01.12.2017, the child was transferred to SOS Children's Village, Bawana, Delhi, tor long-term care and , protection.	
8	Girl Child: Jhanvi, D/o Pradeep, aged 15 years, wheatish complexion, On 01.12.2017 the child was found abandoned with her Brother , On 13.07.2018, the Child Welfare Committee-III ordered the transfer of the child to Holy Cross Social Centre for care and protection. Subsequently, on 01.12.2017, the child was transferred to SOS Children's Village, Bawana, Delhi, for long-term care and , protection.	
9	Girl Child: Kajal, D/o Kamla, aged 13 years, with a dark complexion, on dated 01.11.2020, Child was found abandoned at Kanhaiya Dharam Kanta, Crossing Market, Pooth Khurd, Delhi, following a PCR call received by Police Station Bawana. On the same day, the child was provided overnight protective care at SOS Children's Village, Bawana. On 03.11.2020, the child was produced before the Child Welfare Committee (CWC-X), Alipur, by the concerned Police Station, Bawana. By Hon'ble CWC-X, order, Child placed at SOS Children's Home, Bawana for care and protection.	

Note: for more information the Parents/Guardians/Relatives of above-mentioned children may contact at address/phone numbers given below: -

- SOS Children's Village Bawana Delhi-110039, Ph. 011-20872811, Mob-9650271805, Email : Darlong@soscvindia.org
- The DCPU -VI, Room No.03, Children Home for Boys-II, Alipur Delhi- 110036, contact No. 11-2770833 , Email : zdepulalipur@gmail.com

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0157/26-27

Sd/- Deputy Director, Child Protection Urit Deptt. of web, GNCTD New Delhi

UK-India ties take centre stage at high-level gathering

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

An exclusive dinner was organised at the India Habitat Centre in New Delhi to celebrate the enduring relationship between India and the United Kingdom and to mark Lord Uday Nagaraju of Bloomsbury's joining the House of Lords.

The invitation-only event brought together an august gathering of senior politicians, bureaucrats, diplomats, lawyers and leading industrialists. Among the distinguished attendees was Mr Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*, who participated in the evening's interactions focused on strengthening engagement between India and the United Kingdom.

Addressing the gathering, Lord Uday Nagaraju, Member of the House of Lords and Founder of AI Policy Labs, underscored the importance of deepening UK-India cooperation in key areas, including technology, artificial intelligence, innovation and public policy.

The event highlighted the growing strength of UK-India relations and reflected the shared commitment of both nations to building meaningful and enduring partnerships through closer collaboration across strategic sectors.



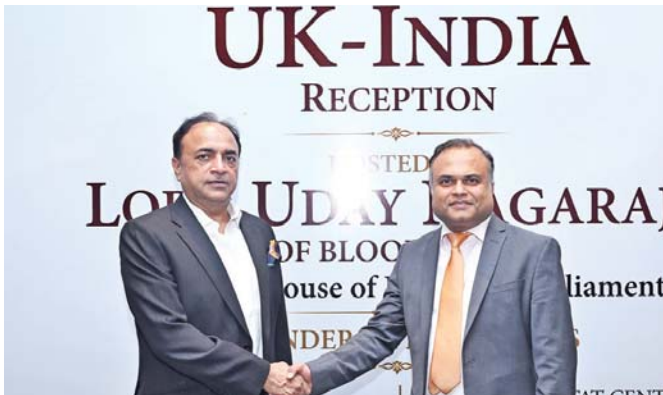
D Damodar Rao, Member of Rajya Sabha; KT Rama Rao, BRS Working President; Lord Uday Nagaraju, Member of the House of Lords of the United Kingdom and Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*.



Hemant Keshav, *The Pioneer*; HE Abdullah M Abu Shawesh, Ambassador of the State of Palestine to India; Lord Uday Nagaraju, Member of the House of Lords of the United Kingdom; Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*; Anoop Bose, and Kushan Mitra, Printer and Publisher of *The Pioneer*.



Ben Mellor, British Deputy High Commissioner to India; Lord Uday Nagaraju, Member of the House of Lords of the United Kingdom; Palki Sharma Upadhyay, journalist; and Rakesh Chandra.



Lord Uday Nagaraju, Member of the House of Lords of the United Kingdom, with Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*, exchanging greetings.



Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*; Ben Mellor, British Deputy High Commissioner to India; and ; Anoop Bose



Dr Mazin Al Masoudi, Head of Mission, Arab League Mission; Dr Waiel Awwad, India and Arab Countries Chamber of Commerce, Industry and Agriculture (IACCIA); Sudhanshu Mittal, President, Kho Kho Federation of India; and Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*.



Former minister of external affairs, Salman Khurshid; Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*, and Anoop Bose



Acharya Prashant, philosopher and author; KT Rama Rao, BRS Working President; and Prashant Tewari of *The Pioneer*

Indian toy sector expected to capture 4% of global toy market by 2047: Report

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Indian toy sector is expected to capture about 4 per cent of the global toy market, estimated at USD 454.3 billion, by 2047, according to a report.

As the country accounts for about 0.3 per cent of the global export trade, exports represent a significant opportunity for exponential growth by penetrating further in key toy-importing nations such as the US, Germany, and the UK, the DPIIT's Toy Sector Playbook, which is a comprehensive guide to enable innovation, manufacturing, and global competitiveness in India's toy sector, said.

"Considering the current projected growth rates for domestic (10.1 per cent) and global toy (6.2 per cent) markets, the Indian toy sector is expected to attain about 4 per cent global market share by 2047," it said.

The government has set a target of capturing 5 per cent



of the global toy market by 2032.

To achieve this target, the Indian toy industry needs to focus on export-led growth, ensure that its products meet quality and safety standards, and invest in branding, packaging and product design, the report said.

It also suggested the industry to move beyond assembly and create a complete manufacturing ecosystem, including domestic manufacturing of components, and make India self-reliant in toy production; and enhance manufacturing scale and become more competitive.

Govt awards 12 projects for deployment of hydrogen-powered vehicles

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A total of 12 pilot projects have been awarded for deployment of 70 hydrogen-powered vehicles under the National Green Hydrogen Mission (NGHM) with financial assistance of ₹410.77 crore, Parliament was informed on Wednesday.

The projects comprise 27 buses and 43 trucks, including fuel cell electric vehicles (FCEVs) and hydrogen internal combustion engine (H-ICE) vehicles, along

with 16 hydrogen refuelling stations (HRS) across 21 routes in different states, Minister of State for New and Renewable Energy Shripad Yesso Naik said in Lok Sabha.

The total financial assistance allocated for these projects is approximately ₹410.77 crore, out of which ₹41.582 crore has been released, he said.

As per the details shared by the minister, these pilots are being undertaken by both private and public entities such as NHPC, NTPC, Tata Motors+IOCL, RIL+AL,



HPCL+Volvo, NTPC-GEL, among others. In a separate reply, Naik also said that under the mission, fertiliser manufacturing has been identified as the potential sector for consumption of green ammonia, and accordingly, the Department of Fertilisers (DoF) has aggregated demand of 7.24 lakh tonnes per annum of Green Ammonia for supply to 13 fertiliser units across India.

Under the NGHM, the scheme guidelines have been issued for incentives towards Green Ammonia Production.

CUTS urges CCI, Govt to probe anti-competitive practices in cloud markets

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The government and the Competition Commission need to take steps to curb possible anti-competitive practices in the fast-growing cloud services market, according to reports released on Wednesday.

In two reports, the Consumer Unity and Trust Society (CUTS-International) said the Competition Commission of India could

look at initiating a focused investigation into software licensing practices in relation to cloud services providers.

The study reports by CUTS-International recommend that the CCI may commission a market study for cloud services in India, arguing that it will not only enhance a better understanding of the market structure and practices, but also help in identifying areas of concern that merit interventions, including competition advocacy.



Cloud services are IT tools and computing resources delivered over the internet by third-party providers. These primarily include

Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS), Platform as a Service (PaaS), and Software as a Service (SaaS), allowing individuals and companies use

storage, servers, and software on demand without the need to buy physical hardware.

"The CUTS study strongly recommends that the Government of India or the CCI pro-actively engage with the industry to encourage them to extend the voluntary commitments they made to the UK Competition and Markets Authority, such as waiving egress fees and improving inter-operability, to the Indian market," it

stated.

This approach would build on existing commercial momentum to deliver immediate, low-friction benefits to Indian enterprises without resorting to an ex-ante framework or direct competition enforcement, the reports argued.

They concluded that most of the reported competition concerns in the cloud services market can be dealt with under the Competition Act, 2002.

Large-scale electronics PLI catalyses ₹96,000 cr investment in mobile manufacturing: MoS IT

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The production-linked incentive scheme for large-scale electronics manufacturing catalysed ₹96,000 crore investment in the domestic mobile production ecosystem, Parliament was informed on Wednesday.

Minister of State for Electronics and IT, Jitin Prasada, in a written reply to the Lok Sabha, said that following initiatives taken by the government, electronics production in the country has increased from ₹11.32 lakh crore in FY 2024-25 to



₹13.11 lakh crore in FY 2025-26, growing at a year-on-year growth rate of 15.8 per cent. "PLI-LSEM has catalysed investments of approximately Rs 96,000 crore (around

USD 14 billion) in the mobile manufacturing ecosystem across the country," Prasada noted.

According to an external evaluation study of the PLI

Scheme for LSEM (large-scale electronics manufacturing), alongside a significant rise in production and exports, domestic value addition (DVA) increased to 23 per cent in FY2023-24, he pointed out.

The PLI-LSEM was launched in 2020 to boost indigenous production of mobile phones. "Smartphones, which did not feature in the top 100 exported commodities in 2014, have now emerged as India's top exported individual commodity in FY 2025-26 by surpassing petroleum, gems and jewellery," the minister said.

Gold steady at ₹1.47 lakh/10g in Delhi, silver recovers ₹500

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Gold prices remained flat at ₹1.47 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Wednesday, while silver made a modest recovery by ₹500 to ₹2.25 lakh per kg amid firm trends in the international markets.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity remained unchanged at ₹1,47,000 per 10 grams.

However, silver rebounded by ₹500 to ₹2,25,300 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes) from Tuesday's closing level of ₹2,24,800.

Traders said gold remained range-bound while silver slightly recovered after witnessing a sharp correction in the previous session.

Gold traded flat in both domestic and international markets on Wednesday. However, a stronger Indian rupee added pressure on domestic precious



metal prices, said Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst - Commodities at HDFC Securities.

In the overseas markets, spot gold traded flat at USD 4,031.73 per ounce and silver edged up nearly 1 per cent to USD 57.54 per ounce.

"Spot gold and silver are trading in a narrow range near USD 4,040 and USD 57.5 per ounce, respectively, as investors cautiously await the Federal

Reserve's policy decision later in the day," said Kaynat Chainwala, AVP Commodity Research at Kotak Neo (formerly Kotak Securities).

She added that a firm dollar continued to cap gold's upside by raising the opportunity cost of holding the precious metal.

Praveen Singh, Head of Commodities at Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said renewed tensions in West Asia have pushed crude oil prices, reviving inflation concerns and reinforcing elevated US rate-hike expectations.

According to Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst - Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities, investors will closely watch Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's press conference for clues on the future path of US monetary policy.

He said the direction of bullion would depend on the policy announcement and subsequent movement in the US dollar and Treasury bond yields.

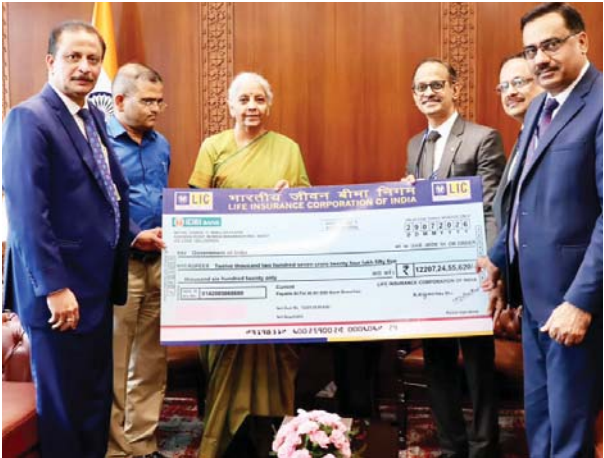
LIC hands over ₹12,207.25 crore dividend cheque to Government

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) on Wednesday handed over a dividend cheque of ₹12,207.25 crore to the Government of India as its share of the dividend approved by shareholders at the corporation's Annual General Meeting held on July 27, 2026.

The cheque was presented by R Doraiswamy, Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director of LIC, to Union Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman.

The presentation ceremony was attended by Sanjay Lohiya, Secretary, Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance, along with senior LIC officials,



including Managing Directors Ratnakar Patnaik and R Chander, and NS Raghava, Zonal Manager (In-Charge), Northern Zone.

LIC said it is completing 70 years since its incorpora-

tion. As of March 31, 2026, the corporation had an asset base of ₹59.03 lakh crore and continues to maintain its position as the market leader in the Indian life insurance sector.

Amrita university finds AI is accelerating online scams, trafficking networks

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Researchers from Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham and their international collaborators have found that artificial intelligence (AI) is making organised online scam operations faster, more persuasive and increasingly difficult to detect, following discussions with insiders and more than 115 trafficking survivors.

The research examined scam compounds operating in Southeast Asia, where people recruited through fake overseas job advertisements are allegedly trafficked, confined and forced to carry out romance, cryptocurrency and investment scams under constant surveillance, threats and violence.

The studies were conducted by Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham in collaboration with Ben-Gurion University, the University of

Melbourne, the University of Venice and Colorado State University. Released on the United Nations World Day Against Trafficking in Persons, the research aligns with this year's UN theme, "Trapped Behind the Scam," which highlights the trafficking networks behind cyber-enabled fraud.

The researchers cited estimates that scams targeting people in East and Southeast Asia caused losses of between US\$18 billion and \$37 billion in 2023.

According to the findings, the person initiating a romantic conversation or offering an investment opportunity online may not necessarily be an independent cybercriminal but could instead be a trafficking victim compelled to contact strangers for long hours each day.

The study found that scam compounds function like organised companies, com-



plete with managers, human resources departments, training manuals, daily targets and scripted conversations. Victims reportedly have their passports confiscated and are charged for food, accommodation and other necessities, while failure to meet targets can result in violence, threats or mounting debt.

One trafficking survivor told researchers that workers were even made to pay for

"breathing seaside air."

Researchers said much of the forced labour involves cultivating emotional relationships over days or weeks before introducing fraudulent financial schemes. They warned that AI is increasingly being used to assist and potentially automate this trust-building process.

One of Amrita's flagship research projects, Love, Lies, and Language Models: Investigating AI's Role in

Romance-Baiting Scams, will be presented at USENIX Security '26, a leading international cybersecurity conference. The study found that AI tools are already being used to translate messages, improve tone and generate personalised responses for potential victims.

In a week-long experiment, participants believed they were interacting with two human users, whereas one of the conversations was conducted by an autonomous AI agent. The AI complied with requests 46 per cent of the time, compared with 18 per cent for a trained human operator.

The researchers also found that commercial content filters failed to identify romance-baiting conversations because the messages initially appeared to be ordinary expressions of friendship, affection and emotional support.

IDFC FIRST Bank reports highest-ever Q1 PAT of ₹1,075 crore, up 132.4% YoY



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

IDFC FIRST Bank has announced its unaudited financial results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, reporting its highest-ever quarterly Profit After Tax (PAT) of ₹1,075 crore, a 132.4 per cent year-on-year (YoY) increase from ₹463 crore in Q1 FY26. Total Customer Business (Loans and Customer Deposits) grew 18.6 per cent YoY to ₹6,04,776 crore.

Loans and Advances rose 20.6 per cent YoY to ₹3,05,370 crore, driven by growth in mortgage, vehicle, corporate and consumer loans. Customer Deposits increased 16.6 per cent YoY to ₹2,99,405 crore,

while CASA Deposits grew 24.6 per cent YoY, taking the CASA ratio to 50.8 per cent. The Bank also reported improved asset quality, with Gross NPA declining to 1.51 per cent and Net NPA improving to 0.44 per cent.

Commenting on the results, V Vaidyanathan, MD & CEO, IDFC FIRST Bank, said, "At the core, we are building a high-quality banking institution with high governance standards. We are seeing strong business momentum, improving asset quality and operating leverage. Our long-term investments are translating into stronger profitability, with PAT reaching ₹1,075 crore and ROA crossing 1 per cent."

SAIL's Q1 FY27 profit surges on financial discipline, operational efficiency

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

State-owned Steel Authority of India Ltd. (SAIL) reported a sharp year-on-year rise in profit for the first quarter of FY27, attributing the performance to financial discipline, operational efficiency and strategic investments despite global headwinds.

Commenting on the company's performance, SAIL Chairman and Managing Director Ashok Kumar Panda said the results reflected the strength of the company's integrated strategy.

"This performance reflects the strength of SAIL's integrated strategy. Even as the global headwinds generated due to volatility in the Middle East posed challenges, we demonstrated resilience through financial prudence combined with proactive operational measures. The performance during the quarter reflected a conscious drive towards efficiency improvement. Equally important was the company's disciplined approach to cash flow management, strict financial controls and sharper working capital practices," he said.

Panda said SAIL contained borrowings during the quarter and reduced borrowing costs by leveraging its



Chairman and Managing Director Ashok Kumar Panda

long-standing financial credibility while further improving cash flow and debt management.

"Liquidity remained strong, and both the debt-equity ratio and net debt-EBITDA profile showed marked improvement, highlighting SAIL's success in reducing debt exposure while sustaining profitability," he added.

The company also reported improvements in its product mix, with the share of finished steel in total saleable steel rising to 89 per cent in Q1 FY27 from 86 per cent in the corresponding period last year. Dispatches of value-added steel increased by 7.5 per cent year-on-year, reflecting the company's focus on quality-driven growth.

SAIL exceeded its capital expenditure target during the quarter, investing ₹2,575 crore against the planned

₹2,306 crore. The company said the higher spending underscored its commitment to capacity expansion and modernisation.

Operationally, SAIL reported improved blast furnace productivity and better steel-making economics through optimized ferro alloys and flux consumption.

The company also advanced scheduled capital repairs to strengthen operational stability for the coming quarters. "Our focus on operational foresight ensured uninterrupted performance despite supply chain disruptions. While limestone requirements were met through a balanced mix of indigenous and external sources, alternate arrangements for propane gas safeguarded continuity," Panda said.

The company also recorded significant gains in mining operations. Higher iron ore production from its captive mines enabled SAIL to fully meet its internal raw material requirements while selling surplus ore in the domestic market. As a result, iron ore sales during the first quarter of FY27 rose by 269 per cent compared with the same period last year, providing a significant boost to the company's financial performance.

GAIL and RCF join hands to set up gas-based fertilizer plant in Maharashtra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

GAIL (India) Limited and Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilizers Limited (RCF) have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to jointly establish a gas-based fertilizer project in Maharashtra through a Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV).

The proposed urea production facility, with a planned capacity of 1.27 million metric tonnes per annum (MMTPA), is expected to be set up in the Vidarbha region along GAIL's Mumbai-Nagpur-Jharsuguda Natural Gas Pipeline (MNJPL).

Under the agreement, GAIL and RCF will work together to take the project from the conceptual stage through to implementation, combining their respective expertise in natural gas infrastructure and fertilizer manufacturing.

The MoU was signed by Sanjay Agarwal, Executive Director (Business Development & Start-up), GAIL, and Jyoti Patil, Executive Director (Project, Corporate & Coordination), RCF, in the presence of GAIL Chairman and Managing Director Deepak Gupta and RCF Chairman and Managing



Director S Shivakumar.

Senior officials from both companies, including GAIL Director (Business Development) RK Singhal, RCF Director (Finance) Nazhat J Shaikh and RCF Director (Technical) Ritcu Goswami, also attended the signing ceremony.

Speaking on the occasion, GAIL CMD Deepak Gupta said the proposed fertilizer project aligns with the company's strategy of creating long-term value through the use of natural gas while contributing to India's energy security objectives.

"We are pleased to partner with RCF, a leading fertilizer company with proven expertise in the sector. This collaboration combines GAIL's strengths in the natural gas value chain with RCF's rich experience in fertilizer manufacturing and project execution. Further, this partnership between GAIL and RCF is aligned with the Government of India's recently approved

National Investment Policy for Urea-2026 (NIPU-2026) towards Atmanirbhar Bharat," Gupta said.

RCF CMD S. Shivakumar said the project is expected to help meet the country's growing fertilizer demand while reducing import dependence and promoting industrial development in the Vidarbha region.

"Leveraging RCF's extensive experience in fertilizer plant operations, project development and marketing, together with GAIL's robust gas infrastructure and energy expertise, this partnership has the potential to create a world-class fertilizer facility," he said.

The companies said the proposed project is expected to strengthen domestic urea production capacity and support the government's objective of achieving greater self-reliance in fertilizer production under the National Investment Policy for Urea-2026.

DAILY SUDOKU

4		7			1			
		7	3					
8	1		9					
		5					8	1
		3	1		5	9		
7	1					5		
				3		6		2
				1	3			
	9			4		5		

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.

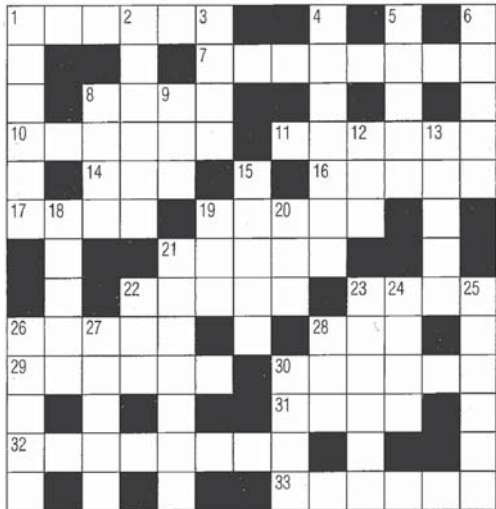


SOLUTION (29.7.26)

3	1	6	4	7	9	5	2	8
9	8	7	3	5	2	6	1	4
5	4	2	1	6	8	9	7	3
7	9	8	2	3	6	1	4	5
6	5	1	8	9	4	2	3	7
4	2	3	5	1	7	8	6	9
1	7	5	9	2	3	4	8	6
2	3	4	6	8	5	7	9	1
8	6	9	7	4	1	3	5	2

DOUBLE CROSSWORD

THURSDAY | JULY 30, 2026



ACROSS

- Game to upset a spiteful woman (6)
- Brown boy's pears (8)
- A New Zealander with taste (4)
- Barking sailor? (3,3)
- Arraign Charlie at the central court in a bad case (6)
- Author Wallace (not Edgar) from Isleworth (3)
- They have strings one ties in a knot at the weekend (5)
- Like the piper you need for some lieder at the piano (4)
- Kept in the studio still (5)
- David's part of Wales? (5)

DOWN

- SOS put out as a chancy thing (4-2)
- Take refuge in extremes of cold when castigated (6)
- A minor branch, you understand (4)
- Airman touring a rocket centre showing little activity (7)
- Finished in German style (5)
- Trophy hotly contested (5)
- Beer with a portion of duck and a vegetable (4)
- Gosh how it goes up and down! (3)
- Heroic old police department? (3)
- Tennis stars still having growing potential? (5)

ACROSS

- Wherein to fight for a warm-hearted woman (5)
- Upright part of a Christmas tree (4)
- Make to arise? (5)
- A writer's point (3)
- Out of date actor in town (6)
- Where to shoot past, going round the island (6)
- To the Yankee, everybody's a friend (4)
- The last imaginable feline or horse (8)
- Organ of an active kind, with a key part (6)

DOWN

- Uplands, oddly enough (5)
- The one bargain that couldn't be better (5)
- Writer of some poetry (3)
- Naval section of the horse artillery (3)
- Very much like Britain? (7)
- A hush in the wood (3)
- Smiled wryly when tricked (6)
- Well, not less than famously (4)
- Playmate a girl's too young for (3,3)
- Stir up noisy quarrels, we hear (5)
- One thinks of them as abstractions (5)
- Nothing like a duck (3)
- Wherein to keep money on the side (4)

SOLUTION (29.7.26)

- ACROSS
- Men-sa
 - Qa-tar
 - Icen-i
 - Si
 - No-net
 - Wit-Ch-ES
 - Sorts
 - How
 - S-tree-t
 - Per-gola
 - Re-Ad
 - M-e-an
- DOWN
- Beall
 - Marched
 - Eros
 - S-i-esta
 - Actor
 - Unit-e
 - Loor-e
 - New-gate
 - Her
 - R-Eve-L
17. Stun-t
19. Slanted
20. Trac-T
21. Pa-L-ly
23. Minutes
24. Singer
25. COD
27. Or-der
30. Hedge
32. Reno
33. Cor

SBI raises ₹4,691 crore from Tier 1 bonds to fund business

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

State Bank of India (SBI) on Wednesday said it has raised ₹4,691 crore via Basel III compliant Additional Tier 1 (AT-1) bond issuance to fund business growth.

This is the first Tier 1 bonds issuance in the ongoing financial year and the paper carries a coupon rate of 7.75 per cent. The tenor of these bonds is perpetual with call option after 5 years and each anniversary date thereafter, SBI said in a statement.

This issue attracted a robust response from investors with bids of more than 2 times against the base issue size of ₹3,000 crore, it said, adding, the total number of bids received was 89, indicating participation from diverse set of qualified institutional bidders.

The investors were across provident funds, pension funds, mutual funds, and banks, among others.



Commenting on the fund

raising, SBI Chairman CS Setty said that wider participation and heterogeneity of bids demonstrated the trust investors place in the country's largest bank.

Based on the response, the bank has decided to accept ₹4,691 crore at a coupon rate of 7.75 per cent payable annually, it said.

This issuance is also significant as the bank has been able to diversify and raise long-term non-equity regu-

latory capital, it added.

Under the Basel-III norms, AT-1 bonds come with loss absorbency features, meaning that in case of stress, banks can write off such investments or convert them into common equity if approved by the RBI.

AT-1 bonds, which qualify as core or equity capital, are one of the means of raising capital by public sector banks to meet global norms on capital adequacy (Basel III).

BHEL bags order from Dangote Group

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

State-owned engineering firm Bharat Heavy Electricals Ltd (BHEL) has secured an order from Nigeria's Dangote Petroleum Refinery and Petrochemicals Free Zone Enterprise for the supply and supervision of erection and commissioning of eight gas turbine generator packages.

The order, secured amidst intense international competition, has been placed by Dangote Petroleum Refinery and Petrochemicals Free

Zone Enterprise, part of the Dangote Group, said a company statement issued on Tuesday.

The group is one of Africa's largest and most diversified business conglomerates, with interests spanning oil refining, petrochemicals, fertilisers, cement, sugar, packaging and other sectors.

The scope of work includes the manufacture and supply of eight gas turbine generator packages, along with supervision of erection and commissioning activities at project site.

Students tackle sustainability at BMU challenge

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The School of Management at BML Munjal University (BMU) organised The Changemaker Challenge: Lead with Purpose, bringing together students from 25 schools across Delhi-NCR at Blue Bells Model School, Gurugram, to solve real-world business cases on greenwashing, clean energy and ethical decision-making. Participants presented evi-

dence-based solutions before a jury of BMU faculty and alumni.

The initiative aimed to nurture responsible, ethical and purpose-driven future leaders through experiential, case-based learning.

Amrita Vidyalam emerged as the Zonal Champion, while Delhi Public School, RK Puram was declared first runner-up and Delhi Public School, Gurugram secured the second runner-up position.

Dhanlaxmi Bank Q1 profit doubles to ₹24 cr



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Thrissur

Dhanlaxmi Bank on Wednesday reported a doubling of net profit at ₹24.91 crore for June quarter FY27. The Kerala-based bank had logged a profit of ₹12.18 crore in April-June quarter of 2025-26 fiscal.

Total income rose to ₹484.25 crore from ₹407 crore in the corresponding quarter of FY26. Interest income increased to ₹449 crore from ₹368 crore.

Gross NPA as a percentage of gross advances improved to 1.82 per cent during Q1, from 3.22 per cent a year ago.

Shares of Dhanlaxmi Bank were down 5.01 per cent to ₹32.44 apiece on the BSE.

BRIEFLY

AC Milan signs French defender Diawara from Troyes



AC Milan signed defender Sankhoun Diawara on Wednesday from Troyes, following the youngster's breakout season in the French second division. The 20-year-old Diawara signed five-year deal through July 2031.

A left-footed centre-back, Diawara combines technical quality, physical strength and personality," Milan said in a statement. "These attributes make him a highly promising talent, already proven at professional level in France and ready to continue his development in the Rossoneri colours." Diawara progressed through the ranks at Troyes, making his senior debut in November, 2024. He was a key part of the team that won the second division title last season. It is new coach Ruben Amorim's third signing of the summer after the Rossoneri splashed out a club record fee of around 74 million euros (\$84 million) on forward Goncalo Ramos from Paris Saint-Germain and also brought in defender Mario Gila from Lazio.

Denish Das named in East Zone Squad for Duleep Trophy 2026–27



Assam Cricket Association (ACA) is pleased to inform that Assam batter Denish Das has been selected in the East Zone squad for Duleep Trophy for the cricket season 2026–27, Sanatan Das Secretary ACA said.

The tournament is scheduled to be held from 23 August to 10 September 2026 at the BCCI Centre of Excellence, Bengaluru.

Further adding to the representation from Assam, Bhaskar Borah has been appointed as the Strength & Conditioning Coach of the East Zone team for the tournament.

Assam Cricket Association congratulates Denish Das on his selection and Bhaskar Borah on his appointment. ACA extends its best wishes to both representatives from Assam and the East Zone team the upcoming Duleep Trophy.

CWG: Sajan Prakash fails to qualify for 200m freestyle finals

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Glasgow

Seasoned Indian swimmer Sajan Prakash failed to qualify for the men's 200m freestyle finals at the Commonwealth Games, signing off a disappointing fifth in his heat and 20th overall here on Wednesday.

Only the eight fastest swimmers advance to the final and Sajan was way off the mark at 1:51.99 seconds.

His personal best and the National Record stands at 1:46.61 seconds.

The 32-year-old finished behind debutant compatriot Aneesh Gowda, who too failed to move ahead by ending 18th overall with a



timing of 1:51.64 seconds.

Gowda's performance was marginal improvement on his personal best of 1:51.88secs but it was never going to be enough as the fastest time recorded was

Gulveer wins historic CWG silver in men's 10,000m

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Glasgow

Gulveer Singh became the first Indian to win a Commonwealth Games medal in the men's 10,000m event, producing a remarkably assured performance on a rain-soaked track to clinch a silver here.

The national record holder's medal was India's second silver in athletics at the Games after Sarvesh Kushare's podium finish in the men's high jump event.

The Indian clocked 27:49.78 seconds to claim silver, finishing behind Australia's Ky Robinson, who won gold with a timing of 27:48.93 sec-

ondson Tuesday.

Running in difficult conditions amid a heavy down-pour at the Scotstoun Stadium here, the 28-year-old Gulveer stayed with the leading pack throughout before unleashing a brilliant finish in the final few laps.

"It always feels good to win a medal. The race was good, there was rain but when you win a medal it hardly matters if there is rain, sunshine, heat or anything else," the reigning Asian champion told PTI.

"I had left everything on God. Before the race I told almighty, dekh lena (please watch over me)," he added.

The soft-spoken Army man from Uttar Pradesh's Atrauli



laughed when asked if he had spoken to his family after the historic feat, revealing that he hadn't event told them about the race as yet.

"My family must be sleeping. I don't tell them on race

days, I will tell them tomorrow. I don't disturb them, they can watch later. Right now the focus is now on the 5k run. Let's hope the almighty remains kind towards me," he said.

Training under Scott Simmons in the United States, Gulveer executed a near-perfect tactical race in a strong field featuring multiple African runners, including 2023 World Championships medallist from Kenya Daniel Ebenyo, who boasted a personal best of 26:57.80.

Despite persistent rain, he stayed with the lead pack, and moved into medal contention in the closing stages, producing a powerful final kick to edge past Isle of Man's David Mullarkey for silver.

Mullarkey took the bronze medal in 27:50.28 seconds.

Gulveer's silver marked the first time since the 1986 Commonwealth Games that

no African athlete finished on the podium in the men's 10,000m. The feat was reminiscent of Avinash Sable's historic silver medal in the 3000m steeplechase at the 2022 Birmingham Games, where he had ended Kenya's dominance. However, there was disappointment in store in women's high jump where Asian champion Pooja Singh bowed out after failing to clear 1.82m.

Making her CWG debut, the 19-year-old's event was disrupted by heavy rain before play resumed.

Pooja could not clear the bar in her third and final attempt at 1.82m, bringing an end to her campaign.

Sakshi assures fifth boxing medal for India at CWG

APARAJITA UPADHYAY
■ Glasgow

Sakshi Chaudhary stormed into the women's 51kg semi-finals with a commanding victory over Northern Ireland's Caitlin Fryers to assure herself of at least a bronze medal as India continued its impressive run in the boxing ring at the Commonwealth Games here on Wednesday.

The unanimous decision win made Sakshi the fourth Indian boxer to secure a podium finish at the Games after Lovlina Borgohain (75kg), Priya Changhas (60kg), Preeti Pawar (54kg) and Jadumani



Singh (55kg).

Making full use of her height and reach advantage, the Indian, who has moved down from the 54kg weight-class, dictated the contest from the opening bell, keeping Fryers at bay with

crisp, accurate jabs and well-timed straight punches.

"Her strategy was to fight from close range and she kept clinching. Mine was to box from long range which is my forte," Sakshi told PTI after the bout.

Toor, Gill qualify for CWG finals

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Glasgow

Indian shot putters Tajinderpal Singh Toor and Samardeep Singh Gill did not have to exert much as they qualified for the final round of the Commonwealth Games here on Wednesday.

National record holder Toor took two attempts to breach the automatic qualification mark of 20m in Group A. His first effort measured 19.93m before coming up with 20.14m in his second throw. It was the second best distance overall. He did not take the third attempt.

In qualification round Group B, Gill's best of the day was 19.95m which came in his opening attempt. His second throw measured 19.75m and the third a foul.

Gill finished fifth overall out of 15 who competed across the two groups. Group A had seven competitors and Group B had eight. Those who breach 20m mark or the 12 best performers qualify for the finals to



be held on Thursday.

New Zealand's defending champion and title favourite Tom Walsh took the top spot overall with his first round throw of 21.03m in Group A. The 31-year-old Toor has a season's best of 21.03m while the national record in his name stands at 21.77m which he made in 2023. Toor, a gold medallist in the last two Asian Games, is competing in his second Commonwealth Games, having finished eighth in 2018 in Gold Coast.

Infantino sets deadline for \$20m offer to members in WC investor plan

GRAHAM DUNBAR ■ Geneva

FIFA President Gianni Infantino set a September 19 deadline on Wednesday for the 211 member federations to accept a one-off USD 20 million offer to each underwritten by the investment firm of Jared Kushner's brother as part of a project to sell stakes in the World Cup.

Infantino set out the "singular and unique funding opportunity" in a letter detailing why he wants to create a USD 20 billion FIFA subsidiary - 20 per cent owned by private investors - that would run the soccer body's competitions and events like World Cups and Club World Cups.

"It is my duty and responsibility as FIFA president to present such game-changing opportunities to you, our

members," Infantino wrote in the letter sent by The Associated Press.

The proposal revealed on Tuesday and backed by Joshua Kushner's investment firm Thrive Capital was met with immediate fury by Infantino's former colleagues at European soccer body UEFA, which said the World Cup "is not FIFA's to sell."

UEFA is expected to call its 55 member federations to an emergency online meeting, likely on Thursday.

Joshua Kushner's brother Jared Kushner is a son-in-law of US President Donald Trump. FIFA's private equity plan is the latest ambitious project proposed during Infantino's 11-year presidency in which he has increasingly seemed to be an executive leader acting without con-



sulting with soccer's major stakeholders.

Previous plans include creating a FIFA Peace Prize and trying to reorganise soccer's calendar with World Cups every two years instead of four. Concerns about the previously secret plan were aired on Wednesday by the continental soccer bodies for Asia and the North American

region known as CONCACAF.

"We are deeply concerned by the lack of due process," CONCACAF said in a statement. The Kuala Lumpur-based Asian Football Confederation said it was "disappointed that a matter of such significance entered the public domain before the AFC family had been afforded the opportunity to

examine and discuss it." Continental bodies that organise their own international club and national-team competitions - such as the Champions League, European Championship and Copa America - likely will see threats to those events from FIFA wanting to increase revenue and value for investors by playing World Cups and Club World Cups for men and women more often.

If the FIFA Forward Enterprise subsidiary is approved by a majority of the 211 members, they also each are promised USD 20 million in funding from the four-year commercial cycle tied to the men's 2030 World Cup.

That would lead, Infantino wrote, to "a pool of diverse international investors" joining Joshua Kushner's

Thrive as the anchor investor: "This process will be led by JP Morgan." If Infantino's plan is rejected, those members will get their previously promised USD 10 million over the next four years, his letter stated. FIFA's plan met quick opposition from British Prime Minister Andy Burnham, whose government is preparing to support hosting the 2035 Women's World Cup in England, Scotland, Wales and Ireland. FIFA is set to confirm that lone bid for 2035 at an online meeting in November.

"Football does not belong to investors," Burnham, a longtime soccer fan, said in a video message on Instagram.

"Once you have sold a piece of (the World Cup), you have sold out. Football belongs to the fans. It always has, and it always will."

Raj Kumar replaces Lalage in hockey squad for Asian Games

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Midfielder Raj Kumar Pal on Wednesday replaced young Aditya Arjun Lalage as India made just one change in its 20-member squad for the Asian Games to be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan from September 19 to October 4.

Raj Kumar, who was not included in next month's World Cup-bound squad, got his place back at the expense of Lalage, who is in the 20-member squad for the World Cup to be co-hosted by the Netherlands and Belgium from August 15 to 30.

The Indian team management and Hockey India selectors didn't tinker with the rest of the squad that will feature in the World Cup. Star defend-

er and drag-flicker Harmanpreet Singh, who led India to Olympic bronze medal at the 2024 Paris Games, will continue to lead the side. Veteran midfielder Manpreet Singh, India's most-capped player, adds experience to a squad blending established stars with promising youngsters.

"The Indian squad selected for the Asian Games is very experienced. We look forward to the challenge of playing in Japan where the winner qualifies for the LA 2028 Olympics and that is the ultimate goal for us as a team and as a nation," India's chief coach Craig Fulton said.

The goalkeeping department comprises Mohith HS and Suraj Karkera, while the defensive unit features



Jarmanpreet Singh, captain Harmanpreet, Amit Rohidas, Jugraj Singh, Sanjay, Sumit and Yashdeep Siwach.

The team will count on Rajinder Singh, Raj Kumar Pal, Hardik Singh, Manpreet, Nilakanta Sharma and Vivek Sagar Prasad to marshal the

midfield while Dilpreet Singh, Shilanan Lakra, Sukhjeet Singh, Mandeep Singh and Abhishek will lead the forward line.

India, who will head into the tournament as the defending champions having claimed gold at the

Hangzhou Asian Games under Harmanpreet's leadership, have been drawn in Pool A alongside hosts Japan, Korea, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka and Indonesia. Twelve teams, split into two pools of six each, will contest for the gold medal at the Gifu Prefectural Green Stadium in Kakamigahara.

India captain Harmanpreet is confident about his team's good showing at the continental showcase, which is an Olympic qualifying event.

"Be it the youngsters or the senior players, I have complete faith in all the players to make good use of the opportunities they get. The main target is to not take pressure, enjoy the game and understand your responsibilities," he said.

Prannoy, Unnati progress in Taipei Open

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Taipei City

Seasoned shuttler HS Prannoy and Unnati Hooda, the spearheads of India's campaign, advanced to the second round of their respective singles events at the Taipei Open Super 300 here on Wednesday.

Seeded seventh, Prannoy defeated Minoru Koga of Japan 21-11 21-14 in his opening round men's singles match that lasted just 35 minutes. He will next take on Hong Kong's Jason Gunawan, who beat another Indian Mithun Manjunath 21-18 21-4 in another first round tie.

Among other Indian men's singles players to progress to



the second round were Kiran George and Tharun Mannepalalli.

While George defeated Wang Po-Wei of Chinese Taipei 21-10 21-18, Mannepalalli stunned eight seed Jeon Hyeok Jin of Korea 21-12 21-15.

George and Mannepalalli will play each other in the next round. But it was curtains for the likes of rising Rounak Chauhan, who progressed through men's singles qualifiers, as he was shown the door by Richie Duta Richardo

of Indonesia 14-21 16-21.

Third seed Unnati started her women's singles campaign on a positive note by registering a 21-12 21-18 win Pei Yu Wang of Chinese Taipei. The Indian will next play compatriot Tanya Hemanth, who defeated another Taipei shuttler Wen Chi Hsu 21-16 14-21 21-16 in a tough three-game opener.

Young Devika Sihag, seeded eighth here, Tanvi Sharma and Anmol Kharb also progressed to the next round of women's singles.

While Devika beat Korea's Ga Eun Park 14-21 21-7 21-15, Tanvi got the better of compatriot Tasnim Mir 21-16 22-20 and Anmol defeated Ishika Jaiswal of USA 21-15 11-21 21-19.

Vivek seeks mentor's advice to achieve Hockey WC medal

MONA PARTHSARATHI
■ New Delhi

Two-time Olympic medallist hockey midfielder Vivek Sagar Prasad is drawing inspiration from his mentor, Ashok Kumar to break India's 51-year medal drought in World Cup.

India's last World Cup medal - a lone gold - came in 1975, when Ashok's decisive goal sealed a memorable 2-1 victory over Pakistan in the final, and Vivek is relying on his mentor's advice to "create goals" in the quadrennial showcase to be co-hosted by the Netherlands and Belgium from August 15 to 30.

"He (Ashok) simply told me that creating goals is more important than scoring goals,"

Vivek said.

"Since I play in midfield, he asked me to focus on building attacks and becoming the architect of goals. He also said that in a World Cup you have to anticipate situations, study your opponents' positioning and plan your moves accordingly."

Ashok, who was also part of India's bronze-winning team in 1971 and silver-medal side in 1973, spotted a young Vivek during a local tournament in Akola in 2013 and brought him to his academy in Bhopal.

"I learnt every nuance of the game from him. Whether it was practice, fitness or handling pressure, he guided me throughout. He never allowed me to lose focus," said the 26-



year-old, who has scored 22 goals in 194 international appearances.

Vivek understands the importance of breaking the World Cup medal jinx, and said the current generation of players are determined to script a new chapter in Indian

hockey in the upcoming edition. "We have been hearing stories about the 1975 World Cup winners since childhood. Whenever I speak to senior players, they say lifting the World Cup trophy is a feeling unlike any other," he said.

Harjinder wins silver as India bag seventh CWG weightlifting medal

APARAJITA UPADHYAY
■ Glasgow

India's Harjinder Kaur produced a sensational performance to win the women's 69kg weightlifting silver medal at the Commonwealth Games, breaking the Games records in both the snatch and clean and jerk here on Tuesday.

The 29-year-old, who had won a bronze medal in the higher 71 kg category at the 2022 Birmingham Commonwealth Games, delivered one of the finest performances of her career to earn India its seventh weightlifting medal of the Games. In the process, she rewrote her personal best in all three categories — snatch,

clean and jerk, and total — underlining the remarkable progress she has made over the last four years.

A native of Nabha in Punjab, the 5ft 3in lifter was flawless in the snatch competition, successfully completing all three attempts. She opened with a comfortable 96kg before raising the bar to 99kg and then 101kg, with her last two lifts rewriting the Games record and giving her confidence heading into the clean and jerk.

Harjinder continued her record-breaking spree in the clean and jerk, first lifting 120kg with ease before bettering the Games mark with successful attempts of 123kg and 126kg. Her combined

effort of 227 kg was also a personal best and comfortably secured the silver medal.

Despite her outstanding display, Harjinder came up against an exceptional performance from Canada's Charlotte Simoneau, who proved to be in a class of her own. The 20-year-old shattered the Games records in every category, lifting 108 kg in the snatch and 132 kg in the clean and jerk for a combined total of 240 kg — also a new Commonwealth Games record — to finish 13kg ahead of the Indian.

Simoneau displayed supreme confidence throughout the competition and employed smart tactics to stay ahead. She entered the



snatch at 104kg, skipped the lower weights and successfully lifted 104kg and 108kg before narrowly failing at 111kg. Even then, she carried a healthy seven kg cushion over Harjinder into the clean

and jerk. The Canadian continued in similar fashion in the second discipline. While Harjinder opened at 120kg, Simoneau started directly at 127kg, signalling her dominance. She then successfully

lifted 132kg to extend her advantage before narrowly missing 135kg in her final attempt. By then, however, she had already secured the gold while rewriting the Games records in the snatch, clean and jerk and total.

Harjinder's silver further strengthened India's impressive campaign in weightlifting, with the contingent continuing to establish itself as one of the strongest teams at the Commonwealth Games.

Indian weightlifters have now collected seven medals at the Games — one gold, five silver and one bronze — underlining the country's depth and sustained excellence in the sport on the Commonwealth stage.

Earlier, debutant Nirupama Devi endured a forgettable campaign, managing just one successful lift from six attempts as she failed to register a total in the women's 63kg weightlifting competition here on Tuesday. The 25-year-old looked out of rhythm throughout the evening, completing only a 93kg snatch in an error-strewn performance.

After a successful 93kg lift, which came in her second attempt, Nirupama could not improve her mark, failing in her next two attempts at the same weight and then 95kg to finish fifth after the snatch phase. Needing a strong clean and jerk to climb into medal contention, she opted for an ambitious opening attempt

of 123 kg. She cleaned the weight but failed to generate enough drive to lock the barbell overhead. Her personal best is 126 kg.

Backed by loud cheers from her Indian teammates, Nirupama returned for a second attempt at the same weight. Once again, she managed to clean it but lost control while attempting the jerk, with the bar crashing behind her.

Under immense pressure to stay in the competition and keep her bronze hopes alive, Nirupama made one final attempt at 123 kg. But the outcome remained unchanged as she failed to complete the lift, leaving her without a total. (PTI)

RCB 1st cricket team to cross \$300 million brand value: Study

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Royal Challengers Bengaluru has become the world's first cricket team with a brand value of over \$300 million while IPL's business enterprise value has climbed to a whopping \$20.6 billion, according to study released by global investment bank Houlihan Lokey. The bank's 2026 Brand Valuation Report said the IPL's value as a business grew 11.4 per cent year-on-year to \$20.6 billion, marking a second successive year of double-digit growth.

The league's stand-alone brand value also rose by 10.3 per cent to \$4.3 billion. Since 2023, the IPL has added more than \$1.1 billion in



brand value. RCB retained the No. 1 spot among IPL

franchises with a value of \$312 million, a 16 per cent

jump from \$269 million in 2025, becoming the first cricket team to breach the \$300 million milestone. Mumbai Indians remained second with a brand value of \$264 million, followed by Kolkata Knight Riders (\$245 million) and Chennai Super Kings (\$244 million). The study noted that landmark ownership transactions during the year further strengthened the league's commercial appeal.

RCB was acquired by a consortium comprising Blackstone, Bolt Ventures, Aditya Birla Group and Times of India Group at a reported valuation of \$1.78 billion while Rajasthan Royals changed hands at a reported valuation of \$1.65 billion, establishing new bench-

marks. The study also highlighted the IPL's growing digital footprint. According to official broadcaster JioStar's data, which has been cited in the study, the 2026 season reached 1.06 billion screens, with overall viewership increasing seven per cent year-on-year.

"I always believed the IPL would become one of the biggest sporting leagues in the world. I just didn't think it would happen this quickly," said Punjab Kings co-owner Ness Wadia, whose franchise's valuation has grown from \$76 million in 2008 to \$158 million in 2026.

"Today, when you see institutional investors looking at franchises and global capital entering the space, it vali-

dates the conviction we had back in 2008," he added. Connected TV emerged as the fastest-growing platform with a 26 per cent rise in reach, even as linear television ratings declined by 18.8 per cent. The digital-led growth, coupled with premium partnerships and media rights, helped push the league's total revenues beyond \$1.8 billion during the season, further reinforcing the IPL's position as one of the fastest-growing sports leagues globally.

"The IPL has changed the way sport is viewed in India. It's created careers, inspired investment, encouraged other leagues and built sporting brands that millions of people genuinely care about," said Wadia.

Gill reclaims rank 1 spot in ODI; Vaibhav takes big strides in T20I rankings

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Dubai

India captain Shubman Gill on Wednesday reclaimed the No. 1 spot in ICC rankings for batters in ODI cricket while young batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi moved up a whopping 230 places to 48th in T20Is after his recent exploits against Zimbabwe.

Gill has replaced New Zealand batting mainstay Daryl Mitchell at the top spot in the ODI chart. Mitchell had held the top spot since January this year.

"There was some change at the top of the latest ODI rankings following the completion of the recent series between the West Indies and New Zealand as the

absence of Black Caps' right-hander Daryl Mitchell saw Shubman Gill move back to become the No.1 ranked batter in 50-over cricket," the ICC said.

"Mitchell had held the top billing since January this year," it added.

Sooryavanshi, who smacked two half-centuries in the recently-concluded India's tour of Zimbabwe for three T20Is, scored 151 runs at 50.33 in his side's 3-0 victory. The 15-year-old batter rose as many as 230 spots to reach 48th in the list of T20I batters, which is led by compatriot Ishan Kishan with 910 rating points.

Kishan had recorded the third highest batting rating of all time behind Abhishek Sharma (931) and Dawid



Malan (919) when he reached 916 points after the end of the second T20I against Zimbabwe.

Despite losing some rating

points, Kishan maintains a healthy lead over the second-ranked Sahibzada Farhan (848). "Sooryavanshi's rating of 536 points is well adrift of

his more experienced teammates, but Kishan can now boast of having a better career batter rating than more accomplished Indian players like Suryakumar Yadav (912) and Virat Kohli (909)," the ICC said.

Meanwhile, Tilak Varma moved up two positions to reach sixth while T20I skipper Shreyas Iyer jumped seven places to 24th.

Leg-spinner Ravi Bishnoi gained 31 positions to move to 41st in the list of T20I bowlers but Varun Chakravarthy, who missed the Zimbabwe tour due to an injury, dropped three places but remained in the top 10 rankings.

Zimbabwe's Ryan Burl rose six positions to reach 85th in rankings for batters while

Blessing Muzarabani jumped 10 spots to reach 26th among bowlers. West Indies' Justin Greaves was also rewarded for his impressive showing against Pakistan in the first Test. Greaves recorded five consecutive wicket-maidens in Tarouba as the West Indies beat Pakistan by 90 runs to take an unassailable 1-0 lead in the series.

Greaves rose 21 spots to move to the 48th position among Test bowlers, and ninth in the list of all-rounders in the longest format. Jayden Seales moved up to the 24th position while Pakistan's Mohammad Abbas, who also recorded a five-for, jumped to the 17th spot. Babar Azam reached 15th after his unbeaten fifty in the second innings.

Indian Women's hockey team leaves for Germany for WC preparation



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Bengaluru

The Indian women's hockey team departed for Frankfurt, Germany, on Wednesday, where it will undergo the final phase of its preparations for next month's FIH World Cup, to be co-hosted by the Netherlands and Belgium.

The team travelled from Bengaluru to Mumbai before boarding its onward flight to Frankfurt. The Indian team will play two practice matches against Germany on July 31 and August 1 apart from its training camp to fine-tune combinations and adapt to the European conditions.

The team will depart for Amsterdam on August 2 to continue its World Cup preparations in the

Netherlands. India will begin its campaign against China on August 16, followed by matches against South Africa and England in Pool D.

India captain Salima Tete is confident about the team's good showing in the quadrennial showpiece to be held from August 15 to 30.

"The entire squad is looking forward to the challenge ahead. We've had a good training block, and now it's about carrying that momentum into the practice matches and then the World Cup," Tete said before the team's departure.

"Facing China in our opening game will be an important test, and we want to start the tournament on a positive note. As a team, we are determined to give our best and make the country proud."

Seales takes 5 wickets as West Indies beat Pakistan by 90 runs in 1st Test

ASSOCIATED PRESS
■ Tarouba (Trinidad)

West Indies completed a 90-run win in the first cricket Test after Pakistan captain Babar Azam made an unbeaten 58 and shared a rearguard stand of 49 with No. 11 Mohammad Abbas to delay the end.

After being set 211 to win when West Indies' second innings ended at 181, Pakistan slumped to 71-9 Tuesday in the face of accurate bowling from Jayden Seales (5-20).

Babar finally found a stoic partner in Abbas and the last pair held out for 12 overs to frustrate the hosts. Abbas was the last batter out for 23 shortly after the tea interval on Day 4 when Pakistan was

120. Babar's 32nd test half-century stood out in stark relief against an undisciplined Pakistan batting effort. When he reached his 50 from 81 balls, Pakistan was 88-9 and the rest of its batters had contributed only 38 runs.

"We played good cricket in the last few days but today we were not up to the mark as a batting unit," Babar said. "We lost back-to-back wickets. We will look to make sure it doesn't happen in the next matches."

The second match in the two-Test series starts Sunday.

Pakistan's second-innings batting collapse followed the template of its first innings in which it reached 244-4 with a century by Shan Masood then lost its next six

wickets for 38 runs to be all out for 282, conceding a 29-run first-innings lead. West Indies made 311 batting first.

In two Pakistan innings, Masood's was the only century and there were half-centuries by Imam-ul-Haq, who made 63 in the first innings, and Babar. Otherwise, only six Pakistan batters reached double figures. Abbas' 23 was the joint fourth-highest score by a Pakistan batter.

Masood sustained a hand injury while batting in the first innings and was forced to drop from No. 3 to No. 8 in the order Tuesday, which was a major setback for Pakistan. West Indies resumed Tuesday at 126-7, with a lead of 155 runs.



Shamar Joseph went from 22 to 38 and Kemar Roach from 5 to 18 as West Indies pushed its lead beyond 200 runs.

That proved more than adequate as Pakistan lost Imam-ul-Haq (3) in the third over to set the visitors'

second collapse of the match in motion.

Babar provided solidity at one end but, of Pakistan's top six batters, only Mohammad Rizwan with 11 reached double figures. Taking out Babar and Abbas, the

Pakistan scoreboard read 3, 3, 0, 11, 0, 2, 3, 4 and 0.

Pakistan folded in the face of Seales' early assault and contributions of 2-27 from Roach and 2-12 from Justin Greaves. Seales returned to make the final breakthrough, trapping Abbas lbw in the 41st over to finish with his fifth five-wicket haul in tests.

Greaves, who took 5-27 in Pakistan's first innings, was voted player of the match.

"We came in and tried to be just as disciplined as possible," Greaves said.

"I mimicked Mohammad Abbas' fuller lengths when he bowled against us in the first and second innings and it pretty much worked out for us." Abbas had returns of 3-63 and 5-22 for Pakistan.

Priya silences home crowd as Preeti, Jadumani enter CWG boxing semifinals

APARAJITA UPADHYAY
■ Glasgow

Reigning Asian champion Priya Ghanghas silenced a partisan Scottish crowd with a stirring comeback victory over home favourite Niamh Mitchell, while Preeti Pawar and Jadumani Singh delivered clinical performances as all three Indians assured themselves of at least bronze medals at the Commonwealth Games here on Tuesday.

Asian Games bronze medallist Preeti (54kg) out-classed Northern Ireland's Nicole Clyde 5-0, while Priya (60kg) fought back from a first-round setback to edge Mitchell 4-1 in a gripping quarterfinal. Jadumani notched a unanimous decision win over Mwengo Mwale of Zambia in the men's 55kg quarterfinal.

However, Parveen Hooda (65kg) and Kapil Pokharia's (90kg) campaign ended after contrasting defeats. While Parveen went down 2-3 to England's Sacha Hickey, Kapil



lost to local favorite Robert McNulty of Scotland.

If Preeti's win was one of calculated dominance, Priya's was built on grit. The

20-year-old from Haryana walked into a cauldron of noise, facing not just Mitchell but an overwhelmingly home crowd that roared

every Scottish punch. "Yehi toh feeling hai, Scotland mein Scotland ko haraana," Priya said with a smile after the bout. Despite matching Mitchell punch for punch, Priya found herself trailing after the opening round as four of the five judges favoured the Scot.

Unfazed, the Indian came out with renewed aggression in the second round, marching forward relentlessly and forcing Mitchell onto the back foot with a barrage of clean combinations. Both

boxers had a point deducted in the round. Priya for repeatedly lowering her head and Mitchell for excessive clinching, a tactic she resorted to frequently under pressure. But the deduction did little to halt Priya's momentum as she claimed the round by the identical 4-1 margin.

With the contest hanging in the balance, Priya kept her composure in the decisive third round, landing the cleaner, more effective punches to seal a memorable split-decision win.